



Novus Holdings Limited and its subsidiaries

Registration Number: 2008/011165/06

Annual financial statements

for the year ended 31 March 2026

The reports and statements set out below comprise the annual financial statements presented to the shareholders.

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Statement of responsibility by the Board of directors

for the year ended 31 March 2026

The annual financial statements of the Group and the Company are the responsibility of the directors of Novus Holdings Limited ("Board"). In discharging this responsibility, they rely on the management of the Group to prepare the annual financial statements presented on pages 16 to 105 in accordance with the JSE Listings Requirements, IFRS Accounting Standards as issued by the International Accounting Standards Board (IFRS Accounting Standards) and the Companies Act of South Africa, 2008 (Act No 71 of 2008), as amended ("Companies Act"). As such, the annual financial statements include amounts based on judgements and estimates made by management. The information given is comprehensive and presented in a responsible manner.

The directors accept responsibility for the preparation, integrity and fair presentation of the annual financial statements and are satisfied that the systems and internal financial controls implemented by management are effective. The directors' responsibilities also include implementing adequate controls and security to maintain the integrity of the Company's website.

The directors believe that the Group and the Company have adequate resources to continue operations as a going concern in the foreseeable future, based on forecasts and available cash resources. The financial statements support the viability of the Group and the Company. The preparation of the financial results was supervised by the Chief Financial Officer, Kim Julies CA(SA).

The independent auditing firm, BDO South Africa Incorporated ("BDO"), which was given unrestricted access to all financial records and related data, including minutes of all meetings of shareholders, the Board and committees of the Board, has audited the financial statements. The Board believes that all representations made to the independent auditors during their audit were valid and appropriate. BDO's audit report is presented on page 11.

The annual financial statements were approved by the Board on 11 June 2026 and are signed on its behalf by:



A van der Veen
Chief Executive Officer



K Julies
Chief Financial Officer

CEO and CFO responsibility statement

Each of the directors, whose names are stated below, hereby confirm that-

- The annual financial statements set out on pages 16 to 105, fairly present in all material respects the financial position, financial performance and cash flows of Novus Holdings Limited in terms of IFRS Accounting Standards;
- To the best of our knowledge and belief, no facts have been omitted or untrue statements made that would make the annual financial statements false or misleading;
- Internal financial controls have been put in place to ensure that material information relating to Novus Holdings Limited, its consolidated subsidiaries and controlled entities have been provided to effectively prepare the financial statements of Novus Holdings Limited;
- The internal financial controls are adequate and effective and can be relied upon in compiling the annual financial statements, having fulfilled our role and function as executive directors with primary responsibility for implementation and execution of controls;
- Where we are not satisfied; we have disclosed to the Audit and Risk Committee and the auditors any deficiencies in design and operational effectiveness of the internal financial controls and have remediated the deficiencies; and
- We are not aware of any fraud involving directors.



A van der Veen
Chief Executive Officer



K Julies
Chief Financial Officer

Certificate by the company secretary

In terms of section 88(2)(e) of the Companies Act, 2008 (Act No 71 of 2008), as amended, we, Acorim Proprietary Limited, in our capacity as company secretary of Novus Holdings Limited, confirm that for the year ended 31 March 2026, the Company has lodged with the Companies and Intellectual Property Commission, all such returns as are required of a public company in terms of the Companies Act and that all such returns and notices are, to the best of our knowledge, true, correct and up to date.



Acorim Proprietary Limited
Company Secretary

11 June 2026

Report of the audit and risk committee

The Audit and Risk Committee ("the committee") submit this report, as required by section 94 of the South African Companies Act, 2008 (Act No 71 of 2008), as amended, ("Companies Act").

Composition of the audit and risk committee

The committee comprises:

- Mr A Mayman (Chair)
- Ms P Mnisi (appointed 01 April 2025)
- Mr A Zetler

Functions of the audit and risk committee

The committee has adopted formal terms of reference, delegated to it by the Board of directors, as its committee charter. The committee has discharged the functions in terms of its charter and ascribed to it in terms of the Companies Act as follows:

- Reviewed the year-end financial statements, culminating in a recommendation to the Board to adopt them. In the course of its review the committee:
 - takes appropriate steps to ensure that the financial statements are prepared in accordance with IFRS Accounting Standards as issued by the International Accounting Standards Board (IFRS Accounting Standards) and in the manner required by the Companies Act and the JSE Listings Requirements;
 - considers and, when appropriate, makes recommendations on internal financial controls;
 - deals with concerns or complaints relating to accounting policies, internal audit, the auditing or content of annual financial statements, and internal financial controls; and
 - reviews legal matters that could have a significant impact on the organisation's financial statements.
- Reviewed the external audit reports on the financial statements;
- Approved the internal audit charter and audit plan;
- Reviewed the internal audit and risk management reports, and, where relevant, recommendations are made to the Board;
- Evaluated the effectiveness of risk management, controls and the governance processes;
- Verified the independence of the external auditors, nominated BDO South Africa Incorporated as the auditors for 2026 and noted the appointment of Ms Fayaz Mohamed as the designated auditor;
- Approved the audit fees and engagement terms of the external auditors;
- Determined the nature and extent of allowable non-audit services and pre-approved the contract terms for the provision of non-audit services by the external auditors; and
- Confirmed that appropriate financial reporting procedures are established and that those procedures are operating effectively, which includes consideration of all the entities in the consolidated Group financial statements.

Members of the audit and risk committee

The committee comprises two independent non-executive directors and one non-independent non-executive director who meet at least three times per year in accordance with the committee charter. All members act independently as described in section 94 of the Companies Act.

Attendance

The committee has met three times during the year.

The internal and external auditors, in their capacity as auditors to the Group, attended and reported at all three meetings of the committee. Executive directors and relevant senior managers attended meetings by invitation.

Committee agendas provide for confidential meetings between the committee members and the internal and external auditors.

Report of the audit and risk committee (continued)

Internal audit

The committee has oversight of the Group's financial statements and reporting process, including the system of internal financial control. It is responsible for ensuring that the Group's internal audit function is independent and has the necessary resources, standing and authority in the organisation to discharge its duties. The committee oversees cooperation between internal and external auditors and serves as a link between the Board and these functions. The internal audit function reports functionally to the chair of the committee and administratively to the Group Chief Financial Officer.

Based on the review of the Group's system of internal controls and risk management, and considering the information and explanations given by management and discussions with the external auditor on the results of the audit, nothing has come to the attention of the committee that caused it to believe that the Group's system of internal controls and risk management are not effective, and that the internal financial controls do not form a sound basis for the preparation of reliable financial statements.

Combined assurance

The Group implements a combined assurance model ("CAM") and this is overseen by the committee. The CAM draws from the risk management process and assesses the adequacy of assurance being provided using the three lines of defence model (i.e. management-based assurance, risk and compliance-based assurance and independent assurance). The committee has considered the risk assessments and mitigation plans presented by management, evaluated and approved the plans of the internal audit function and the external auditors, and the outcomes of the audit work performed. The committee is satisfied that the combined assurance framework is appropriate and provides sufficient assurance over the Group's risk universe.

Risk management

The Group has an enterprise-wide risk management framework which is designed to ensure that significant risks and related incidents are identified, documented, managed, monitored and reported in a consistent and structured manner across the Group. The committee has reviewed the strategic risks which could materially impact the ability of the Group to deliver its objectives and the related mitigation plans and considers these appropriate.

External auditors

In assessing the auditor's independence, the committee considered guidance contained in King IV™ as well as the Independent Regulatory Board for Auditors ("IRBA") publications and the related commentary thereon.

The Board sets a policy that governs the level and nature of non-audit services, which requires pre-approval by the committee for all non-audit services. In determining the independence of the external auditors, the committee confirmed that the non-audit services for the 2026 financial year performed by and paid to BDO were approved. In addition, the committee has satisfied itself that the auditors' independence was not prejudiced by any consultancy, advisory or other work undertaken or as a result of any previous appointment as auditor.

The committee has considered the relevant audit quality indicators, including the audit firm's system of quality control. It noted that BDO was subject to a review of its quality control practices in terms of International Standard on Quality Control by the IRBA. No legal or disciplinary proceedings have been concluded against the firm in the past 10 years. The committee was satisfied with the quality of the audit concluded.

The committee is satisfied that in discharging its duties in terms of its mandate, it has reviewed and confirmed the independence of BDO, being the audit firm, as well as Ms Fayaz Mohamed, being the Group's designated auditor for the 2026 financial year, including their internal independence processes, their internal quality review processes, in addition to those conducted by IRBA, and the rotation of the Group audit partner and key component audit partners at least every five years.

Report of the audit and risk committee (continued)

Significant areas of judgement

Many areas within the financial statements that require judgement form an integral part of the financial statements. The committee has assessed the significance of the assets and liabilities on the statement of financial position and relating items that require significant judgement and the following key audit matters are highlighted:

- **Valuation of goodwill**

The Group tests annually whether goodwill has suffered any impairments, in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.1 and 1.5. The committee is satisfied that the carrying values of goodwill are fairly stated. Further details are provided in note 3.

- **Valuation of Property, Plant and Equipment**

The Group evaluates the carrying values of property, plant and equipment for impairment whenever circumstances indicate that the carrying value of such assets might not be recoverable in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.1 and 1.4. The committee is satisfied that the carrying values of these assets are fairly stated. Further details are provided in note 2.

The Group engages with internal technical experts in assessing the appropriateness of estimated useful lives in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.1. The committee agreed with the procedures followed to determine the appropriate economic useful lives that are a true reflection of the future economic use of the applicable assets. Further details are provided in note 2.

- **Valuation of investments in subsidiaries**

The Group tests annually whether investments in subsidiaries have suffered any impairments, in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.1 and 1.2. The committee is satisfied that the carrying values of these investments are fairly stated. Further details are provided in note 5.

- **Valuation of investments in associates**

The Group tests annually whether investments in associates have suffered any impairments, in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.1 and 1.2. The committee is satisfied that the carrying values of these investments are fairly stated. Further details are provided in note 37.

- **Valuation of intangible assets acquired as part of a business combination**

The Group determines the fair values of all identifiable intangible assets acquired as part of a business combination using recognised valuation techniques, in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.1 and 1.5. The committee is satisfied that the carrying values of these intangibles are fairly stated. Further details are provided in note 4.

- **Potential voting rights related to the acquisition of Bytefuse Proprietary Limited**

The group evaluated whether the potential voting rights related to an option to purchase additional equity are substantively enacted. The committee is satisfied that these voting rights are not substantively enacted as the option to purchase additional shares would not be taken up as at year end. Refer to note 37 for additional detail.

- **Business combinations and acquisition of controlled structured entities**

The group applied judgement and assumptions in determining the IFRS Accounting Standards implication of the business combination and acquisition of structured entities referred to in note 36. These judgements and assumptions included the determination of the fair value of net identifiable assets and liabilities at acquisition, identifiable intangible assets determination of the purchase price.

Expertise and experience of chief financial officer and the finance function

In terms of the JSE Listings Requirements, the committee performs an annual evaluation of the financial reporting function in the Group. The committee was satisfied that the financial reporting function had appropriate resources, skills, expertise and experience. The committee also confirmed that it is and was satisfied that Ms Kim Julies, the Group Chief Financial Officer, possesses the appropriate skills, expertise and experience to meet the responsibilities required for that position during her service as such.

Report of the audit and risk committee (continued)

Discharge of responsibilities

The committee determined that during the financial year under review it had discharged its legal and other responsibilities as governed in the Board approved charter. The Board concurred with this assessment.

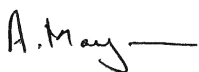
Annual report

- **Annual financial statements**

After review of the annual financial statements for the year ended 31 March 2026, the committee is of the opinion that, in all material respects, they comply with the relevant provisions of the Companies Act, the JSE Listings Requirements and IFRS Accounting Standards as issued by the International Accounting Standards Board (IASB), and fairly present the results of operations, cash flow and the financial position. On this basis, the committee recommended that the Board of directors approve the annual financial statements for the year ended 31 March 2026.

- **Integrated annual report**

The committee reviewed this report, taking cognisance of material factors and risk that may impact the integrity thereof and recommended that the Board of directors approve the integrated annual report for the year ended 31 March 2026.



A Mayman

Chairman: Audit and Risk Committee

11 June 2026

Directors' report to the shareholders

The Board herewith presents the report on the activities and financial results for the year under review:

Nature of the business

Novus Holdings Limited ("Novus Holdings" or "the Group" or "the Company") was incorporated in 2008 under the laws of the Republic of South Africa. Our principal operations are in print media, labels, flexible plastic packaging, hyperlocal community newspaper & sports publications, media supply chain management and education. These activities are conducted primarily in South Africa.

Financial review

Novus Holdings' performance for the 2026 financial year declined slightly since the previous year, with overall revenue down by 0,7% in 2026 to R4,19 billion (2025: R4,22 billion). Gross profit margin increased by 1,5% year on year.

Print, Publishing and Distribution revenue comprising 64,99% (2025: 60,45%) of total revenue increased year on year, due to the inclusion of the community newspaper portfolio (Novus Media), football publication division titled "Soccer Laduma and Kick Off" (Novus Sport) and distribution business, On the Dot for the full 12 months in the current year, with only 5 months included in the prior year.

Education revenue comprising 18,08% (2025: 21,92%) of total revenue decreased year on year due to a decrease in key customer orders, which was partly offset with increased orders from other customers. The delayed publishing of the revised foundation phase catalogue, and the resulting uncertainty, also contributed to this decrease.

Packaging revenue decreased by 5,1% from 2025 due to pricing pressure within the market and currently represents 16,67% (2025: 17,4%) of the Group's revenue.

The Other segment which comprises mainly rental income currently represents 0,25% (2025: 0,20%) of the Group's revenue. Also included in this segment, is 1 months' trading from newly acquired Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited, contributing R3,1 million revenue in the current year.

The current year included impairments of loans and receivables which amounted to R20 million, within the 'Other' segment.

The Group's associates, Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited and Bytefuse Proprietary Limited contributed equity accounted losses of R4,6 million and Mustek Limited contributed equity accounted earnings of R26,4 million during the year.

The Group made a profit after tax of R273,3 million (2025: R356 million).

The annual financial statements on pages 16 to 105 set out the financial position, results of operations, changes in equity and cash flows of the Group for the financial year ended 31 March 2026.

Share capital

The authorised share capital at 31 March 2026 was 3 000 000 000 ordinary no par value shares. Refer to note 10.

Property, plant and equipment

At 31 March 2026 the Group's investment in property, plant and equipment amounted to R803,1 million, compared with R761,0 million in the prior year. The Group impaired property, plant and equipment to the value of Rnil (2025: Rnil) in the current year. Details are reflected in note 2 of the annual financial statements. Capital commitments at 31 March 2026 amounted to R40,1 million (2025: R15,6 million). Refer to note 30.

Dividends

Dividends declared amounted to 55 cents per share in the current financial year, R174,2 million (2025: R156 million at 50 cents per share). A final dividend of 55 cents per share was approved by the Board.

Group

The name, country of incorporation and effective percentage interest of the holding company in each of the principal subsidiaries are disclosed in note 5 to the annual financial statements.

Borrowings

The Company has unlimited borrowing powers in terms of its memorandum of incorporation.

Directors' report to the shareholders (continued)

Going concern

The Board believes that the Group has adequate financial resources to continue in operation for the foreseeable future and accordingly, the annual financial statements have been prepared on a going concern basis. The directors have satisfied themselves that the Group is in a sound financial position and that it has access to sufficient borrowing facilities to meet its foreseeable cash requirements.

Events after reporting date

The Group entered into a sale agreement for its Investment Property (refer to note 38) on 17 March 2026. The property's sale was contingent to fulfilment or waiver of certain conditions which were fulfilled by 18 May 2026. The fair value of the property is considered to be R85 million based on this sale agreement.

During the prior financial year, the Group acquired more than 35% of all the issued share capital of Mustek Limited. Accordingly, the Group proceeded to make a mandatory offer on 30 May 2025, as required in terms of section 123 of the Companies Act, 71 of 2008 ("Companies Act") read with the Regulations published in terms of the Companies Act ("Takeover Regulations") to acquire all of the shares of Mustek Limited not already beneficially held by the Group, or any of its related and concert parties. The offer process has been placed on hold pending formal confirmation by the Takeover Special Committee (TSC) to increase the cash offer to R15,41 per Mustek share, up from the previous R13,00 offer.

At 31 March 2026, the Group held a 39,96% interest in Mustek Limited. Subsequent to year-end, the Group concluded two separate transactions which increased its shareholding to 50,39%. Details of the transactions were announced on SENS on 05 June 2026 and 10 June 2026, respectively.

Subsequent to the reporting date, Maskew Miller Learning (Pty) Ltd (a subsidiary of the group) initiated a comprehensive restructuring exercise affecting all staff across its operations. The restructuring programme was approved and is aimed at aligning the organisation's cost base and operating model with its strategic objectives and current market conditions. Refer to note 41.

Effective 16 April 2026, the Group entered into share subscription agreements with Forestry Systems Proprietary Limited (South Africa) and Forest Systems Ltd (Mauritius), subject to fulfilment of suspensive conditions by 15 July 2026. Upon implementation, the Group will acquire a 50,1% shareholding in each entity for a combined cash consideration of R24,5 million.

Other than the matters raised in note 41 to the Group annual financial statements, no other events occurred after the reporting date that may have a material effect on the Group's results.

Directors and auditor

The following changes took place during the period:

- Effective 01 April 2025, Ms Pitsi Mnisi has been appointed as an independent non-executive director of the Board and is a member of the Audit and Risk Committee and Social and Ethics Committee.
- Effective 01 January 2026, Craig Wright resigned as Group Chief Financial Officer and Kim Julies was appointed as Group Chief Financial Officer.
- Effective 22 May 2026, the board of directors appointed Mr Phildon Roux as an independent non-executive director of the Group.

The Board has appointed BDO South Africa Incorporated as the Group auditors for the 2026 financial year.

Directors' interests and emoluments

Particulars of the emoluments of directors and their interests in the issued share capital of the company and in contracts are disclosed in notes 15, 29 and 35 to the annual financial statements.

Signed on behalf of the Board.



A van der Veen
Chief Executive Officer

11 June 2026



K Julies
Chief Financial Officer

11 June 2026

Independent auditor's report

Report on the Audit of the Consolidated and Separate Financial Statements

Opinion

We have audited the consolidated and separate financial statements of Novus Holdings Limited and its subsidiaries ("the group and company") set out on pages 16 to 105, which comprise the consolidated and separate statements of financial position as at 31 March 2026, and the consolidated and separate statements of profit or loss, the consolidated and separate statements of changes in equity and the consolidated and separate statements of cash flows for the year then ended, and notes to the consolidated and separate financial statements, including material accounting policy information.

In our opinion, the consolidated and separate financial statements present fairly, in all material respects, the consolidated and separate financial position of Novus Holdings Limited and its subsidiaries as at 31 March 2026, and its consolidated and separate financial performance and consolidated and separate cash flows for the year then ended in accordance with IFRS Accounting Standards as issued by the International Accounting Standards Board and the requirements of the Companies Act of South Africa.

Basis for Opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (ISAs). Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Consolidated and Separate Financial Statements section of our report. We are independent of the group and company in accordance with the Independent Regulatory Board for Auditors' Code of Professional Conduct for Registered Auditors (IRBA Code) as applicable to audits of financial statements of public interest entities, and other independence requirements applicable to performing audits of financial statements in South Africa. We have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with the IRBA Code and in accordance with other ethical requirements applicable to performing audits in South Africa. The IRBA Code is consistent with the corresponding sections of the International Ethics Standards Board for Accountants' International Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (including International Independence Standards). We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

In terms of the IRBA Rule on Enhanced Auditor Reporting for the Audit of Financial Statements of Public Interest Entities, published in Government Gazette No. 49309 dated 15 September 2023 (EAR Rule), we report:

Final Materiality

	Consolidated financial statements	Separate financial statements
Final materiality	R41.50 million	R10.57 million
The benchmark used for determining materiality	The materiality was determined with reference to consolidated revenue and represents 1% of that balance.	The materiality was determined with reference to total assets and represents 1% of that balance.
Rationale for the benchmark applied	In considering the users of the consolidated financial statements and given the fact that the group is a profit-orientated listed entity, consolidated profit before taxation would ordinarily be considered as the benchmark. However, due to fluctuations in that benchmark over the past few years, consolidated revenue was considered more stable and therefore the most appropriate benchmark.	In considering the users of the separate financial statements and given the fact that the company operates primarily as a holding company for the group, total assets was determined as the appropriate benchmark.

Independent auditor's report (continued)

Group Audit Scope

We tailored the scope of our audit in order to perform sufficient work to enable us to provide an opinion on the consolidated financial statements as a whole, taking into account the structure of the group, the accounting processes and controls, and the industry in which the group operates. The group consists of 8 components.

Full scope audits were performed on 6 components. For an additional 2 components, we performed audit procedures in respect of certain specific account balances, sufficient to address the risk of material misstatement at a consolidated financial statement level.

In establishing the overall approach to the group audit, we determined the extent of the work that needed to be performed by us, as the group engagement team, and by component auditors operating under our instruction, in order to express our audit opinion on the consolidated financial statements of the group.

Where the work was performed by component auditors, we determined the level of our involvement necessary in the audit work at those components to be able to conclude whether sufficient appropriate audit evidence has been obtained to support our opinion on the consolidated financial statements. Further audit procedures were performed by us as the group engagement team in respect of the consolidation process.

The work performed by component auditors, together with additional procedures performed at the group level, provided us with sufficient appropriate audit evidence to express an opinion on the group's consolidated financial statements as a whole.

Key Audit Matters

Key audit matters are those matters that, in our professional judgement, were of most significance in our audit of the consolidated and separate financial statements of the current period. These matters were addressed in the context of our audit of the consolidated financial statements as a whole, and in forming our opinion thereon, and we do not provide a separate opinion on these matters. We have determined that there are no key audit matters in respect of the separate financial statements to communicate in our report.

In terms of the EAR Rule, we are required to report the outcome of audit procedures or key observations with respect to the key audit matters and these are included below.

Independent auditor's report (continued)

Key audit matter

Assessment of impairment of intangible asset (consolidated financial statements)

The group recognised an intangible asset with an indefinite useful life, namely Brands, on the acquisition of Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited in a prior year. The carrying value of this intangible asset amounted to R93,4 million as at 31 March 2026.

Refer to notes 1.1(i), 1.5 and 4 to the consolidated financial statements for disclosure regarding this intangible asset.

An indicator of impairment existed at year-end due to a revision in the educational curriculum which could impact the key inputs to the Cash generating unit (CGU) supporting this intangible asset.

Management determined the recoverable amount of the CGU to which this intangible asset is allocated by calculating the CGU's value-in-use.

This required management to make subjective judgements concerning the cash flows, growth rates and discount rates of the CGU.

A discounted cash flow calculation was used to determine the recoverable amount of the CGU. The calculation was based on three years budgeted and two years' forecasted information using the long-term average industry growth.

We considered the impairment assessment of this intangible asset to be a matter of most significance to our current year audit of the consolidated financial statements, due to the degree of estimation uncertainty and the judgement applied by management, as well as the magnitude of this balance.

How our audit addressed the key audit matter

Our audit procedures included:

Through discussion with management, we obtained an understanding of the approach followed in assessing the recoverable amount of the intangible asset.

We evaluated the design and implementation of relevant controls surrounding the assessment of impairment of the intangible asset.

We evaluated the valuation methodology used by management in determining the recoverable amount and considered whether the value-in-use of the cash generating unit (CGU) was appropriate and consistent with the requirements of IAS 36 Impairment of Assets. We did not note any inconsistencies in this regard.

We obtained the value-in-use model and performed the following procedures:

- a. We assessed the mathematical accuracy of the model by casting and cross casting the supporting computation;
- b. We utilised our internal valuations expertise to evaluate the key assumptions applied by management which included:
 - i. The weighted average cost of capital rates and
 - ii. The growth rates applied

Based on the results of our assessment, we accepted the key assumptions used by management.

- c. We assessed management's forecasted future cash flows against historical performance and agreed the forecasted information to management's approved budgets. The key assumptions applied by management included:
 - i. Earnings before interest, tax and depreciation;
 - ii. capital expenditure requirements;
 - iii. working capital requirements; and
 - iv. pre-tax cash outflows.

Based on the results of our assessment, we accepted the key assumptions used by management.

We performed independent sensitivity calculations on the impairment assessment to assess the impact of changes to the key assumptions on the available headroom.

We recalculated and compared the carrying amount of the CGU to the recoverable amount based on management's determined value-in-use.

We evaluated the appropriateness of the disclosures in the consolidated financial statements against the requirements of IFRS Accounting Standards.

Independent auditor's report (continued)

Other Information

The directors are responsible for the other information. The other information comprises the information included in the document titled "Novus Holdings Limited and its subsidiaries Annual financial statements for the year ended 31 March 2026" which includes the Certificate by the Company Secretary, the Report of the Audit and Risk Committee and the Directors' report to the shareholders as required by the Companies Act of South Africa, which we obtained prior to the date of this report, and the 2026 Integrated Annual Report, which is expected to be made available to us after that date. The other information does not include the consolidated and separate financial statements and our auditor's report thereon.

Our opinion on the consolidated and separate financial statements does not cover the other information and we do not and will not express an audit opinion or any form of assurance conclusion thereon.

In connection with our audit of the consolidated and separate financial statements, our responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the consolidated and separate financial statements, or our knowledge obtained in the audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If, based on the work we have performed on the other information obtained prior to the date of this auditor's report, we conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, we are required to report that fact. We have nothing to report in this regard.

Responsibilities of the Directors for the Consolidated and Separate Financial Statements

The directors are responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of the consolidated and separate financial statements in accordance with IFRS Accounting Standards as issued by the International Accounting Standards Board and the requirements of the Companies Act of South Africa, and for such internal control as the directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of consolidated and separate financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the consolidated and separate financial statements, the directors are responsible for assessing the group and the company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the directors either intend to liquidate the group and/or the company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Consolidated and Separate Financial Statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the consolidated and separate financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these consolidated and separate financial statements.

As part of an audit in accordance with ISAs, we exercise professional judgement and maintain professional scepticism throughout the audit. We also:

- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the consolidated and separate financial statements, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than for one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control.
- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the group and the company's internal control.
- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates and related disclosures made by the directors.

Independent auditor's report (continued)

- Conclude on the appropriateness of the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting and based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the group and the company's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in our auditor's report to the related disclosures in the consolidated and separate financial statements or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify our opinion. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our auditor's report. However, future events or conditions may cause the group and the company to cease to continue as a going concern.
- Evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the consolidated and separate financial statements, including the disclosures, and whether the consolidated and separate financial statements represent the underlying transactions and events in a manner that achieves fair presentation.
- Plan and perform the group audit to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence regarding the financial information of the entities or business units within the group as a basis for forming an opinion on the consolidated financial statements. We are responsible for the direction, supervision and review of the audit work performed for the purposes of the group audit. We remain solely responsible for our audit opinion.

We communicate with the directors regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that we identify during our audit.

We also provide the directors with a statement that we have complied with relevant ethical requirements regarding independence, and to communicate with them all relationships and other matters that may reasonably be thought to bear on our independence, and where applicable, actions taken to eliminate threats or safeguards applied.

From the matters communicated with the directors, we determine those matters that were of most significance in the audit of the consolidated and separate financial statements of the current period and are therefore the key audit matters. We describe these matters in our auditor's report unless law or regulation precludes public disclosure about the matter or when, in extremely rare circumstances, we determine that a matter should not be communicated in our report because the adverse consequences of doing so would reasonably be expected to outweigh the public interest benefits of such communication.

Report on Other Legal and Regulatory Requirements

Audit Tenure

In terms of the IRBA Rule published in Government Gazette No. 39475 dated 4 December 2015, we report that BDO South Africa Incorporated has been the auditor of Novus Holdings Limited for three years.

BDO South Africa Inc.

BDO South Africa Incorporated

Registered Auditors

Fayaz Mohamed

Director

Registered Auditor

12 June 2026

123 Hertzog Boulevard
Foreshore
Cape Town, 8001

Statement of financial position

as at 31 March 2026

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
ASSETS					
Non-current assets		1 572 620	1 563 246	1 057 618	1 057 618
Property, plant and equipment	2	803 158	760 874	—	—
Investment property	38	57 019	58 785	—	—
Goodwill	3	87 823	87 823	—	—
Other intangible assets	4	179 832	260 005	—	—
Investments in subsidiaries	5	—	—	1 057 618	1 057 618
Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income		3 005	3 019	—	—
Investment in associates	37	366 526	307 995	—	—
Post retirement medical plan asset	12.1	10 928	11 107	—	—
Other financial assets at amortised cost		2 421	3 434	—	—
Deferred taxation asset	6	61 908	70 204	—	—
Current assets		2 347 554	2 434 985	164	129
Inventory	7	507 024	556 569	—	—
Intangible assets - product development	4	18 373	24 661	—	—
Trade and other receivables	8	733 420	967 962	—	—
Related party receivables	29	—	18 571	—	—
Contract assets	8.1	29 124	31 276	—	—
Current income tax receivable	27	—	3 348	—	—
Derivative financial instruments	31	5 252	—	—	—
Other financial assets at amortised cost		1 013	1 311	—	—
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss	39	36 208	19 033	—	—
Cash and cash equivalents	9	1 017 140	812 254	164	129
Total Assets		3 920 174	3 998 231	1 057 782	1 057 747
EQUITY					
Capital and reserves attributable to the Group's equity holders		2 510 295	2 414 377	971 588	986 144
Share capital	10	485 708	485 708	539 925	539 925
Treasury shares	10	(292 393)	(303 378)	(261 772)	(268 620)
Other reserves	11	(124 973)	(118 954)	—	—
Retained earnings		2 441 953	2 351 001	693 435	714 839
Non-controlling interest	40	53 639	14 562	—	—
Total Equity		2 563 934	2 428 940	971 588	986 144
LIABILITIES					
Non-current liabilities		381 353	393 774	—	—
Post-employment medical liability	12	40 933	37 035	—	—
Provisions	13	16 587	15 173	—	—
Borrowings and lease liabilities	14	289 000	275 681	—	—
Deferred taxation liabilities	6	33 168	63 719	—	—
Deferred grant income	17	1 665	2 166	—	—
Current liabilities		974 887	1 175 518	86 194	71 603
Post-employment medical liability	12	2 246	1 856	—	—
Current portion of borrowings and lease liabilities	14	89 931	182 734	—	—
Trade and other payables	16	881 623	990 427	400	400
Related party payables	29	—	—	85 794	71 203
Current income tax payable	27	586	—	—	—
Deferred grant income	17	501	501	—	—
Total Equity and Liabilities		3 920 174	3 998 231	1 057 782	1 057 747

Statement of profit or loss

for the year ended 31 March 2026

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Revenue	18	4 194 863	4 222 345	174 200	156 700
Cost of sales	20	(2 813 796)	(2 895 529)	—	—
Gross profit		1 381 067	1 326 816	174 200	156 700
Operating expenses	20	(1 021 979)	(932 344)	—	—
Administrative and other expenses		(1 003 777)	(883 398)	—	—
Net impairment losses on financial assets	8	(18 202)	(48 946)	—	—
Other gains/(losses)	19	(16 175)	27 234	—	—
Operating profit		342 913	421 706	174 200	156 700
Finance income	21	56 006	59 522	—	—
Finance costs	22	(53 026)	(51 436)	(5)	(13)
Share of net (losses)/profit of associates accounted for using the equity method	37	21 808	(17 360)	—	—
Net gain on investment in associate	37	—	51 192	—	—
Profit before taxation		367 701	463 624	174 195	156 687
Taxation	23	(94 435)	(107 564)	—	—
Net profit for the year		273 266	356 060	174 195	156 687
Attributable to:					
Equity holders of the Group		266 119	347 971	174 195	156 687
Non-controlling interest	40	7 147	8 089	—	—
		273 266	356 060	174 195	156 687
Earnings per share (cents):					
Basic	24	84,12	110,88	—	—
Diluted	24	75,92	102,70	—	—

Statements of comprehensive income

for the year ended 31 March 2026

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Net profit for the year		273 266	356 060	174 195	156 687
Other comprehensive income/(loss)					
Hedging reserve	11	(160)	—	—	—
Foreign exchange movement, gross		(219)	—	—	—
Foreign exchange movement, tax portion		59	—	—	—
Fair value reserve		(12)	(7)	—	—
Net fair value losses gross		(16)	(10)	—	—
Net fair value losses, tax portion		4	3	—	—
Post-employment benefit obligations and provisions	12,13	(806)	228	—	—
Remeasurement of post-employment benefit obligations and provisions, gross		(1 104)	313	—	—
Remeasurement of post-employment benefit obligations and provisions, tax portion		298	(85)	—	—
Total other comprehensive (loss)/income, net of tax		(977)	221	—	—
Total comprehensive income for the year		272 288	356 281	174 195	156 687
Attributable to:					
Equity holders of the Group		265 141	348 192	174 195	156 687
Non-controlling interest		7 147	8 089	—	—
		272 288	356 281	174 195	156 687

Statement of changes in equity

for the year ended 31 March 2026

Group	Notes	Share capital and premium R'000	Treasury shares R'000	Existing control business combination reserve R'000	Share-based compensation reserve R'000	Hedging reserve R'000	Actuarial reserve R'000	Fair Value through OCI reserve R'000	Total other reserves R'000	Retained earnings R'000	Attributable to equity holders of the Group R'000	Non controlling interest R'000	Total equity R'000
Balance as at 01 April 2024		449 199	(331 385)	(129 154)	13 355	746	3 385	7	(111 661)	2 205 596	2 211 749	33 976	2 245 725
Total comprehensive income for the year		—	—	—	—	—	229	(7)	221	347 971	348 193	8 089	356 281
Profit for the year		—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	347 971	347 971	8 089	356 059
Other comprehensive income		—	—	—	—	—	229	(7)	221	—	221	—	221
Transactions with owners:													
Share based compensation expense		—	—	—	483	—	—	—	483	—	483	—	483
Share awards vested and issued	11	—	17 021	—	(1 281)	—	—	—	(1 281)	(15 740)	—	—	—
Reallocation in respect of prior year awards vested and issued*		36 509	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	(36 509)	—	—	—
Transferred as purchase consideration	11.0	—	10 986	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	10 986	—	10 986
Share awards lapsed and expired	11	—	—	—	(6 716)	—	—	—	(6 716)	6 716	—	—	—
Dividends paid	28.2	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	(157 034)	(157 034)	(27 502)	(184 536)
Total transactions with owners		36 509	28 007	—	(7 514)	—	—	—	(7 514)	(202 567)	(145 565)	(27 502)	(173 067)
Balance as at 01 April 2025		485 708	(303 378)	(129 154)	5 841	746	3 614	—	(118 954)	2 351 000	2 414 377	14 563	2 428 939
Total comprehensive income for the year		—	—	—	—	(160)	(806)	(12)	(977)	266 119	265 141	7 147	272 288
Profit for the year		—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	266 119	266 119	7 147	273 266
Other comprehensive loss		—	—	—	—	(160)	(806)	(12)	(977)	—	(977)	—	(977)
Reclassification adjustment to inventory, gross	11	—	—	—	—	1 093	—	—	1 093	—	1 093	—	1 093
Reclassification adjustment to inventory, tax portion	11	—	—	—	—	(295)	—	—	(295)	—	(295)	—	(295)
Transactions with owners:													
Acquisition of controlled structures		—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	40 534	40 534
Share awards vested and issued		—	6 848	—	(721)	—	—	—	(721)	(6 127)	—	—	—
Transferred as purchase consideration	37	—	6 604	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	6 604	—	6 604
Purchase of shares	11	—	(2 466)	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	(2 466)	—	(2 466)
Share awards lapsed and expired		—	—	—	(5 120)	—	—	—	(5 120)	5 120	—	—	—
Acquisition of minorities		—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	5 266	5 266
Dividends paid	28.2	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	(174 160)	(174 160)	(13 870)	(188 030)
Total transactions with owners		—	10 986	—	(5 841)	—	—	—	(5 841)	(175 167)	(170 022)	31 930	(138 092)
Balance as at 31 March 2026		485 708	(292 392)	(129 154)	—	1 384	2 808	(12)	(124 974)	2 441 953	2 510 295	53 639	2 563 934
Notes		10	10	11	11	11	11	11	11			40	

* This is a reallocation between reserves related to historical share awards that vested and were issued, which were previously accounted for in share capital when the treasury shares were issued to employees

Statement of changes in equity

for the year ended 31 March 2026

Company	Notes	Share capital R'000	Treasury shares R'000	Retained earnings R'000	Total R'000
Balance as at 1 April 2024		503 416	(285 641)	783 273	1 001 048
Total comprehensive income for the year		—	—	156 687	156 687
Profit for the year		—	—	156 687	156 687
Transactions with owners:					
Dividends paid	28.2	—	—	(171 591)	(171 591)
Share awards vested and issued	10	—	17 021	(17 021)	—
Reallocation in respect of prior year awards vested and issued		36 509	—	(36 509)	—
Balance as at 1 April 2025		539 925	(268 620)	714 839	986 144
Total comprehensive income for the year		—	—	174 195	174 195
Profit for the year		—	—	174 195	174 195
Share issue expenses		—	—	—	—
Transactions with owners:					
Dividends paid	28.2	—	—	(188 751)	(188 751)
Share awards vested and issued	10	—	6 848	(6 848)	—
Reallocation in respect of prior year awards vested and issued*		—	—	—	—
Balance as at 31 March 2026		539 925	(261 772)	693 435	971 588
Notes		10	10		

* This is a reallocation between reserves related to historical share awards that vested and were issued, which were previously accounted for in share capital when the treasury shares were issued to employees.

Statements of cash flows

for the year ended 31 March 2026

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Cash generated from operating activities					
Cash generated from operations	26	739 947	558 570	—	—
Finance income received	21	56 006	59 522	—	—
Finance costs paid	22	—	—	(5)	(13)
Dividends received		—	—	174 200	156 700
Taxation paid	27	(113 371)	(121 807)	—	—
Net cash inflow from operating activities		682 582	496 285	174 195	156 687
Cash flows from investing activities					
Property, plant and equipment acquired	2	(120 616)	(56 893)	—	—
Proceeds from sale of property, plant and equipment		502	932	—	—
(Purchases of)/Proceeds from other investments and loans		(5 670)	6 611	—	—
Purchase of intangible assets	4	(14 972)	(5 169)	—	—
Financial assets at amortised cost repaid		—	1 759	—	—
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss acquired	39	(17 175)	(5 355)	—	—
Related party loans advanced	29	(1 424)	(3 822)	—	—
Acquisition of investment in associates	37	(26 866)	(251 243)	—	—
Acquisition of business/subsidiary	36	44 232	(16 121)	—	—
Net cash outflow from investing activities		(141 989)	(329 301)	—	—
Cash flows from financing activities					
Proceeds from borrowings	14	429 000	435 000	—	—
Repayment of borrowings	14	(499 865)	(405 889)	—	—
Principal portion of lease liabilities	14	(14 473)	(12 291)	—	—
Interest portion of lease liabilities	14	(2 625)	(2 579)	—	—
Finance costs paid	22	(57 247)	(55 804)	—	—
Dividends paid to company's shareholders	28.2	(174 160)	(157 034)	(174 160)	(157 034)
Dividends paid to non-controlling interests in subsidiaries	40	(13 870)	(27 502)	—	—
Payments for shares bought back	10	(2 466)	—	—	—
Net cash outflow from financing activities		(335 706)	(226 099)	(174 160)	(157 034)
Net increase/(decrease) in cash and cash equivalents		204 887	(59 114)	35	(347)
Cash and cash equivalents at beginning of the year		812 254	871 368	129	476
Cash and cash equivalents at end of the year	9	1 017 140	812 254	164	129

Notes to the annual financial statements

for the year ended 31 March 2026

ACCOUNTING POLICIES

The material accounting policies applied in the preparation of these annual financial statements are set out below. These policies have been consistently applied to all the years presented, unless otherwise stated.

1. BASIS OF PREPARATION

The annual consolidated and separate financial statements of Novus Holdings Limited have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the JSE Limited Listings Requirements ("Listings Requirements") and the South African Companies Act, 2008 (Act No 71 of 2008), as amended, ("Companies Act"). The Listings Requirements require the financial statements to be prepared in accordance with the framework concepts, the measurement and recognition requirements of IFRS Accounting Standards as issued by the International Accounting Standards Board (IFRS Accounting Standards). The financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost convention, as modified by the revaluation of Contracts for differences ("CFDs") and derivatives in notes 31 and 39 at fair value through profit or loss or fair value less costs to sell.

The preparation of financial statements in conformity with IFRS Accounting Standards requires the use of certain critical accounting estimates. It also requires management to exercise its judgement in the process of applying the Group's accounting policies. The areas involving a higher degree of judgement or complexity, or areas where assumptions and estimates are significant to the consolidated financial statements are disclosed in note 1.1.

These financial statements incorporate accounting policies that have been consistently applied to all years presented, with the exception of the implementation of the following standards, interpretations and amendments to published standards that became effective and were adopted by the Group during the current financial year:

Standard/Interpretation	Effective date: Years beginning on or after
Lack of exchangeability (Amendments to IAS 21)	01 January 2025

The amendments impact entities that have transactions or operations in a foreign currency that are not exchangeable into another currency at a measurement date for a specified purpose. A currency is exchangeable when there is an ability to obtain the other currency (with a normal administrative delay), and the transaction would take place through a market or exchange mechanism that creates enforceable rights and obligations. The Group is not conducting transactions in jurisdictions that currently have lack of exchangeability. Accordingly, it has been assessed that these amendments do not have an impact on the Group.

Standards, interpretations and amendments to published standards which are not yet effective

Management considered all new accounting standards, interpretations and amendments to IFRS Accounting Standards that were issued prior to 31 March 2026, but not yet effective on that date. These standards are not expected to have a material impact on the entity in the current or future reporting periods.

Standard/Interpretation	Effective date: Years beginning on or after
Classification and Measurement of Financial Instruments (Amendments to IFRS 9 & IFRS 7)	01 January 2026
Contracts referencing nature-dependent electricity (Amendments to IFRS 9 and IFRS 7)	01 January 2026
Annual Improvements to IFRS Accounting Standards (Volume 11)	01 January 2026
IFRS 18 Presentation and Disclosure in Financial Statements	01 January 2027

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1. BASIS OF PREPARATION (continued)

Under IFRS 18, effective from 01 January 2027, the presentation of results on the statement of comprehensive income as well as the notes to the financial statements will change. There is a requirement to restate comparatives, however the group's profit for the year will not change. Presentational changes include the disclosure of certain "non-IFRS Accounting Standards" measures – management performance measures (MPMs) which will form part of the audited financial statements – as well as guidance on aggregation and disaggregation of subtotals and line items in the primary financial statements. The Group is in the process of assessing the impact of the amendments, particularly with respect to the collation of additional information needed to meet the new disclosure requirements.

The Group does not expect other amendments to standards issued by the IASB, but not yet effective, to have a material impact on the Group.

1.1 Critical accounting estimates and assumptions

The Group makes estimates and assumptions concerning the future and these accounting estimates are an integral part of the preparation of financial statements. The resulting accounting estimates will, by definition, seldom equal the related actual results. The estimates and assumptions that have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities within the next financial year are as follows:

a) Estimated impairment of goodwill

The Group tests annually whether goodwill is impaired, in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.5. The recoverable amounts of cash-generating units are determined as being the higher of the value-in-use or fair value less costs to sell. Calculation of these amounts requires the use of estimates. Further details are provided in note 3.

b) Property, plant and equipment

The estimated useful economic lives of property, plant and equipment are based on management's judgement and experience. Management engages with internal technical experts in assessing the appropriateness of estimated useful lives and recoverable amounts of property, plant and equipment. When management identifies that actual useful economic lives differ materially from the estimates used to calculate depreciation, that charge is adjusted prospectively. Due to the significance of property, plant and equipment investment to the Group, variations between actual and estimated useful economic lives could impact operating results both positively and negatively, although historically few changes to estimated useful economic lives have been required.

The Group is required to evaluate the carrying values of property, plant and equipment for impairment whenever circumstances indicate, in management's judgement, that the carrying value of such assets may not be recoverable. The recoverable amounts of the CGUs to which plant and machinery are allocated are determined by calculating the higher of the CGUs' fair value less costs to sell or value-in-use. This requires management to make subjective judgements concerning the cash flows, growth rates and discount rates of the CGUs. Refer to note 2 for further details.

c) Expected credit loss allowance on trade and other receivables

At each reporting date, the company and each of its subsidiaries evaluate the recoverability of trade and other receivables and record allowances for expected credit losses based on the Expected Credit Loss ("ECL") model. These allowances are measured through calculating the historical loss rates based on the payment profiles of sales over actual credit losses experienced. The historical rates are adjusted to reflect current and forward-looking information on macroeconomic factors such as tough trading conditions due to inflation and consumer behaviour affecting the ability of the customers to settle their debt.

The actual level of receivables collected may differ from the estimated levels of recovery, which could impact operating results positively or negatively.

Refer to note 8 where information is provided on historical loss rates calculated and the forward-looking rates it was adjusted with to determine the expected credit loss allowance on trade and other receivables.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.1 Critical accounting estimates and assumptions (continued)

d) Estimated impairment of investments in subsidiaries and associates

The Group tests annually whether investments in subsidiaries have suffered any impairment, in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.2. The recoverable amounts of these investments are determined based on value-in-use calculations applicable to the cash generating units which operate in these subsidiaries. These calculations require the use of estimates. Refer to notes 3 and 5 for further details on investment in subsidiaries. Refer to note 37 for further details on investment in associates.

e) Deferred tax asset

Deferred tax assets include an amount of R73 million (2025: R78,4 million) which relates to tax losses carried forward. This is considered a significant estimate. Refer to note 6 for further details.

f) Leases

When the entity has the option to extend the lease, management uses its judgement to determine whether or not an option would be reasonably certain to be exercised. Management includes all facts or circumstances available to determine the lease term. These facts and circumstances include the location of warehouses and office spaces, the likelihood of changing locations of operations and whether the Group would be able to replace machinery and office equipment without significant cost or business interruption.

As at 31 March 2026, all lease extension options had been taken into account in the lease liability.

g) Impairment of inventories

The recoverability of inventories is based upon a detailed line-by-line management review of the Group's inventory items at various stages of the financial year. Information considered in the impairment review include the age complement of the inventory on hand (i.e., when the first and last product was receipted into inventory) including the sales that have occurred during the past year. Other factors considered in the review would ordinarily include the likelihood of future publications of each title, the inter relationship between inventories, product development assets and author cost impairments.

h) Impairment of intangible assets for product development and author costs

Intangible assets not yet available for use are tested for impairment when an indication of impairment exists, and at least annually, irrespective of indicators. Author costs are recovered as and when the related royalties are earned by contractual set off against the royalties due to an author.

i) Estimated impairment of intangible assets

Intangible assets with an indefinite useful life relate to brands within the education segment. The Group tests annually whether indefinite useful life assets are impaired, in accordance with the accounting policy stated in note 1.5. The recoverable amounts of cash-generating units are determined as being the higher of the value-in-use or fair value less costs to sell. Calculation of these amounts requires the use of estimates. Further details are provided in note 4.

Intangible assets with a definite useful life are tested for impairment when there are indicators of impairment identified. The recoverable amounts of cash-generating units are determined as being the higher of the value-in-use or fair value less costs to sell. Calculation of these amounts requires the use of estimates. Further details are provided in note 4.

j) Potential voting rights related to the acquisition of Bytefuse Proprietary Limited

The group evaluated whether the potential voting rights related to an option to purchase additional equity are substantively enacted. The committee is satisfied that these voting rights are not substantively enacted as the option to purchase additional shares would not be taken up as at year end and prior to its expiry, post year end, on 01 May 2026. Refer to note 37 for additional detail.

k) Business combinations

The group applied judgement and assumptions in determining the IFRS Accounting Standards implication of the business combination referred to in note 36. These judgements and assumptions included the determination of the fair value of net identifiable assets and liabilities at acquisition, identifiable intangible assets and the determination of the purchase price.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.2 Basis of consolidation

Subsidiaries

Subsidiaries are all entities (including structured entities) over which the Group has control. The Group controls an entity when the Group is exposed to, or has rights to, variable returns from its involvement with the entity and has the ability to affect those returns through its power over the entity. Subsidiaries are fully consolidated from the date on which control is transferred to the Group. They are deconsolidated from the date that control ceases.

The Group applies the acquisition method to account for business combinations. The consideration transferred for the acquisition of a subsidiary is the fair values of the assets transferred, the liabilities incurred to the former owners of the acquiree and the equity interests issued by the Group. The consideration transferred includes the fair value of any asset or liability resulting from a contingent consideration arrangement. Acquisition-related costs are expensed as incurred. The identifiable assets and liabilities acquired, including contingent liabilities assumed in a business combination are measured initially at their fair values at the acquisition date. The Group recognises any non-controlling interest in the acquiree on an acquisition-by-acquisition basis, either at fair value or at the non-controlling interest's proportionate share of the recognised amounts of the acquiree's identifiable net assets.

If the business combination is achieved in stages, the acquisition date carrying value of the acquirer's previously held equity interest in the acquiree is remeasured to fair value at the acquisition date. Any gains or losses arising from such remeasurement are recognised in profit or loss.

The excess of the consideration transferred, the amount of any non-controlling interest in the acquiree and the acquisition-date fair value of any previous equity interest in the acquiree over the fair value of the identifiable net assets acquired is recorded as goodwill. If the total of consideration transferred, non-controlling interest recognised and previously held interest measured is less than the fair value of the net assets of the subsidiary acquired in the case of a bargain purchase, the difference is recognised directly in the income statement.

Intercompany transactions, balances and unrealised gains on transactions between Group companies are eliminated. Unrealised losses are also eliminated unless the transaction provides evidence of the impairment of the transferred asset. When necessary, amounts reported by subsidiaries have been adjusted to conform with the Group's accounting policies.

Associates

Associates are all entities over which the group has significant influence but not control or joint control. This is generally the case where the Group holds between 20% and 50% of the voting rights. Investments in associates are accounted for using the equity method.

The investment in associate is initially recognised at cost and adjusted thereafter to recognise the Group's share of the post-acquisition profits or losses of the associate in profit or loss, and the Group's share of movements in other comprehensive income of the associate in other comprehensive income. Dividends received or receivable from associates are recognised as a reduction in the carrying amount of the investment.

Where the Group's share of losses in an equity-accounted investment equals or exceeds its interest in the entity, no further losses are recognised.

Unrealised gains on transactions between the Group and its investment in associates are eliminated to the extent of the Group's interest in these entities. Unrealised losses are also eliminated unless the transaction provides evidence of an impairment of the asset transferred. Accounting policies of investment in associates have been changed where necessary to ensure consistency with the policies adopted by the Group.

The carrying amount of investment in associates is tested for impairment when there is an indicator of impairment. An impairment loss is recognised for the amount by which the investment's carrying amount exceeds its recoverable amount. The recoverable amount is the higher of an investment's fair value less costs of disposal and value-in-use.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.2 Basis of consolidation (continued)

Investment in subsidiaries

The investments of Novus Holdings Limited in the ordinary shares of its subsidiaries are carried at cost less impairment losses in the separate financial statements.

Non-controlling interests in the results and equity of subsidiaries are shown separately in the consolidated income statement, statement of comprehensive income, statement of changes in equity and statement of financial position.

Common control transactions

Business combinations in which all of the combining entities or businesses are ultimately controlled by the same party or parties both before and after the business combination (and where that control is not transitory) are referred to as common control transactions. The accounting policy for the acquiring entity is to account for the transaction at book value (predecessor values) in its consolidated financial statements. The book value of the acquired entity is the consolidated book value as reflected in the consolidated financial statements at the highest level of common control. The excess of the cost of the transaction over the acquirer's proportionate share of the net asset value acquired is allocated to the "existing control business combination reserve" in equity. Where comparative periods are presented, the financial statements and financial information presented are not restated.

Changes in ownership interests in subsidiaries without change of control

The Group treats transactions with non-controlling interests that do not result in loss of control as transactions with equity owners of the Group. A change in ownership interest results in an adjustment between the carrying amounts of the controlling and non-controlling interests to reflect their relative interests in the subsidiary. Any difference between the amount of the adjustment to non-controlling interests and any consideration paid or received is recognised within the "existing control business combination reserve" in equity.

Disposal of subsidiaries

When the Group ceases to have control, any retained interest in the entity is remeasured to its fair value at the date when control is lost, with the change in carrying amount recognised in profit or loss. The fair value becomes the initial carrying amount for the purposes of subsequently accounting for the retained interest as an associate, joint venture or financial asset. In addition, any amounts previously recognised in other comprehensive income in respect of that entity are accounted for as if the Group had directly disposed of the related assets or liabilities. This may mean that amounts previously recognised in other comprehensive income are reclassified to profit or loss.

1.3 Segment reporting

Operating segments are reported in a manner consistent with the internal reporting provided to the chief operating decision-maker. The chief operating decision-maker, who is responsible for allocating resources and assessing performance of the operating segments, has been identified as the executive committee, which includes the CEO and CFO and other members of the executive management team that makes strategic decisions.

1.4 Property, plant and equipment

Property, plant and equipment are stated at cost, being the purchase cost plus any cost to prepare the assets for their intended use, less accumulated depreciation and any accumulated impairment losses. Cost includes transfers from equity of any gains/losses on qualifying cash flow hedges relating to foreign currency property, plant and equipment acquisitions. Property, plant and equipment, with the exception of land, are depreciated in equal annual amounts over each asset's estimated useful life to their residual values. Land is not depreciated as it is deemed to have an indefinite life.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.4 Property, plant and equipment (continued)

Depreciation periods vary in accordance with the conditions in the relevant industries, but are subject to the following range of useful lives:

Item	Average useful life
Buildings	8 - 50 years
Plant and machinery	3 - 25 years
Furniture and fixtures	3 - 10 years
Motor vehicles	4 - 5 years
Office equipment	1 - 10 years
IT equipment	2 - 5 years

The Group applies the component approach whereby parts of some items of property, plant and equipment may require replacement at regular intervals. The carrying amount of an item of property, plant and equipment will include the cost of replacing the part of such an item when that cost is incurred, if it is probable that future economic benefits will flow to the Group and the cost can be reliably measured. The carrying amount of those parts that are replaced is derecognised on disposal or when it is withdrawn from use and no future economic benefits are expected from its disposal. Each part of an item of property, plant and equipment with a cost that is significant in relation to the total cost of the item is depreciated separately.

Major leasehold improvements are amortised over the shorter of their respective lease periods and estimated useful economic lives.

Subsequent costs are included in the asset's carrying amount or recognised as a separate asset, as appropriate, only when it is probable that future economic benefits associated with the item will flow to the Group and the cost of the item can be measured reliably. All other repairs and maintenance are charged to profit or loss during the financial period in which they are incurred. The cost of major renovations is included in the carrying amount of the asset when it is probable that future economic benefits will flow to the Group and the cost can be reliably measured. Major renovations are depreciated over the remaining useful economic life of the related asset.

Items of property, plant and equipment are reviewed for indicators of impairment at least annually. Where indicators of impairment are identified, the carrying values of property, plant and equipment are reviewed to assess whether or not the recoverable amount has declined below the carrying amount. In the event that the recoverable amount of the asset is lower than its carrying amount, the carrying amount is reduced and the reduction is charged to profit or loss.

The assets' residual values and useful lives are reviewed, and adjusted if appropriate, at the end of each reporting period. An asset's carrying amount is written down immediately to its recoverable amount if the asset's carrying amount is greater than its estimated recoverable amount.

Gains and losses on disposals are determined by comparing the proceeds with the carrying amount and are recognised within 'Other gains / (losses)' in profit or loss.

Work in progress is defined as assets still in the construction phase and not yet available for use. These assets are carried at initial cost and are not depreciated. Depreciation on these assets commences when they become available for use and depreciation periods are based on management's assessment of their useful lives.

1.5 Intangible assets

Goodwill

Goodwill is initially measured at cost, being an amount representing the excess of the consideration transferred, the amount of any non-controlling interests in the acquiree and the acquisition-date fair value of any previously held equity interest over the fair value of the identifiable assets acquired and liabilities assumed. If this consideration is lower than the fair value of the net assets of the acquiree (a bargain purchase), the difference is recognised in profit or loss.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.5 Intangible assets (continued)

Goodwill arising on acquisition of subsidiaries is included in "goodwill" in the statement of financial position. Goodwill is not amortised, but it is tested for impairment annually or more frequently if events or changes in circumstances indicate that it might be impaired, and is carried at cost less accumulated impairment losses. Impairment losses on goodwill are not reversed. Gains and losses on the disposal of an entity include the carrying amount of goodwill relating to the entity sold.

Goodwill is allocated to cash-generating units for the purpose of impairment testing. The allocation is made to those cash-generating units or groups of cash-generating units that are expected to benefit from the business combination in which the goodwill arose. The units or groups of units are identified at the lowest level at which goodwill is monitored for internal management purposes. An impairment test is performed by assessing the recoverable amount of the cash-generating unit to which the goodwill relates. Where the recoverable amount of the cash-generating unit is less than the carrying amount, an impairment loss is recognised.

Acquired intangible assets

Separately acquired intangible assets include trademarks, licences, customer lists and relationships, trademarks and brands, publishing rights, content and technology and are shown at historical cost. Those intangible assets acquired in a business combination are recognised at fair value at the acquisition date. The definite useful life intangibles are carried at cost less accumulated amortisation. Amortisation is calculated using the straight-line method to allocate the cost of intangible assets over their estimated useful lives of two to twenty years. Brands within the education segment are classified as indefinite useful life assets which are tested annually for impairment. Brands within the publishing segment is being amortised over their estimated useful lives of 8 to 10 years.

Acquired computer software licences are capitalised on the basis of the costs incurred to acquire and bring to use the specific software. These costs are amortised over their estimated useful lives of two to five years.

Computer software

Costs associated with maintaining computer software programmes are recognised as an expense as incurred. Development costs that are directly attributable to the design and testing of identifiable and unique software products controlled by the Group are recognised as intangible assets when the following criteria are met:

- it is technically feasible to complete the software product so that it will be available for use;
- management intends to complete the software product and use or sell it;
- there is an ability to use or sell the software product;
- it can be demonstrated how the software product will generate probable future economic benefits;
- there are adequate technical, financial and other resources to complete the development; and
- the expenditure attributable to the software product during its development can be reliably measured.

Directly attributable costs that are capitalised as part of the software product include the software development employee costs and an appropriate portion of relevant overheads.

Other development expenditures that do not meet these criteria are recognised as an expense as incurred. Development costs previously recognised as an expense are not recognised as an asset in a subsequent period.

Computer software is amortised on the straight-line method over its estimated useful life (three to ten years) when available for use.

Work in progress is defined as intangible assets still in the development phase and not yet available for use. These assets are tested annually for impairment and carried at cost less accumulated impairment losses while still being developed. Amortisation on these assets commences when they become available for use and amortisation periods are based on management's assessment of their useful lives.

Copyrights

Expenditure on acquired copyrights is initially stated at historical cost. Copyrights have a finite useful life and are carried at cost less accumulated amortisation and impairment losses. Copyrights are amortised using the straight-line method to allocate the cost of copyrights over their estimated useful lives (maximum of twenty years). The carrying value is reviewed annually and written down to its recoverable amount if the carrying amount is greater than the recoverable amount.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.5 Intangible assets (continued)

Product development assets

Product development assets represent direct costs incurred in the development of educational programmes and titles prior to their publication. These costs are recognised as current intangible assets where the title will generate probable future economic benefits and costs can be measured reliably. These costs are eligible for capitalisation when incurred after the research phase when feasibility has been completed and prior to publication of the product/availability for use or sale. Product development assets relating to content are amortised upon publication of the title over estimated economic lives of three to five years, with a higher proportion of the amortisation taken in the earlier years for printed product. The rates of amortisation are 70%, 15% and 15% over three years for printed products and over five years for digital products.

This economic life represents the time between the acquisition of these asset for processing and their realisation in cash or cash equivalents. All though these assets are not expected to be realised within twelve months after the reporting period, the costs that are capitalised as assets are presented under current assets as this represents the normal operating cycle in which the asset will be realised.

The assessment of the useful economic life and the recoverability of product development assets involves judgement and is based on historical trends and management's estimation of future potential sales. Product development assets are assessed for impairment triggers on a regular basis or when triggering events occur. The carrying amount of product development assets is set out in note 4.

Product development assets are measured at cost less accumulated amortisation and accumulated impairment losses.

1.6 Financial assets

The Group classifies its financial assets in the following categories: financial assets at amortised cost, financial assets at fair value through profit and loss and financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income. The classification depends on the business model within which the financial assets are managed; and the contractual cash flow characteristics of the asset (that is, whether the cash flows represent "solely payments of principal and interest"). Management determines the classification of its financial assets at initial recognition.

Financial assets at amortised cost

Financial assets at amortised cost includes loans and receivables and are non-derivative financial assets with fixed or determinable payments that are not quoted in an active market. Financial assets at amortised cost are carried at amortised cost using the effective interest rate method. They are included in current assets, except for maturities greater than 12 months after the end of the reporting period. These are classified as non-current assets.

Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss

The Group classifies its listed investments (CFDs) under this category. Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss are measured at fair value, and any fair value changes in the carrying amount of the financial asset are recognised in profit or loss and accumulated under the heading of financial assets at profit or loss.

Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income

The Group elected to classify its non-listed debt investment under this category. Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income (FVOCI) are measured at fair value, and any fair value changes in the carrying amount of financial assets are recognised in other comprehensive income and accumulated under the heading of financial assets at FVOCI reserve. When these financial assets are sold or impaired, the accumulated fair value adjustments recognised in equity are included in the income statement as 'Other gains/(losses)'.

Impairment of financial assets

The Group assesses at the end of each reporting period whether the credit risk on a financial asset has increased significantly since initial recognition. When making the assessment, the Group uses the change in the risk of a default occurring over the expected life of the financial asset. The Group recognises lifetime expected credit losses for all financial assets for which there have been significant increases in credit risk since initial recognition, whether assessed on an individual or collective basis, considering all reasonable and supportable information, including that which is forward-looking.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.6 Financial assets (continued)

(a) Financial assets carried at amortised cost

The Group assesses whether its financial assets at amortised cost are impaired based on the basis of expected credit losses ("ECL"). This analysis requires the identification of significant increases in the credit risk of the counterparty. Considering that the majority of the Group's financial assets are trade receivables, the analysis also integrates statistical data reflecting the past experience of losses incurred due to default. Refer to note 1.8 for impairments related to trade and other receivables where the simplified approach to measuring the ECL is used.

Loss allowances for financial assets measured at amortised cost are deducted from the gross carrying amount of these assets.

The model and some of the assumptions used in calculating these ECLs are key sources of estimation uncertainty.

An allowance for expected credit losses of financial assets carried at amortised cost, except for trade and other receivables, is established using the general approach to measuring expected credit losses (ECLs) for financial assets carried at amortised cost.

Financial assets are written off when there is no reasonable expectation of recovery such as when attempts are unsuccessfully made to recover debt with the assistance of lawyers. When financial assets have been written off, the company continues to attempt to recover the amount due. Where recoveries are made, these are recognised in profit or loss.

Derivative financial instruments and hedging activities

Derivatives are initially recognised at fair value on the date a derivative contract is entered into and are subsequently remeasured to their fair value at the end of each reporting period. The accounting for subsequent changes in the fair value depends on whether the derivative is designated as a hedging instrument, and if so, the nature of the item being hedged. The Group designates derivatives as hedges of a particular risk associated with the cash flows of recognised assets and liabilities and highly probable forecast transactions (cash flow hedges). The Group applies IAS 39 in terms of hedge accounting.

The Group documents at the inception of the hedging transaction the relationship between hedging instruments and hedged items, as well as its risk management objectives and strategy for undertaking various hedging transactions.

The Group also documents its assessment, both at hedge inception and on an ongoing basis, of whether the derivatives that are used in hedging transactions have been and will continue to be highly effective in offsetting changes in fair values or cash flows of hedged items.

The fair values of various derivative instruments used for hedging purposes are disclosed in the income statement. The full fair value of a hedging derivative is classified as a non-current asset or liability when the remaining maturity of the hedged item is more than 12 months, and as a current asset or liability when the remaining maturity of the hedged item is less than 12 months. Trading derivatives are classified as a current asset or liability.

Cash flow hedge

The effective portion of changes in the fair value of derivatives that are designated and qualify as cash flow hedges is recognised in other comprehensive income and accumulated in reserves in equity. The gain or loss relating to the ineffective portion is recognised immediately in the income statement within 'Other gains / (losses)'.

Amounts accumulated in equity are reclassified to profit or loss in the periods when the hedged item affects profit or loss (for example, when the forecast sale that is hedged takes place). The gain or loss relating to the effective portion of interest rate swaps hedging variable rate borrowings is recognised in the income statement within 'finance income/cost'. However, when the forecast transaction that is hedged results in the recognition of a non-financial asset (for example, inventory or fixed assets), the gains and losses previously deferred in equity are transferred from equity and included in the initial measurement of the cost of the asset. The deferred amounts are ultimately recognised in cost of goods sold in the case of inventory or in depreciation in the case of fixed assets.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.6 Financial assets (continued)

When a hedging instrument expires or is sold, or when a hedge no longer meets the criteria for hedge accounting, any cumulative gain or loss existing in equity at that time remains in equity and is recognised when the forecast transaction is ultimately recognised in the income statement. When a forecast transaction is no longer expected to occur, the cumulative gain or loss that was reported in equity is immediately reclassified to the income statement within finance costs.

1.7 Inventories

Inventories are stated at the lower of cost and net realisable value. Cost is determined using the first-in, first-out (FIFO) method.

The cost of finished goods and work in progress comprises raw materials, direct labour, other direct costs and related production overheads (based on normal operating capacity) within the Print and Packaging segments. It excludes borrowing costs. Within the Education and Distribution segment, the cost of finished goods comprises only the purchase price of the product, including non-refundable purchase taxes and import duties, net of rebates or other discounts; costs that are directly attributable to the purchase of inventories, including initial delivery and handling costs; and other costs that are incurred in bringing the inventory to their present location and condition.

Net realisable value is the estimated selling price in the ordinary course of business less the estimated costs of completion and the estimated costs necessary to make the sale. Costs of inventories include the transfer from equity of any gains/losses on qualifying cash flow hedges for purchases of raw materials. Provisions are made for obsolete, unusable and unsaleable inventory and for latent damage first revealed when inventory items are taken into use or offered for sale.

1.8 Trade and other receivables

Trade receivables are amounts due from customers for merchandise sold or services performed in the ordinary course of business. If collection is expected in one year or less (or in the normal operating cycle of the business if longer), they are classified as current assets. If not, they are presented as non-current assets.

Trade receivables are recognised initially at the amount of consideration that is unconditional unless they contain significant financing components, when they are recognised at fair value. The Group holds the trade receivable with the objective to collect the contractual cash flows and therefore measures them subsequently at amortised cost using the effective interest method.

An allowance for expected credit losses of trade receivables is established using the simplified approach to measuring expected credit losses (ECL's) for trade receivables at an amount equal to the lifetime ECLs. The amount of expected credit losses is updated at each reporting date to reflect changes in credit risk since initial recognition. To measure the expected credit losses, trade receivables have been grouped based on shared credit risk characteristics and days past due. The expected credit losses on these financial assets are estimated using a provision matrix based on the group's historical credit loss experience. The historical credit loss rates are based on the payment profiles of sales over the previous reporting periods and the corresponding actual credit losses experienced during the current 12 month reporting period. The historical rates are adjusted to reflect current and forward-looking information on macroeconomic factors such as tough trading conditions due to inflation and consumer behaviour affecting the ability of the customers to settle their debt.

The Group considers a trade receivable to be credit impaired when one or more detrimental events have occurred such as:

- Significant financial difficulty of the customer; or
- The customer is over terms after it is highly probable the customer will not be able to pay all amounts owing according to original terms of payment or numerous defaults on revised repayment plans put in place.

Information about the Group's exposure to foreign currency risk and interest rate risk can be found in note 31.

1.9 Cash and cash equivalents

In the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash includes cash on hand and deposits held at call with banks. Cash equivalents includes other short-term highly liquid investments with original maturities of three months or less that are readily convertible to known amounts of cash and which are subject to an insignificant risk of changes in value. Bank overdrafts are shown separately within current liabilities on the statement of financial position.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.10 Share capital

Ordinary shares are classified as equity.

Incremental costs directly attributable to the issue of new ordinary shares or options are shown in equity as a deduction, net of tax, from the proceeds.

Where any Group company purchases the company's equity share capital (treasury shares), the consideration paid, including any directly attributable incremental costs (net of income taxes) is deducted from equity attributable to the company's equity holders until the shares are cancelled or reissued. Where such ordinary shares are subsequently reissued, any consideration received, net of any directly attributable incremental transaction costs and the related income tax effects, is included in equity attributable to the company's equity holders.

1.11 Borrowings

Borrowings are recognised initially at fair value, net of transaction costs incurred. Borrowings are subsequently measured at amortised cost. Any difference between the proceeds (net of transaction costs) and the redemption amount is recognised in profit or loss over the period of the borrowings using the effective interest method.

Borrowings are removed from the statement of financial position when the obligation specified in the contract is discharged, cancelled or expired. The difference between the carrying amount of a financial liability that has been extinguished or transferred to another party and the consideration paid, including any non-cash assets transferred or liabilities assumed, is recognised in profit or loss as other income or finance costs.

1.12 Employee benefits

Retirement benefits

The Group provides retirement benefits for its full-time employees, primarily by means of monthly contributions to a number of defined contribution pension and provident funds in the countries in which the Group operates. The assets of these funds are generally held in separate trustee-administered funds. The Group's contributions to retirement funds are recognised as an expense in the period in which employees render the related service.

Medical aid benefit

The Group's contributions to medical aid benefit funds for employees are recognised as an expense in the period during which the employees render services to the Group.

Post-employment medical aid benefit

Some Group companies provide post-employment healthcare benefits to their retirees. The entitlement to post-employment healthcare benefits is subject to the employee remaining in service up to retirement age and completing a minimum service period. The expected costs of these benefits are accrued over the minimum service period. Independent qualified actuaries carry out annual valuations of these obligations. All actuarial re-measurements resulting from experience adjustments and changes in actuarial assumptions are recognised immediately in other comprehensive income. The actuarial valuation method used to value the obligations is the projected unit credit method. Future benefits are projected using specific actuarial assumptions and the liability to in-service members is accrued over their expected working lifetime. These obligations are unfunded.

Retirement gratuity benefits

The Group provides retirement gratuity benefits to qualifying employees. The obligation to settle benefits relating to the retirement gratuity provision is limited to a group of employees who still remain entitled to these benefits. The entitlement to retirement gratuity benefits is subject to the employee remaining in service up to retirement age and completing a minimum service period. The remeasurements relating to the retirement gratuity provision is recognised in other comprehensive income.

Long-service benefits

The Group provides long service benefits to qualifying employees. The Group has an obligation to pay the benefits relating to the long service bonus for current employees. A long service bonus is paid to qualifying employees at various intervals of uninterrupted service. The accrued liability is determined on the basis that each employee's long service benefit accrues uniformly over the period to which the benefit becomes payable. The remeasurements relating to the long service bonus provision are recognised in profit or loss.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.14 Share-based payments

The Group grants share options, share appreciation rights (SARs) and restricted shares (RSPs) to its employees under a number of equity compensation plans. The Group recognises a share-based payment expense in the income statement, representing the fair value of share options/SARs/RSPs granted to the Group's employees. A corresponding credit to equity has been raised for equity-settled plans. The fair value of the options/SARs/RSPs at the date of grant under equity-settled plans is charged to income over the relevant vesting periods, adjusted to reflect actual and expected levels of vesting.

1.15 Current and deferred income tax

The tax expense for the period comprises current and deferred tax. Tax is recognised in the income statement, except to the extent that it relates to items recognised in other comprehensive income or directly in equity. In this case, the tax is also recognised in other comprehensive income or directly in equity, respectively.

The current income tax charge is calculated on the basis of the tax laws enacted or substantively enacted at the statement of financial position date in the countries where the company and its subsidiaries operate and generate taxable income. Management periodically evaluates positions taken in tax returns with respect to situations in which applicable tax regulation is subject to interpretation. It establishes provisions where appropriate on the basis of amounts expected to be paid to the tax authorities.

Deferred income tax is recognised on temporary differences arising between the tax bases of assets and liabilities and their carrying amounts in the consolidated financial statements. However, deferred tax liabilities are not recognised if they arise from the initial recognition of goodwill; deferred income tax is not accounted for if it arises from initial recognition of an asset or liability in a transaction other than a business combination that at the time of the transaction affects neither accounting nor taxable profit or loss. Deferred income tax is determined using tax rates (and laws) that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the balance sheet date and are expected to apply when the related deferred income tax asset is realised, or the deferred income tax liability is settled.

Deferred income tax assets are recognised only to the extent that it is probable that future taxable profit will be available against which the temporary differences can be utilised.

Deferred income tax liabilities are provided on taxable temporary differences arising from investments in subsidiaries and associates, except for deferred income tax liability where the timing of the reversal of the temporary difference is controlled by the Group and it is probable that the temporary difference will not reverse in the foreseeable future. Generally, the Group is unable to control the reversal of the temporary difference for associates, only where there is an agreement in place that gives the Group the ability to control the reversal of the temporary difference not recognised.

Deferred income tax assets are recognised on deductible temporary differences arising from investments in subsidiaries and associates only to the extent that it is probable the temporary difference will reverse in the future and there is sufficient taxable profit available against which the temporary difference can be utilised.

Deferred income tax assets and liabilities are offset when there is a legally enforceable right to offset current tax assets against current tax liabilities and when the deferred income taxes assets and liabilities relate to income taxes levied by the same taxation authority on either the same taxable entity or different taxable entities where there is an intention to settle the balances on a net basis.

The normal South African company tax rate used for the year ending 31 March 2026 is 27% (2025: 27%). Deferred tax assets and liabilities have been calculated using the 27% (2025: 27%) rate, being the rate that the Group expects to apply to the periods when the assets are realised or the liabilities are settled.

Capital gains tax is calculated as 80% (2025: 80%) of the company tax rate. Local income tax as per note 23 refers to taxation applicable to the country in which the subsidiaries operate.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.16 Dividends withholding tax (DWT)

Shareholders are subject to DWT on dividends received, unless they are exempt in terms of the amended tax law. DWT is levied at 20% (2025: 20%) of the dividend received. The DWT is categorised as a withholding tax as the tax is withheld and paid to tax authorities by the company paying the dividend or by a regulated intermediary and not the beneficial owner of the dividend.

1.17 Provisions

Provisions are measured at the present value of the cash resources expected to be required to settle the obligation using a pre-tax rate that reflects current market assessments of the time value of money and the risks specific to the obligation. The increase in the provision due to passage of time is recognised as interest expense.

1.18 Trade and other payables

Trade payables are obligations to pay for goods or services that have been acquired in the ordinary course of business from suppliers. Accounts payable are classified as current liabilities if payment is due within one year or less (or in the normal operating cycle of the business if longer). If not, they are presented as non-current liabilities.

Trade payables are recognised initially at fair value and subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method.

1.19 Revenue

Revenue from contracts with customers

Printing revenue

Printing revenue is recognised upon client acceptance of product specifications and completion of printing to client specifications (point in time).

Packaging revenue

Packaging revenue is recognised based on contractual arrangements with customers, either upon client acceptance of product specifications and completion of the product to client specifications (point in time) or upon delivery of the related product and customer acceptance (point in time).

Educational revenue

Educational revenue consists of:

Revenue that is derived from selling a range of products to its customers ostensibly in the South Africa market. Sales are recognised when control of products has transferred, being when the products are delivered to the customer, the customer has full discretion over the channel and price to sell the products, and there is no unfulfilled obligation that could affect the customer's acceptance of the products (point in time). Delivery occurs when the products have been shipped to the specific location, the risks of obsolescence and loss have been transferred to the customers, and either the customer has accepted the products in accordance with the sales contract, the acceptance provisions have lapsed, or the Group has objective evidence that all criteria for acceptance have been satisfied. These revenues are derived mainly from provincial education departments in South Africa, schools and bookshops. Revenue is also derived from higher learning institutions in South Africa. A small element of product is exported to markets outside of South Africa where the product is aligned with that territory's curriculum.

Revenue from these sales is recognised based on the price specified in the contract. No element of financing is deemed present as the sales are made with a credit term of 60 days and in some instances 90 days, which is consistent with market practice.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.19 Revenue (continued)

Revenue from digital products arises from supplies of digital products through third party fulfilment provider that act as agent of the Group. The Group has contracted with this independent third party ("fulfilment provider") who then enters into a contract with the customer. The customer then provides access to the end consumer. An end consumer is defined as an individual consumer (such as a single learner, student, faculty member, teacher, instructor or other individual) on whose behalf an institution has purchased a permanent download or subscribed for such digital products. The Group is not party to the contract between the fulfilment provider and the customer. The Group has no present right to payment of any amount at the time it makes the digital product available to the fulfilment provider. The fulfilment provider does not owe the Group any amount until the significant risks and rewards of ownership have passed to the customer, and ultimately to the end consumer which is when:

- the customer has accepted the products in accordance with the sales contract between it and the fulfilment provider; and
- the Group has objective evidence that all criteria for acceptance have been satisfied, i.e. the Group has confirmation that the end customer has accepted delivery or receipt of the digital product. The customer will accept the digital product only after the end consumers (learners, teachers, etc) have accessed the digital product.

Distribution revenue

Distribution revenue arises from the provision of logistics, delivery and related services relating to printed media, pamphlets, specialised logistics, merchandising and online sales. The Group's performance obligation is satisfied when the distribution service has been completed, and the goods have been delivered to the customer in accordance with the contractual delivery terms. Revenue from distribution services is recognised at a point in time, being when delivery to the customer occurs and control of the service has transferred.

In assessing whether the Group acts as principal or agent, management evaluates whether the Group controls the specified service before it is transferred to the customer.

- Where the Group controls the distribution service prior to transfer, it acts as principal and recognises revenue on a gross basis equal to the total consideration received for the service.
- Where the Group arranges for another party to provide the distribution service, without controlling the service before transfer to the customer, it acts as an agent and recognises revenue on a net basis, representing the commission or fee earned for arranging the service.

Payment is received for the goods/service rendered in line with payment terms of each customer.

Where print and distribution services are provided to the same client, the terms of each separate contract are consistent with contracts where an unrelated party provides one of the services. Revenue is recognised separately for print and distribution services as the contracts are separately negotiated.

Publishing revenue

Publishing revenue is mainly derived from advertising revenues for advertisements published in the Group's newspapers and shown online on the Group's websites. Advertising revenues from print media products are recognised upon showing or publication over the time of the advertising contract. Publication is regarded to be when the print media product has been delivered to the retailer and is available to be purchased by the general public.

Waste revenue and Other revenue (mainly consisting out of circulation revenue from the sale of international magazines locally) is recognised at a point in time upon delivery of the related product and customer acceptance.

Revenue other than from contracts with customers

Other revenue mainly consists of rent received. Refer to note 1.22.

Other revenue for the Company, comprises dividends received from subsidiaries and is recognised when the right to receive payment is established.

Revenue is measured as the amount of consideration which the Group most likely expects to receive, based on the price list applicable to a given performance obligation, net of returns and allowances, trade discounts and volume rebates.

Payment is due once delivery is made within terms of invoice. The Group has no significant payment terms in place with its customers.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.20 Finance income

Interest received on financial assets are included in "Finance income". Interest is accrued using the effective interest method.

1.21 Dividend distribution

Dividend distribution to the company's shareholders is recognised as a liability in the Group's financial statements in the period in which the dividends are approved by the Board of directors.

1.22 Leases

The Group leases various offices, factory premises and equipment. Certain lease contracts in place have renewal options included. Renewal options are only included in the lease term if the lease is reasonably certain to be extended.

For any new contracts entered into, the Group considers whether the contract contains a lease and applies IFRS 16: Leases as set out below.

Measurement and recognition of leases as a lessee

At lease commencement date, the Group recognises a right-of-use asset and a lease liability on the statement of financial position. The lease liability is measured as the present value of lease payments over the lease term, discounted at the Group's incremental borrowing rate. To determine the incremental borrowing rate, the Group, where possible, uses recent third-party financing received by the Group as a starting point, adjusted to reflect changes in financing conditions since third party financing was received. The right-of-use asset is recognised at the amount of the initial measurement of the lease liability and any initial direct costs.

Right-of-use assets

The Group depreciates the right-of-use assets on a straight-line basis from the lease commencement date to the end of the earlier of the useful life or the end of the lease term. The Group also assesses the right-of-use asset for impairment when such indicators exist.

On the statement of financial position, the right-of-use assets have been included in Property, Plant and Equipment.

Lease Liabilities

Subsequent to initial measurement of the lease liability, the liability will be reduced for payments made and increased for finance costs. It is re-measured to reflect any reassessment or modification. When the lease liability is re-measured, the corresponding gain or loss is reflected in profit or loss.

On the statement of financial position, lease liabilities have been included in 'Borrowings and lease liabilities' and 'Current portion of borrowings and lease liabilities'.

The Group has elected to apply the exemptions applicable to short term leases and to assets of low value. Payments associated with short-term leases and leases of low-value assets are recognised on a straight-line basis as an expense in profit or loss. Short-term leases are leases with a lease term of 12 months or less.

Deferred tax is recognised on temporary differences arising from the lease liability and right-of-use assets.

Measurement and recognition of leases as a lessor

A lease is classified as a finance lease if it transfers substantially all the risks and rewards incidental to ownership of an underlying asset. A lease is classified as an operating lease if it does not transfer substantially all the risks and rewards incidental to ownership of an underlying asset.

The Group leases a building to an associate of the Group. The lease is classified as an operating lease.

Lease payments from operating leases are recognised as income on a straight-line basis. Costs, including depreciation, incurred in earning the lease income is recognised as an expense.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

1.23 Foreign currency translation

a) Functional and presentation currency

Items included in the financial statements of each of the Group's entities are measured using the currency of the primary economic environment in which the entity operates ('the functional currency'). The consolidated financial statements are presented in South African Rands (ZAR) which is the Group's presentation currency.

b) Transactions and balances

Foreign currency transactions are translated into the functional currency using the exchange rates prevailing at the dates of the transactions or valuation where items are remeasured. Foreign exchange gains and losses resulting from the settlement of such transactions and from the translation at year-end exchange rates of monetary assets and liabilities denominated in foreign currencies are recognised in profit or loss, except when deferred in other comprehensive income as qualifying cash flow hedges.

1.24 Government grants

Grants from the government are recognised at their fair value where there is a reasonable assurance that the grant will be received and the Group will comply with all attached conditions. Government grants relating to costs are deferred and recognised in the income statement over the period necessary to match them with the costs that they are intended to compensate.

Government grants relating to property, plant and equipment are included in non-current liabilities as deferred income (note 17) and are credited to the income statement on a straight-line basis over the expected lives of the related assets.

1.25 Investment property

Investment property which includes a building, is held for long-term rental yields and is not occupied by the Group. Investment property is measured by applying the cost model and depreciated in equal annual instalments over the useful life of the building which is determined to be fifty years. Investment property is measured at cost less accumulated depreciation and less accumulated impairment.

1.26 Treasury shares

Consideration paid for the purchase of treasury shares is recognised directly in equity. The cost of treasury shares held is presented as a separate reserve.

1.27 Contract assets

A contract asset is raised for products printed but not yet invoiced/delivered or products delivered/sold but not yet invoiced, where the performance obligations have been met. This is recognised as a separate line item in the statement of financial position.

1.28 Publishers' liability

Publishers' liability represents amounts collected from customers for the sale of printed media from retailers on behalf of publishers. A liability is recognised when cash is collected or an account receivable is recorded for the sales where the publisher is entitled to the consideration. Where the Group acts as agent, it recognises only its commission fee as revenue. The liability is measured at the amount payable to publishers, being gross proceeds from sales less approved rebates, discounts, and returns attributable to publishers. Estimates for returns and rebates are updated each reporting period and adjust the liability accordingly. The liability is carried at amortised cost and reduced as payments are made to publishers. Settlements are performed in line with contractual remittance cycles.

Publishers' liability is presented within trade and other payables. Amounts are classified as current unless settlement is expected beyond 12 months.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

2. PROPERTY, PLANT AND EQUIPMENT

	Notes	Land and buildings Owned R'000	Land and buildings Right-of-use asset R'000	Plant and machinery Owned R'000	Plant and machinery Right-of-use asset R'000	Vehicles, computers and office equipment Owned R'000	Vehicles, computers and office equipment Right-of-use asset R'000	Work in progress R'000	Total R'000
Cost		558 971	51 721	2 589 248	2 926	189 862	—	57 355	3 450 083
Accumulated depreciation and impairment		(237 305)	(39 188)	(2 237 215)	(2 502)	(170 302)	—	—	(2 686 512)
Net book value at 1 April 2024		321 666	12 533	352 033	424	19 560	—	57 355	763 571
Additions - cash		575	—	25 642	—	5 435	—	25 241	56 893
Additions - non cash		—	6 130	—	—	—	—	—	6 130
Acquisition of subsidiary		425	6 948	710	—	4 435	1 627	—	14 145
Disposals		—	—	(109)	—	(183)	—	—	(292)
Reclassifications		—	—	(1 383)	—	—	—	—	(1 383)
Depreciation	20	(14 653)	(6 646)	(46 398)	(409)	(9 808)	(276)	—	(78 190)
Transfers from work-in-progress		16 410	—	53 291	—	4 582	—	(74 283)	—
Net book value at 1 April 2025		324 423	18 964	383 787	15	24 021	1 351	8 313	760 874
Cost		573 168	55 395	2 625 060	2 926	204 961	1 627	8 313	3 471 450
Accumulated depreciation and impairment		(248 745)	(36 431)	(2 241 273)	(2 911)	(180 940)	(276)	—	(2 710 576)
Additions - cash		6 450	—	19 159	—	10 600	—	84 407 *	120 616
Additions - non cash		—	4 538	—	1 991	—	—	—	6 529
Acquisition of subsidiary	36	—	—	—	—	2 049	—	—	2 049
Disposals		(611)	(162)	(4 972)	—	(141)	—	—	(5 886)
Transfers from work-in-progress		1 955	—	5 611	—	747	—	(8 313)	—
Reclassifications		6	—	(270)	—	(315)	—	—	(579)
Depreciation	20	(15 506)	(10 769)	(42 288)	(608)	(10 619)	(655)	—	(80 445)
Net book value at 31 March 2026		316 717	12 571	361 027	1 398	26 342	696	84 407	803 158
Cost		580 700	59 729	2 502 623	1 991	160 199	1 627	84 407	3 391 276
Accumulated depreciation and impairment		(263 983)	(47 158)	(2 141 596)	(593)	(133 857)	(931)	—	(2 588 118)

* Work-in-progress relates mainly to machinery not yet brought into use by 31 March 2026.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

2. PROPERTY, PLANT AND EQUIPMENT (continued)

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Net book value of owned assets at 31 March	788 493	740 544
Net book value of right-of-use assets at 31 March	14 665	20 330
	803 158	760 874

Reclassifications

Reclassifications relate to items reclassified to/from other asset categories.

Impairments

The Group assessed impairment on property, plant and equipment. The assessment did not identify any indicators of impairment, and consequently, no impairment was recognised in the current year (2025: Rnil).

In testing for impairment, the recoverable amounts of Plant and machinery were determined with reference to the following valuation methodologies:

At 31 March 2026

	Print R'000	Packaging R'000	Other R'000	Basis of determination of recoverable amount
Net book value				
Plant and machinery	—	184 664	—	Value in use
Plant and machinery	154 846	23 209	—	Fair value less costs to sell
Total Plant and machinery Owned	154 846	207 873	—	

At 31 March 2025

	Print R'000	Packaging R'000	Other R'000	Basis of determination of recoverable amount
Net book value				
Plant and machinery	—	192 184	—	Value in use
Plant and machinery	159 558	31 983	—	Fair value less costs to sell
Total Plant and machinery Owned	159 558	224 166	—	

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

2. PROPERTY, PLANT AND EQUIPMENT (continued)

Print, Publishing and Distribution, Packaging and Education

The Print, Publishing and Distribution, Packaging and Education cash generating units (CGUs) were considered for impairment in the current year and no impairment was deemed necessary as no indication of impairment existed. Refer to note 4 which provides additional information on the impairment assessment performed on the intangible assets recognised at a Group level relating to the Education CGU.

Recoverable amounts of the cash generating units (including goodwill) are determined by reference to either the asset's fair value less costs to sell or value-in-use. Recoverable amounts are based on fair value less cost to sell as and where inputs were available, the inputs used were market values of these assets obtained from manufacturers or agents of the same equipment or similar types of equipment. Where the market values were not obtainable, the recoverable amounts were estimated by management with the use of internal technical experts, approximation of values using recent sale transactions of equipment and given that these are unobservable inputs, the fair value of these assets were classified as level 3 fair value estimates. Where there was no market considered for the specific asset and there is no value-in-use, this asset would be impaired in full. Where fair value less costs to sell or value-in-use was used, if one or more of the inputs were changed to a reasonable possible alternative assumption, there would be no further significant impairments that would have to be recognised.

There were no impairments or reversals of impairments relating to property, plant and equipment in the current year.

At 31 March 2026, the City Deep, Paarden Eiland, Port Elizabeth and Montague Gardens buildings owned by Novus Print with a carrying value of R309,8 million have been pledged as security for the borrowing facilities. Refer to note 9.

3. GOODWILL

	Note	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Cost			
Opening balance		253 595	253 595
Acquisition of subsidiary		—	—
Closing balance		253 595	253 595
Accumulated impairment			
Opening balance		165 772	165 772
Impairment charge		—	—
Closing balance		165 772	165 772
Net book value		87 823	87 823

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

3. GOODWILL (continued)

Impairment testing of goodwill

The Group has allocated its goodwill to various cash-generating units. The recoverable amounts of these cash-generating units have been determined based on the higher of the value-in-use calculation or fair value less costs to sell, where more appropriate. The value-in-use is based on discounted cash flow calculations. The Group based its cash flow calculations on three years budgeted and two years forecasted information. The budgeted information for year 1 was approved by the Board on a consolidated level, with years 2 - 3 derived from budgeted information approved by management and extrapolated over the forecasted years. The growth rates disclosed are the long-term average growth rates which were used to extrapolate the cash flows into the future. These rates were also compared to the average long term industry growth rates for reasonableness. The discount rates used are pre-tax and reflect specific risks relating to the relevant cash generating units in which they operate.

The Group allocated the remaining goodwill to the following cash-generating units:

Note	Net Book Value R'000	Basis of determination of recoverable amount	Discount rate applied to cash flows	Growth rate to extrapolate cashflows into perpetuity
Cash-generating unit				
At 31 March 2026				
ITB	80 212	Value in use	17,1%	3%
Integrity Control Systems	7 611	Value in use	16,1%	3%
	87 823			
At 31 March 2025				
ITB	80 212	Value in use	18,0%	3%
Integrity Control Systems	7 611	Value in use	16,3%	3%
	87 823			

Goodwill represents the above cash-generating units' ability to generate future cash flows; which is a direct result of various factors, including increased expected economic benefits from a larger customer base operating in growth sectors to supply packaging for the food and beverage industry for ITB and Integrity Control Systems.

The following assumptions were used for testing impairment of the cash generating units with goodwill for years 1 - 5.

ITB

Average EBITDA growth rate of 5% (2025: 5%) across the years, resulting in an EBITDA ranging from R85,9 million to R114,7 million (2025: R92 million to R116 million) per year. Average capital expenditure of R19,5 million (2025: R18million) per year.

If one or more of the inputs were changed to a reasonable possible alternative assumption, there would be no further significant impairments that would have to be recognised. If the discount rate increased by 2%, or if the growth rate decreased by 2%, there would be no further impairment charge, with all other assumptions remaining constant. There is sufficient headroom in relation to the extent to which the recoverable amount exceeds the carrying value of the asset.

Integrity Controls System

An average EBITDA growth rate of 5% (2025: 45%) across the years, resulting in the EBITDA ranging from R3 million to R4 million (2025: R1,2 million to R4,4 million) per year. Average capital expenditure of R71 000 (2025: R71 000) per year.

If one or more of the inputs were changed to a reasonable possible alternative assumption, there would be no further significant impairments that would have to be recognised. If the discount rate increased by 2%, or if the growth rate decreased by 2%, there would be no further impairment charge, with all other assumptions remaining constant. There is sufficient headroom in relation to the extent to which the recoverable amount exceeds the carrying value of the asset.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

4. OTHER INTANGIBLE ASSETS

		Non-Current			Current		
	Notes	Patents, trade- marks and customer lists R'000	Brands R'000	Computer Software R'000	Work in Progress R'000	Product development cost** R'000	Total R'000
Cost		402 906	93 447	81 889	—	650 503	1 228 745
Accumulated amortisation and impairment		(187 365)	—	(82 028)	—	(613 041)	(882 434)
Net book value at 01 April 2024		215 541	93 447	(139)	—	37 462	346 311
Additions - cash		2 054	—	—	3 115	43 117	48 286
Additions - non cash		—	—	6 338	7 267	—	13 605
Acquisition of subsidiary		11 571	53 813	57	—	—	65 441
Amortisation*	20	(130 087)	(2 693)	(279)	—	(55 918)	(188 977)
Net book value at 01 April 2025		99 079	144 567	5 977	10 382	24 661	284 667
Cost		416 531	147 260	88 284	10 382	153 960	816 417
Accumulated amortisation and impairment		(317 452)	(2 693)	(82 307)	—	(129 299)	(531 751)
Additions - cash		6 578	—	8 395	—	16 136	31 109
Acquisition of subsidiary		—	3 581	—	—	—	3 581
Transfers (to)/from work-in-progress		—	—	9 175	(9 175)	—	—
Amortisation*	20	(89 342)	(7 217)	(2 168)	—	(22 424)	(121 151)
Net book value at 31 March 2026		16 315	140 931	21 379	1 207	18 373	198 206
Cost		423 109	150 841	105 854	1 207	147 802	828 813
Accumulated amortisation and impairment		(406 794)	(9 910)	(84 475)	—	(129 429)	(630 608)

* The amortisation recognised on the acquired intangible assets is disclosed within the Education and Print, Publishing and Distribution segments and is included within operating expenses in the Statement of Profit or Loss.

** For purposes of fairer presentation, the cost and accumulated amortisation of fully amortised product development intangibles has been removed as these are no longer generating economic benefits for the Group.

Customer relationships (R385,6 million) recognised as part of the acquisition transaction of Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited in the 2023 financial year was recognised at its fair value at the date of acquisition and is subsequently amortised on a straight-line bases over three years. Brands recognised (R93,4 million) as part of the Maskew Miller Learning acquisition in the prior years have an indefinite useful life.

In the prior year, brands amounting to R53,8 million were recognised as part of the acquisition transaction of Novus Media Proprietary Limited (R43,2 million) and Novus Sport Proprietary Limited (R10,5 million) at its fair value at the date of acquisition and is subsequently amortised on a straight-line basis of 8 and 10 years, respectively. As part of the Novus Media acquisition transaction, customer relationships (R6,9 million) with a useful life of 4 years was recognised at its fair value at the date of acquisition and Novus Sport recognised a digital asset with a useful life of 4 years amounting to R4,6 million at its fair value at the date of acquisition.

In the current year, brands amounting to R3,6 million were recognised as part of the acquisition transaction of Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited at its fair value at the date of acquisition and is subsequently amortised on a straight-line basis of 4 years.

Product development costs are internally generated. The carrying value of product development intangible assets not yet available for use is R14,1 million (2025: R15,8 million).

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

4. OTHER INTANGIBLE ASSETS (continued)

Significant estimate: Valuation of intangible assets acquired as part of a business combination

During the year, the Joma brand was recognised. The Joma brand is a well-established international sportswear brand with strong market recognition globally, ranking as the fourth-largest football teamwear supplier in the world. Brand equity like this generally commands a premium and can be valued separately. The Joma brand has been present in the South African market and has built up brand recognition since it was brought into South Africa.

Key assumptions used in the valuation of the brand acquired during the 2026 financial year were:

	2026
Weighted average cost of capital	23,70%
Revenue growth rates	2,0% - 2,7%
Royalty rate	8.0%
Cash flow forecast period	5 years
Customer attrition rate	20%
Customer relationship valuation method	Market excess earnings approach ("MEEM")
Brands valuation method	Relief from royalty method

In the prior year, it was identified that Novus Sport had strong brands including the football-focused publications, Soccer Laduma and Kick Off. This was launched in 1997, with Soccer Laduma becoming South Africa's leading football publication. Digital assets refer to Novus Sport's online platform.

Key assumptions used in the valuation of the brands and digital assets during the 2025 financial year were:

	2025
Weighted average cost of capital	19,3%
Revenue growth rates	6,0% - 30,9%
Royalty rate	8%
Digital assets valuation approach	Cost approach (replication cost, less obsolescence)
Brands valuation method	Relief from royalty method

Impairment testing of acquired indefinite useful live assets

The indefinite useful life assets are tested annually for impairment. The recoverable amounts of the Cash Generating Units below has been determined based on a value-in-use calculation. The value-in-use is based on discounted cash flow calculations. The Group based its cash flow calculations on three years budgeted information. If one or more of the inputs were changed to a reasonable possible alternative assumption, there would be no further significant impairments that would have to be recognised. If the discount rate increased by 2%, or if the growth rate decreased by 2%, there would be no further impairment charge, with all other assumptions remaining constant. There is sufficient headroom in relation to the extent to which the recoverable amount exceeds the carrying value of the asset.

Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited

Average EBITDA growth rate of 3% (2025: -7%) across the years was used to extrapolate the cashflows into the future. Average capital expenditure of R5,6 million (2025: R45 million) per year. A discount rate of 17% (2025: 18%) was used, and no impairment was deemed necessary.

Novus Media Proprietary Limited

Average EBITDA growth rate of 108% across the years was used to extrapolate the cashflows into the future. Average capital expenditure of R444 400 per year. A discount rate of 17% was used, and no impairment was deemed necessary.

Novus Sport Proprietary Limited

Average EBITDA growth rate of 76% across the years was used to extrapolate the cashflows into the future. Average capital expenditure of R80 000 per year. A discount rate of 17% was used, and no impairment was deemed necessary.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

5. INVESTMENTS IN SUBSIDIARIES

The following information relates to the Group's financial interest in its significant subsidiaries, over which the Group has control through its direct and indirect interests in respective intermediate holding companies and other entities.

All subsidiaries, except for Novus Holdings Share Trust which has a year end of 28 February and Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited which has a 31 December year end, share the same financial year end as Novus Holdings Limited and are incorporated in South Africa.

Name of company	Nature of business	Effective interest 2026 %	Effective interest 2025 %	Carrying Amount 2026 R'000	Carrying Amount 2025 R'000
Unlisted					
Direct interests					
Paarl Media Holdings Proprietary Limited	Investment holding company	100,0	100,0	1 043 782	1 043 782
Novus Print Proprietary Limited	Printing	1,0	1,0	13 836	13 836
Latiano 554 Proprietary Limited	Investment holding company	100,0	100,0	*	*
Novus Packaging Holdings Proprietary Limited	Investment holding company	100,0	100,0	*	*
Novus Holdings Share Trust	Investment holding entity	100,0	100,0	*	*
The Novus Foundation**	Charitable trust	100,0	0,0	—	—
				1 057 618	1 057 618
Indirect interests					
Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited	Educational publishing	94,0	94,0		
Novus Print Proprietary Limited	Printing	99,0	99,0		
Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited	Packaging, printing and tissue manufacturing	100,0	100,0		
Ibuyit Proprietary Limited (previously Isithebe Contracting Services Proprietary Limited)	Packaging	100,0	100,0		
Molakai Investments Proprietary Limited	Packaging	100,0	100,0		
Plaslope Proprietary Limited	Dormant	100,0	100,0		
Integrity Control Systems Proprietary Limited	Packaging	100,0	100,0		
On the Dot Supply Chain Management Proprietary Limited (previously Free 4 All Proprietary Limited)	Distribution	100,0	100,0		
Macleary Investments 456 Proprietary Limited	Dormant	100,0	100,0		
Namibie Nuus-Distribueerdes Proprietary Limited	Distribution	100,0	100,0		
Novus Media Proprietary Limited (previously Intrepid Printers Proprietary Limited)	Publishing	100,0	100,0		
Novus Sport Proprietary Limited (previously Victory Ticket 376 Proprietary Limited)	Publishing	100,0	100,0		
K2025568897 (South Africa) Proprietary Limited***	Investment holding company	100,0	0,0		
Digimagic360 Proprietary Limited***	Advertising	100,0	0,0		
Laduma Sport Proprietary Limited***	i-Gaming	74,0	0,0		
Novus Brand Collective Proprietary Limited***	Investment holding company	50,1	0,0		
Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited****	Retail	50,1	0,0		

* The carrying amounts of these investments are less than R1 000.

** Effective 01 July 2025, Novus Holdings Limited obtained control over The Novus Foundation, a charitable trust initially founded by Maskew Miller Longman Proprietary Limited, a dormant subsidiary of Novus Holdings Limited subsidiary, Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited. Refer to note 36.

*** The company was incorporated during the financial year.

**** Effective 04 March 2026, Novus Holdings Limited's 50,1% held subsidiary, Novus Brand Collective Proprietary Limited, acquired 100% of Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited, a retail business. This results in the Group effectively obtaining a 50,1% shareholding in the company. Refer to note 36.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

5. INVESTMENTS IN SUBSIDIARIES (continued)

Impairment is assessed with reference to value-in-use calculations, leveraging the assessment of the subsidiaries' underlying cash flows to determine the recoverable amount of the Group's investments. There was no indicator of impairment noted during the financial period.

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Opening balance	1 057 618	1 057 618
Impairment	—	—
Additions	—	—
Closing balance	1 057 618	1 057 618
Cost	1 310 957	1 310 957
Accumulated impairment	(253 339)	(253 339)

6. DEFERRED TAXATION

The deferred tax assets and liabilities and movement thereon are attributable to the following items:

2026

	Opening balance R'000	Charged to income R'000	Acquisition of subsidiary R'000	Charged to other comprehen- sive income R'000	Charged to equity R'000	Closing balance R'000
Deferred taxation assets						
Property, plant and equipment	6 944	302	—	—	—	7 246
Receivables and other current assets	12 001	(1 585)	—	—	—	10 416
Provisions and other current liabilities	31 723	3 833	—	—	—	35 556
Income received in advance	671	(443)	—	—	—	228
Tax losses carried forward	78 448	(5 412)	(23)	—	—	73 013
Lease liabilities	8 010	36	—	—	—	8 046
Derivative assets	995	(995)	—	—	—	—
Other	14 522	1 260	—	302	—	16 084
	153 314	(3 004)	(23)	302	—	150 589
Deferred taxation liabilities						
Property, plant and equipment	(74 934)	—	—	—	—	(74 934)
Intangible assets	(66 653)	26 606	(967)	—	—	(41 014)
Provisions and other current liabilities	(561)	—	—	—	—	(561)
Hedging reserve	(3 689)	—	—	—	(236)	(3 925)
Derivative assets	(992)	(423)	—	—	—	(1 415)
	(146 829)	26 183	(967)	—	(236)	(121 849)
Net deferred taxation	6 484	23 179	(990)	302	(236)	28 740
Notes		23	36			

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

6. DEFERRED TAXATION (continued)

2025

	Opening balance R'000	Charged to income R'000	Acquisition of subsidiary R'000	Charged to other comprehen- sive income R'000	Charged to equity R'000	Closing balance R'000
Deferred taxation assets						
Property, plant and equipment	6 865	79	—	—	—	6 944
Receivables and other current assets	6 934	5 067	—	—	—	12 001
Provisions and other current liabilities	30 684	1 039	—	—	—	31 723
Income received in advance	1 064	(393)	—	—	—	671
Tax losses carried forward	97 139	(18 558)	—	—	(133)	78 448
Lease liabilities	7 954	56	—	—	—	8 010
Derivative assets	997	(2)	—	—	—	995
Other	5 735	6 908	1 828	(82)	133	14 522
	157 372	(5 804)	1 828	(82)	—	153 314
Deferred taxation liabilities						
Property, plant and equipment	(72 652)	(2 282)	—	—	—	(74 934)
Intangible assets	(84 984)	35 985	(17 654)	—	—	(66 653)
Receivables and other current assets	(2 170)	2 170	—	—	—	—
Provisions and other current liabilities	(561)	—	—	—	—	(561)
Hedging reserve	(3 689)	—	—	—	—	(3 689)
Derivative assets	(992)	—	—	—	—	(992)
	(165 048)	35 873	(17 654)	—	—	(146 829)
Net deferred taxation	(7 677)	30 069	(15 826)	(82)	—	6 485
Note		23				

A summary of the Group's recognised tax losses which does not expire carried forward at 31 March 2026 and the expected dates of utilisation are set out below. The tax losses are within the South African tax jurisdiction.

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Expected to be utilised within one to five years:		
Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited	253 221	290 548
Novus Print Proprietary Limited	—	—
Other Group entities	17 198	—
	270 419	290 548

The ultimate outcome of additional taxation assessments may vary from the amounts accrued. However, management believes that any additional taxation liability over and above the amount accrued would not have a material adverse impact on the Group's income statement and statement of financial position.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

6. DEFERRED TAXATION (continued)

Deferred income tax assets are recognised for tax losses carried forward to the extent that the realisation of the related benefit through future taxable profits is probable. The deferred tax assets relate mainly to carried forward tax losses of Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited. During the current year, in accordance with Section 20 of the Income Tax Act No 58 of 1962, the assessed loss carried forward from the prior year was limited to 80% of the current year's taxable income, where applicable. The Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited subsidiary had incurred tax losses over a number of years following the acquisition of the Correll Tissue business. They relate mainly to costs of integrating the operations and delays in the expansion project of the business. The Group has concluded that the deferred tax assets will be recoverable using the estimated future taxable income based on budgets that were determined by incorporating approved business plans for the subsidiaries. The Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited subsidiary started to utilise the assessed loss from the 2021 financial year and based on future projections it is considered unlikely that the same circumstances within which the losses accumulated will recur. The Group expects to fully utilise this deferred tax asset within the next 4 years based on current projections and forecasts.

Deferred tax assets and liabilities are offset when the income tax relates to the same legal entity. The following amounts are shown in the consolidated statement of financial position:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Deferred tax asset	61 908	70 204
Deferred tax liabilities	(33 168)	(63 719)
	28 740	6 485

7. INVENTORY

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Raw materials	363 200	413 520	—	—
Finished products, trading inventory and consumables	135 593	128 959	—	—
Work-in-progress	38 135	41 723	—	—
Gross inventory	536 928	584 202	—	—
Less: Provision for slow-moving and obsolete inventories	(29 904)	(27 633)	—	—
Net inventory	507 024	556 569	—	—

The total provision charged to the income statement to write inventory down to net realisable value amounted to R9 million (2025: R12,7 million), and reversals of these provisions amounted to R2,8 million (2025: R0,9 million). Provisions utilised amounted to R4,1 million (2025: R2 million).

The cost of inventories recognised as an expense and included in 'costs of goods sold' amounted to R1,6 billion (2025: R1,7 billion).

The Group has pledged its inventory as security against its facilities. Refer to note 14.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

8. TRADE AND OTHER RECEIVABLES

	Note	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Trade accounts receivable, gross		697 033	941 255	—	—
Less: Contract assets	8.1	(29 124)	(31 276)	—	—
Less: Expected credit loss allowance (ECL)		(63 577)	(60 393)	—	—
		604 332	849 586	—	—
Prepayments		21 822	19 275	—	—
VAT receivable		17 047	15 959	—	—
Sundry deposits		16 432	19 763	—	—
Other receivables		73 787	63 379	—	—
		733 420	967 962	—	—

The Group's maximum exposure to credit risk at the reporting date is the carrying value of the receivables mentioned above. The Group also has credit guarantees in place limited to 80% of the R68,7 million (2025: R60,3 million) insured debtors' book within the Packaging segment trade receivables.

The Group has pledged its trade receivables as security against its facilities. Refer to note 14.

The top 5 customers with outstanding balances amounts to R231,7 million (2025: R401,9 million) comprises 34% (2025: 44%) of the outstanding balance of trade receivables and operates within the education and distribution industries.

The Group applies the IFRS 9 simplified approach to measuring expected credit losses which uses a lifetime expected loss allowance for all trade receivables. As at 31 March 2026, to measure the expected credit losses, trade receivables have been grouped based on shared credit risk characteristics, customer types and the days past due.

Management has considered as part of their assessment the low, medium and high risk scenarios, the probability of these likely outcomes in concluding on the impact of loss on the trade receivable book. A historic default rate is calculated by applying specific write offs in the current year to prior year sales payment buckets per industry. The default rate is adjusted for forward-looking information considering macro-economic factors based on the industry the customer operates in. For the debtors' book where there is no historic default rate applicable, a percentage adjustment based on credit risk is further applied in determining the forward looking adjusted default rate.

The Group identifies specific credit loss allowances if receivables are over terms (on average 30 - 60 days) after it is highly probable the customer will not be able to pay all amounts owing according to original terms of payment or numerous defaults on revised repayment plans put in place. The expected credit loss for the current year amounts to R63,6 million (2025: R60,4 million). Specific write-offs were recognised directly against trade receivables by the Group during the current year amounting to R78 million (2025: R21,6 million).

The movement in the expected credit loss allowance of trade receivables during the year was as follows:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Expected credit loss allowance of trade receivables				
Opening balance	60 393	33 066	—	—
Expected credit loss allowance	22 118	51 683	—	—
Unused amounts reversed	(3 916)	(2 737)	—	—
Allowance utilised	(15 018)	(21 619)	—	—
Closing balance	63 577	60 393	—	—

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

8. TRADE AND OTHER RECEIVABLES (continued)

The ageing of the expected loss allowance per age class is presented below:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Current	13 018	12 649	—	—
30 days and older	3 534	2 058	—	—
60 days and older	3 246	148	—	—
90 days and older	7 905	105	—	—
120 days and older	35 874	45 433	—	—
	63 577	60 393	—	—

As at 31 March 2026, the ageing of trade receivables classes are as follows:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
	Gross carrying amount	% ECL [^]	Gross carrying amount	% ECL [^]	Gross carrying amount	Gross carrying amount
Current	440 832	3,0%	546 438	2,3%	—	—
Past due:						
30 days and older	80 683	4,4%	110 520	1,9%	—	—
60 days and older	29 270	11,1%	29 248	0,5%	—	—
90 days and older	19 058	41,5%	23 606	0,4%	—	—
120 days and older	98 066	36,6%	200 167	22,7%	—	—
	667 909	9,5%	909 979	6,6%	—	—

[^] ECL per age class raised as a % of gross debtors per age class

As at 31 March 2026, the credit risk of trade receivables can be assessed by reference to their customer type and industry in which they operate and are categorised and ranked by concentration of risk as follows:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
	% ECL*		% ECL*			
Listed South African companies	322 184	7,2%	284 195	4,8%	—	—
Government / parastatals	160 611	16,2%	379 512	9,1%	—	—
South African corporates	168 738	8,5%	231 019	5,1%	—	—
Corporates in the rest of Africa	16 376	0,7%	14 320	2,5%	—	—
Corporates in the rest of the world	—	0,0%	933	0,0%	—	—
	667 909		909 979		—	—

* ECL raised as a % of debtors book

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

8. TRADE AND OTHER RECEIVABLES (continued)

	Group 2026 R'000										
	Magazines	Retail	Books	Newspapers	Directories	Publishing	Distribution	Packaging	Education	Other	Total
Listed South African companies	11 302	45 939	(126)	26 259	—	5 631	148 248	80 598	3 605	729	322 184
Government / parastatals	—	819	33	19	—	623	1	85	159 030	—	160 611
South African corporates	13 520	24 667	28 777	1 314	—	20 223	26 251	18 444	31 515	4 027	168 738
Corporates in the rest of Africa/World	638	269	5 324	418	681	1	617	6 970	—	1 459	16 376
	25 460	71 693	34 008	28 010	681	26 478	175 117	106 097	194 151	6 214	667 909

	Group 2025 R'000										
	Magazines	Retail	Books	Newspapers	Directories	Publishing	Distribution	Packaging	Education	Other	Total
Listed South African companies	1 982	50 177	3 584	20 932	—	33 536	117 184	54 544	328	1 928	284 195
Government / parastatals	—	—	128 147	16	—	—	—	138	251 211	—	379 512
South African corporates	17 405	28 493	18 981	3 006	—	17 632	46 645	34 249	56 223	8 385	231 019
Corporates in the rest of Africa	1 239	1 530	5 664	651	—	—	—	5 236	—	—	14 320
Corporates in the rest of the world	—	—	—	—	—	933	—	—	—	—	933
	20 626	80 200	156 376	24 605	—	52 101	163 829	94 167	307 762	10 313	909 979

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

8. TRADE AND OTHER RECEIVABLES (continued)

As at 31 March 2026, the expected credit loss allowance of trade receivables was assessed and recognised by reference to their customer type and industry in which they operate as follows:

	Group 2026 R'000										
	Magazines	Retail	Books	Newspapers	Directories	Publishing	Distribution	Packaging	Education	Other	Total
Listed South African companies	2 435	15	—	19 464	—	—	1 173	9	108	—	23 206
Government / parastatals	—	92	—	—	—	—	—	14	25 881	—	25 987
South African corporates	3 763	2 472	4 097	325	—	—	—	1 499	1 596	527	14 278
Corporates in the rest of Africa	—	—	—	99	—	—	—	8	—	—	106
	6 198	2 579	4 097	19 888	—	—	1 173	1 530	27 586	527	63 577

	Group 2025 R'000										
	Magazines	Retail	Books	Newspapers	Directories	Publishing	Distribution	Packaging	Education	Other	Total
Listed South African companies	1 452	—	—	12 303	—	—	—	—	—	—	13 755
Government / parastatals	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	34 396	—	34 396
South African corporates	4 621	3 076	1 254	249	—	—	—	2 608	—	76	11 884
Corporates in the rest of Africa	7	—	—	351	—	—	—	—	—	—	358
	6 080	3 076	1 254	12 903	—	—	—	2 608	34 396	76	60 393

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

8. TRADE AND OTHER RECEIVABLES (continued)

Through conducting the IFRS 9 assessments, a historical credit loss rate of between 1,1% and 15,7% (2025: 0,13% and 7,26%) was calculated relating to customer type across the various industries and was adjusted with forward looking information and a credit risk premium to derive the probability of default rates. Movements in the ECL % from the prior year are mainly in relation to the change in the composition of the debtors' book, as well as the risk profile of the customer and industry.

The ECL % for age classes has increased compared to the prior year across the ageing categories. Despite the increase in ECL percentages applied to the ageing buckets, the overall ECL allowance increased only marginally during the current year. This is because the significant increase in gross trade receivables was largely attributable to businesses acquired in the prior year (On the Dot Supply Chain Management Proprietary Limited, Novus Media Proprietary Limited and Novus Sport Proprietary Limited) and during the year (Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited), which introduced a substantial volume of receivables that were predominantly current or lower aged balances with comparatively stronger recoverability profiles.

The ECL % for Listed South African companies is primarily concentrated within the Newspaper industry, which contributed 74% (2025: 59%) of the ECL exposure for this customer category, compared to Magazines in the prior year at 73%. The increase in ECL recognised within this segment relates mainly to specific customers identified within the Newspaper portfolio during the year. However, the overall increase in the debtor book for listed entities was accompanied by a proportional increase in credit impaired balances, resulting in a slight increase in the overall ECL coverage ratio relative to the increase in receivables compared to the prior year.

The ECL % for Government/parastatal customers increased compared to the prior year from 9% to 16% due to increased exposure within the Education and Packaging segments. A significant portion of the balances within these segments remained current at year-end.

The ECL % for South African corporates increased compared to the prior year from 5% to 8% and remains diversified across multiple industries, including Magazines, Retail, Newspaper, Packaging and Books. The increase in the ECL recognised for this customer category is primarily attributable to increased impairment recognised within the Magazines and Newspaper industries as a result of revised recoverability assessments, ageing profiles and customer specific risk considerations identified during the year.

Corporates in the rest of Africa and the rest of the world contributed ECL exposure mainly within the Newspaper industry.

8.1 Contract Assets

The Group recognised contract assets of R29,1 million (2025: R31,3 million) related to contracts with customers. Contract assets are raised for products that are printed but not yet invoiced or delivered to the customer by year-end within the packaging industry, or products delivered or sold, but not yet invoiced within the distribution industry. Contract assets are assessed for impairment in terms of IFRS 9. Management has assessed the expected credit loss relating to these contract assets and it was deemed insignificant.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

9. CASH AND CASH EQUIVALENTS

Cash and cash equivalents consist of:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Cash at bank and on hand	323 609	263 584	164	129
Deposits on call	693 531	547 470	—	—
Cash equivalents	—	1 200	—	—
	1 017 140	812 254	164	129
Total amount of undrawn facilities available for future operating activities and commitments	596 775	763 649	—	—

Deposits on call are accessible within 24 hours to 30 days.

The banking facilities of the Group are secured as follows:

Cession of the bank accounts and insurance policies in the names of cedent group. Bank balances at 31 March 2026 for the accounts ceded amounted to R703 million.

Pledge of the four owner occupied properties and one investment property owned by Novus Print, with a carrying value of R309,8 million and R57 million respectively at 31 March 2026.

Cross collateralisation with the term loan facility (included in note 14).

Cross guarantees and suretyships exist between the various Novus Group companies for the remaining banking facilities.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

10. SHARE CAPITAL

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Authorised				
3 000 000 000 ordinary no par value shares (2025: 3 000 000 000 ordinary no par value shares)	—	—	—	—
Issued				
343 183 023 ordinary no par value shares (2025: 343 183 023 ordinary no par value shares)	485 708	485 708	539 925	539 925
Ordinary shares (in shares)				
Opening ordinary shares	343 183 023	343 183 023	343 183 023	343 183 023
Cancellation of ordinary shares	—	—	—	—
Closing ordinary shares	343 183 023	343 183 023	343 183 023	343 183 023
Treasury shares				
Opening treasury shares	(303 378)	(331 385)	(268 620)	(285 641)
Repurchase of treasury shares	—	—	—	—
Share awards vested and issued	6 848	17 021	6 848	17 021
Transferred as purchase consideration (Refer to Note 37)	6 604	10 986	—	—
Repurchase of shares	(2 466)	—	—	—
Shares held as treasury shares	(292 393)	(303 378)	(261 773)	(268 620)
Treasury shares (in shares)				
Opening treasury shares	28 228 398	32 026 548	20 275 998	21 560 590
Shares allotted for employee schemes	(516 801)	(1 284 592)	(516 801)	(1 284 592)
Transferred as purchase consideration (Refer to Note 37)	(1 510 934)	(2 513 558)	—	—
Repurchase of shares	462 726	—	—	—
Closing treasury shares	26 663 389	28 228 398	19 759 197	20 275 998

Treasury shares

Treasury shares include 19 759 197 (2025: 20 275 998) ordinary shares issued to the Novus Holdings Share Trust in respect of employee share options and 6 903 447 (2025: 7 951 655) ordinary shares issued to Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited. In addition to this, treasury shares include 745 (2025: 745) ordinary shares in the Company, which the Group acquired, through its subsidiary, Novus Print Proprietary Limited, during the 2019 financial year as part of a share repurchase.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

11. OTHER RESERVES

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Other reserves in the statement of financial position comprise the following:				
Existing control business combination reserve	(129 154)	(129 154)	—	—
Share-based compensation reserve	—	5 841	—	—
Hedging reserve	1 384	746	—	—
Actuarial reserve	2 808	3 613	—	—
Fair value reserve	(12)	—	—	—
	(124 973)	(118 954)	—	—

The existing control business combination reserve is used to account for transactions with non-controlling shareholders in terms of the economic entity model, whereby the excess of the cost of the transactions over the acquirer's interest in previously recognised assets and liabilities is allocated to this reserve in equity. This reserve is also used in common control transactions (where all of the combining entities in a business combination are ultimately controlled by the same entity) where the excess of the cost of the transactions over the acquirer's proportionate share of the net assets acquired is allocated to this reserve.

The fair value of equity settled share options, Share Appreciation Rights (SARs) and Restricted Shares (RSPs) issued to employees is accounted for in the share-based compensation reserve over the vesting period. The reserve is adjusted at each year-end when the entity revises its estimates of the number of share options, SARs and RSPs that are expected to become exercisable. It recognises the impact of the revision of original estimates, if any, in the income statement, with a corresponding adjustment to this reserve in equity for equity-settled plans. Where an option lapses or expires, the portion included in this reserve is transferred to retained earnings.

The hedging reserve relates to the changes in the fair value of derivative financial instruments and the relevant underlying hedged items. It hedges forecast transactions or the foreign currency part of firm commitments. The changes in fair value are recorded in the hedging reserve until the forecast transaction or firm commitment results in the recognition of a non-financial asset or liability, when such deferred gains or losses are included in the initial measurement of the non-financial asset or liability. Movements in the hedging reserve after tax includes R798 131 (2025: Rnil) relating to the initial reclassification adjustments to inventory through equity, Rnil (2025: Rnil) which was subsequently recognised to cost of sales through equity and -R1 million (2025: Rnil) relating to FEC movements through other comprehensive income.

The actuarial reserve relates to actuarial gains or losses on the post-employment medical liability as well as the provisions for pensioner gratuities.

The fair value reserve relates to gains or losses on the revaluation of financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

12. POST-EMPLOYMENT MEDICAL LIABILITY

The employees of the Group participate in a post-retirement medical benefit scheme. The obligation of the Group to pay medical aid contributions after retirement is no longer part of the conditions of employment for new employees. A number of pensioners and current employees, however, remain entitled to this benefit. The entitlement to this benefit for current employees is dependent on the employees remaining in service until retirement age and completing a minimum service period.

The Group provides for post-retirement medical aid benefits on the accrual basis determined each year by way of a valuation. The key assumptions and the valuation methods are described below. The directors believe that adequate provision has been made for future liabilities.

Key assumptions and valuation method

The actuarial valuation method used to value the liabilities is the Projected Unit Credit Method prescribed by IAS 19 "Employee Benefits". Future benefit values are projected using specific actuarial assumptions and the liability for in-service members is accrued over the expected working lifetime.

The most significant assumptions used for the current and previous valuations are outlined below:

	2026	2025
Discount rate	8,3 - 10,4%	10,4 - 14,9%
Health cost inflation	3,8 - 7,8%	6,5 - 10,3%
Expected retirement age	65	65
Membership discontinued at retirement	0%	0%

It is assumed that current in-service members would retire on their current medical scheme option and that there would be no change in options on retirement.

Movement in post-employment medical liability:

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Opening balance	38 891	25 957
Current service cost	466	156
Interest cost	4 081	3 181
Past service cost	—	11 107
Employer benefit payments	(1 514)	(1 983)
Acquisition of business	—	1 025
Remeasurements	1 255	(551)
Closing balance	43 179	38 891
Total post-employment medical liability	43 179	38 891
Less: Current portion	(2 246)	(1 856)
Non-current: post employment medical liability	40 933	37 035

12.1 Post-employment medical liability plan assets

The Group operates a post-retirement subsidy arrangement for qualifying pensioners and their spouses. The obligation is funded through a CPI +3% linked guarantee annuity policy with Sanlam, which has been structured to match the related subsidy obligations. The insurance policy qualifies as a plan asset in terms of IAS 19.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

13. PROVISIONS

The long-service and retirement gratuity provisions were determined based on management's estimates and assumptions as below. The Group has an obligation to pay the benefits relating to the long service bonus for current employees, however the obligation to settle benefits relating to the retirement gratuity provision is limited to a group of employees who still remain entitled to these benefits. The remeasurements relating to the long service bonus provision is recognised in profit or loss and the remeasurements relating to the retirement gratuity provision is recognised in other comprehensive income.

Key assumptions and valuation method

The actuarial valuation method used to value the provisions is the Projected Unit Credit Method as prescribed by IAS 19 "Employee Benefits".

The most significant assumptions used for the current and previous valuations are outlined below:

	2026	2025
Discount rate	9,1%	11,2%
Normal salary increase rate	5,0%	5,0%
Expected retirement age	63 or 65	60 or 65

The discount rate and the normal salary increase rate assumptions should be considered in relation to each other.

Long service bonus

As per the Group's remuneration policies a long service bonus is paid to qualifying employees at the following intervals:

- 10 years uninterrupted service – 50% of one month's total cost to company
- 15 years uninterrupted service – 75% of one month's total cost to company
- 25 years uninterrupted service – 100% of one month's total cost to company
- 40 years uninterrupted service – 100% of one month's total cost to company

The accrued liability is determined on the basis that each employee's long service benefit accrues uniformly over the period to which the benefit becomes payable.

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Opening balance	10 951	6 937
Current service cost	783	557
Interest cost	1 012	719
Employer benefit payments	(1 929)	(851)
Transfer of business	—	3 383
Remeasurements	135	206
Closing balance	10 952	10 951

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

13. PROVISIONS (continued)

Retirement gratuity

The retirement gratuity is paid to qualifying employees in the event of retirement (normal, early and ill-health) at the age of 55 years or older and with at least 15 years of continued service at retirement.

The accrued liability was calculated by taking a pro-rata proportion of the total calculated value. This proportion is based on the past service of members relative to their prospective total service.

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Opening balance	4 222	1 597
Current service cost	137	4
Interest cost	655	179
Employer benefit payments	(1 689)	(445)
Transfer of business	—	3 200
Remeasurements	2 310	(313)
Closing balance	5 635	4 222

Total provisions

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Long service bonus provision	10 952	10 951
Retirement gratuity provision	5 635	4 222
Total provisions	16 587	15 173
Non-current provisions	16 587	15 173
	16 587	15 173

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

14. BORROWINGS AND LEASE LIABILITIES

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Total lease liabilities	19 672	28 290
Less: Current portion	(14 666)	(14 266)
Interest-bearing: Lease Liabilities	5 006	14 024
Total borrowings	359 259	430 125
Less: Current portion	(75 265)	(168 468)
Interest-bearing: Borrowings	283 994	261 657
Total liabilities	378 931	458 415
Less: Current portion	(89 931)	(182 734)
Net long-term liabilities	289 000	275 681

Details of Lease Liabilities	Total Liability	Currency of balance	Incremental borrowings rate	Final repayment dates
Buildings	13 907	South African Rand (ZAR)	8,93% - 11,75%	2027 - 2029
Manufacturing equipment	5 020	South African Rand (ZAR)	9,98% - 10,15%	2026 - 2031
Vehicles	745	South African Rand (ZAR)	9,98%	2027 - 2028
	19 672			

The right of use asset attributable to the above leases is disclosed with property, plant and equipment. Refer to note 2.

	Note	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Payable within one year		15 792	16 327
Payable within two to five years		5 367	14 888
		21 159	31 215
Future finance costs on leases		(1 487)	(2 925)
Present value of lease liabilities		19 672	28 290
Present value			
Payable within one year		14 666	14 266
Payable within two to five years		5 006	14 024
Present value of lease liabilities		19 672	28 290
The table below show a reconciliation of lease liabilities			
Opening Balance		28 290	25 929
New leases		6 174	6 130
Acquisition of a business		—	8 574
Other		(319)	(52)
Interest	22	2 625	2 579
Payments		(17 098)	(14 870)
Closing Balance		19 672	28 290

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

14. BORROWINGS AND LEASE LIABILITIES (continued)

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Borrowings		
Currency of balance: South African Rand (ZAR)		
Investec Bank Limited - Term Loan	—	311 290
Weighted average year-end interest rate: 10.67% linked to 3-month JIBAR payable in quarterly repayments from 31 March 2023 to 29 November 2027.		
Investec Bank Limited - Term Loan B	—	119 740
Weighted average year-end interest rate: 9.79% linked to 3-month JIBAR payable in quarterly repayments from 31 March 2025 to 11 December 2026.		
Investec Bank Limited/Standard Bank of South Africa Limited - Term Facility	361 905	—
Weighted average year-end interest rate: 9.39% linked to 3-month JIBAR payable in quarterly repayments from 31 December 2025 to 10 December 2030.		
Structuring costs amortised over the loan period	(2 645)	(905)
	359 260	430 125

Managing interest rate benchmark reform and associated risks

The South African Reserve Bank ("SARB") has designated the South African Rand Overnight Index Average ("ZARONIA") as the successor benchmark interest rate to the Johannesburg Interbank Average Rate ("JIBAR"), with JIBAR expected to cease publication after 31 December 2026.

The Group is exposed to JIBAR through borrowings held with Investec Bank Limited and Standard Bank Limited and continues to monitor developments relating to benchmark reform. Management is engaging with financing counterparties regarding the transition of affected facilities to alternative reference rates, including ZARONIA. The Group does not currently expect the transition to have a material impact on its risk management strategy, cash flows or financial position. The Group intends to apply the practical expedients and reliefs available under IFRS Accounting Standards relating to interest rate benchmark reform where applicable. Management continues to assess the operational, contractual, valuation and financial reporting implications associated with the transition from JIBAR to ZARONIA.

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Payable within one year	106 364	206 700
Payable within two to five years	337 415	286 655
	443 779	493 355
Future finance costs on borrowings	(84 519)	(63 230)
Present value of borrowings	359 260	430 125
Repayment terms of borrowings		
Payable within one year	75 265	168 469
Payable within two to five years	283 995	261 656
	359 260	430 125
The table below show a reconciliation of borrowings		
Opening Balance	430 125	401 014
New borrowings	400 000	435 000
Payments	(151 652)	(451 549)
Interest	38 713	45 660
Settlement of existing borrowings	(355 339)	—
Structuring costs paid and to be amortised over the loan period	(2 587)	—
Closing Balance	359 260	430 125
Interest rate profile of long-term liabilities (long and short-term portion, including lease liabilities)		
Loans at fixed rates (1-12 months)	14 666	14 127
Loans at fixed rates (more than 12 months)	5 005	14 163
Loans linked to variable rates	359 260	430 125
	378 931	458 415

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

14.1 Net cash/(debt) reconciliation

This section sets out an analysis of net debt and the movements in net debt for each of the periods presented.

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Net cash		
Cash and cash equivalents	1 017 140	812 254
Liquid investments (i)	39 213	22 052
Borrowings - repayable within one year (including overdraft) (ii)	(89 931)	(182 734)
Borrowings - repayable after one year (ii)	(289 000)	(275 681)
Net cash	677 422	375 891
Cash and liquid investments	1 056 353	834 306
Gross debt - fixed interest rates	(19 671)	(28 290)
Gross debt - variable interest rates	(359 260)	(430 125)
Net cash	677 422	375 891

(i) Liquid investments comprise financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income and financial assets at fair value through profit or loss.

(ii) Borrowings include finance leases, loans and liabilities and bank overdrafts.

	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Total cash flows in respect of leases:		
Principal portion of the lease liabilities (included in cash flows from financing activities)	(14 473)	(12 291)
Interest portion of the lease liabilities (included in cash flows from financing activities)	(2 625)	(2 579)
Variable lease payments that are not included in the measurement of the lease liabilities (included in cash generated from operating activities)	(5 699)	(4 900)
	(22 797)	(19 770)

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

14. BORROWINGS AND LEASE LIABILITIES (continued)

Assets pledged as security for borrowings

The term facility is secured by the following:

- Pledge and cession of secured property by the cedent group, including all shares and assets.
- Cash and cash equivalents are included as collateral.
- Insurance policies are to be maintained and with reputable companies or underwriters.
- Acquisitions of shares in entities require the consent of the Facility Agent.
- Other secured property includes:
 - Claims and receivables
 - Insurance policies and proceeds
 - Intellectual property rights
 - Shareholder and Group claims
 - Related rights
- Cross collateralisation to the revolving credit facilities.

Loan covenants

Under the terms of the major borrowing facilities obtained effective 10 December 2025, the Group is required to comply with the following financial covenants which are calculated biannually, in September and March, in line with reporting requirements:

- Gross debt: EBITDA ratio must be less or equal to 3,5 times.
- EBITDA interest expense ratio must be greater than or equal to 3 times.
- Debt service cover ratio must be greater than or equal to 1,3 times.
- A distribution covenant whereby Total Group Debt: EBITDA ratio must be less than 2,5 times immediately before and after any dividend distribution made by the Group.
- A guarantor coverage covenant where the guarantor entities' aggregate contribution represents not less than 85% of the consolidated EBITDA, gross assets and total turnover of the covenant Group of entities (Novus Group of companies excluding Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited).

The Group has complied with all the required financial covenants at 31 March 2026. At 31 March 2026, the balance on the term loan outstanding amounted to R359,2 million and the revolving credit facility amounted to Rnil.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

15. SHARE BASED PAYMENTS

The Group operates a number of share incentive plans, share appreciation rights ("SARs") and restricted share plans ("RSPs") schemes.

All share options are granted with an exercise price of not less than 100% of the market value or fair value of the respective company's shares on the date of the grant. All SARs are granted with an exercise price of not less than 100% of the fair value of the SARs on the date of the grant. All unvested share options/SARs are subject to forfeiture upon termination of employment. All cancelled options/SARs are options/SARs cancelled by mutual agreement between the employer and employee. The group has replaced its share incentive plans with a deferred bonus scheme or other cash based long term incentive and no grants have been made in accordance with these schemes since 23 September 2016.

All RSPs are granted with an exercise price of nil. All unvested RSPs are subject to forfeiture upon termination of employment and cancelled RSPs are cancelled by mutual agreement between the employer and employee.

The share-based payment reserves at 31 March are as follows:

	Notes	2026 R'000	2025 R'000
Share-based compensation reserve			
Balance as at 31 March	11	—	5 841
Income statement			
Share-based compensation charge	11	—	483

The following significant share incentive plans were in operation during the financial year:

	Date of incorporation	Maximum awards permissible #	Vesting period	Period to expiry from date of offer	IFRS 2 classification
Share appreciation rights schemes					
Novus Holdings Limited Share Appreciation Rights Plan	23 September 2016	10%	*	6 years	Equity settled
Novus Holdings Limited Restricted Share Plan	23 September 2016	10%	**	6 years	Equity settled

Notes

The percentage reflected in this column is the maximum percentage of the respective companies issued/notional share capital that the applicable trust may hold and subsequently allocate to participants subject to the following, where applicable:

* One third vests after each of years three, four and five.

** One quarter vests in years one to four.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

15. SHARE BASED PAYMENTS (continued)

Movements in the share incentive plans are as follows:

	Novus Holdings Limited Share Appreciation Rights Plan		Novus Holdings Limited Restricted Share Plan	
	2026	2025	2026	2025
SARs/RSP's/Options				
Outstanding 1 April	955 419	6 626 116	355 540	355 540
Exercised	(871 663)	(3 118 591)	—	—
Forfeited	—	(2 163 907)	—	—
Lapsed	(83 756)	(388 199)	(355 540)	—
Outstanding 31 March	—	955 419	—	355 540
	R	R	R	R
Weighted average exercise price				
Outstanding 1 April	2,86	4,00	—	—
Exercised	2,75	3,65	—	—
Forfeited	—	4,06	—	—
Lapsed	4,00	4,12	—	—
Outstanding 31 March	—	2,86	—	—
Weighted average share price of options taken up during the year				
SARs	871 663	3 118 591	—	—
Weighted average SAR price (R)	2,75	3,65	—	—

Novus Holdings Limited Share Appreciation Rights Plan

	SARS outstanding				
	Exercise prices	Number outstanding at 31 March	Weighted average remaining contractual life (years)	Exercisable at 31 March	Weighted average exercise price (R)
2026	2,40	—	—	—	2,40
	4,00	—	—	—	4,00
		—		—	0,00
2025	2,40	680 571	0,73	680 571	2,40
	4,00	274 848	0,32	274 848	4,00
		955 419		955 419	2,86

There are currently nil (2025: 955 419) SARs which are exercisable at year-end.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

15. SHARE BASED PAYMENTS (continued)

Novus Holdings Limited Restricted Share Plan

	Restricted shares outstanding		
	Exercise prices	Number outstanding at 31 March	Weighted average remaining contractual life (years)
2026	—	—	—
2025	—	355 540	0,32
		355 540	

There are currently nil (2025: 355 540) RSPs which are exercisable at year-end with an exercise price of Rnil.

There were no SARs or RSPs granted under the Novus Holdings Limited Share Appreciation Rights Plan or Restricted Share Plan during the financial year.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

15. SHARE BASED PAYMENTS (continued)

The directors of Novus Holdings Limited have the following SARs:

2026

Director	SARs	Date of award	Number of instruments awarded	Offer price (R)	Outstanding at 31 March 2025	Exercised during the year	Lapsed during the year	Outstanding at 31 March 2026	Indicative value of unvested and/or unexercised options (R'000)#
K Alwar	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	26/07/2019	148 567	4,00	148 567	(148 567)	—	—	—
	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	20/12/2019	247 611	2,40	112 913	(112 913)	—	—	—
									—
K Julies	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	26/07/2019	42 525	4,00	42 525	(42 525)	—	—	—
	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	20/12/2019	70 875	2,40	32 319	(32 319)	—	—	—
									—

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

15. SHARE BASED PAYMENTS (continued)

The directors of Novus Holdings Limited have the following SARs:

2025

Director	SARs	Date of award	Number of instruments awarded	Offer price (R)	Outstanding at 31 March 2024	Exercised during the year	Cancelled/ forfeited during the year	Outstanding at 31 March 2025	Indicative value of unvested and/or unexercised options (R'000)#
C Wright	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	13/07/2018	225 896	4,12	225 896	(225 896)	—	—	—
	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	26/07/2019	165 375	4,00	165 375	(165 375)	—	—	—
	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	12/20/2019	275 625	2,40	97 616	(97 616)	—	—	—
									—
K Alwar	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	13/07/2018	213 863	4,12	213 863	(213 863)	—	—	—
	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	26/07/2019	148 567	4,00	148 567	—	—	148 567	431
	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	20/12/2019	247 611	2,40	112 913	—	—	112 913	508
									939
K Julies	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	26/07/2019	42 525	4,00	42 525	—	—	42 525	123
	Novus Holdings Share Appreciation Rights Plan	20/12/2019	70 875	2,40	32 319	—	—	32 319	145
									269

The indicative value of outstanding SARs was calculated based on the number of instruments held by the individual at year-end share price (or SAR valuation) less the instrument's strike (or option) price. Only indicative gains were disclosed.

The following shares prices (or SAR valuations) were applicable at year-end:

Novus Holdings Limited – R4,36

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

16. TRADE AND OTHER PAYABLES

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Trade payables	444 970	556 073	—	—
Personnel accruals	15 377	12 960	—	—
Accrued leave pay	24 627	26 195	—	—
Accrued bonus	29 739	30 054	—	—
Accrued expenses	198 956	257 408	—	—
Value added tax	10 360	6 199	—	—
Other current liabilities	157 594	101 538	400	400
	881 623	990 427	400	400

The fair values of trade and other payables approximate their carrying values.

The increase in other current liabilities is attributable to amounts owed to publishers by On the Dot Supply Chain Management Proprietary Limited of R145,6 million (2025: R96,3 million).

17. DEFERRED INCOME

Deferred income consists of Government grants received.

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Opening balance	2 667	3 377	—	—
Included in profit or loss	(501)	(710)	—	—
Closing balance	2 166	2 667	—	—
Non-current liability portion	1 665	2 166	—	—
Current portion	501	501	—	—
	2 166	2 667	—	—

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Grant date:				
28 February 2013	1 968	2 460	—	—
01 October 2015	—	—	—	—
20 October 2015	198	207	—	—
	2 166	2 667	—	—

These grants were received from the Department of Trade and Industry ("DTI") in terms of the Manufacturing Competitiveness Enhancement Programme ("MCEP") and relate to capital expenditure for expansion of production equipment. Income is recognised over the life of the underlying asset.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

18. REVENUE

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Revenue from contracts with customers				
Print revenue	1 969 041	2 181 337	—	—
Packaging revenue	670 466	713 592	—	—
Educational revenue: Printed products	713 546	850 092	—	—
Educational revenue: Digital products	45 035	70 470	—	—
Distribution revenue	460 423	240 661	—	—
Publishing revenue	224 057	85 563	—	—
Waste revenue	24 586	23 573	—	—
Other revenue	80 321	48 515	—	—
Revenue other than from contracts with customers				
Other revenue	7 387	8 542	—	—
Dividends	—	—	174 200	156 700
	4 194 863	4 222 345	174 200	156 700

All revenue streams are earned at a point in time.

19. OTHER (LOSSES)/GAINS

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
(Loss)/Profit on disposal of property, plant and equipment		(5 119)	639	—	—
Gain on derecognition of lease		131	—	—	—
Profit on partial disposal of associate shares	37	—	3 737	—	—
Gain on bargain purchase*	36	1 786	16 388	—	—
Fair value adjustments		7 022	9 050	—	—
Impairment of loan and receivables		(19 995)	(2 580)	—	—
		(16 175)	27 234	—	—

* Included in the gain on bargain purchase is R0,3 million relating to the revision of the prior year purchase price allocation of Namibie Nuus-Distribueerdes Proprietary Limited.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

20. INCOME AND EXPENSES BY NATURE

	Note	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Operating profit includes the following items:					
Depreciation classification					
Cost of sales		48 491	52 557	—	—
Operating expenses		33 720	27 400	—	—
		82 211	79 956	—	—
Amortisation classification					
Cost of sales		24 326	56 205	—	—
Operating expenses		96 825	132 771	—	—
		121 151	188 977	—	—
Property related expenses					
		5 699	4 900	—	—
		5 699	4 900	—	—
Auditor's remuneration					
Fees*		6 898	4 619	—	—
Prior year under/(over) provision		1 077	18	—	—
Non-assurance services**		39	—	—	—
All other fees		377	824	—	—
		8 391	5 461	—	—
Advertising expense					
		8 146	14 681	—	—
Cost of inventories sold					
		1 568 780	1 770 427	—	—
Water and electricity					
		138 660	130 762	—	—
Repairs and maintenance					
		223 888	148 117	—	—
Research and development					
		1 395	1 197	—	—
Distribution costs					
		325 434	156 767	—	—
Employee costs					
Salaries, wages and bonuses		643 409	542 383	—	—
Retirement benefit costs (defined contribution plan)		61 760	50 595	—	—
Medical aid fund contributions		18 777	16 074	—	—
Post-retirement benefits		4 204	13 428	—	—
Share-based compensation charge	15	—	483	—	—
Long-service and retirement gratuities		4 440	1 855	—	—
Training costs		10 618	11 628	—	—
		743 208	636 446	—	—
Other expenses					
		608 811	690 182	—	—
		3 835 774	3 827 873	—	—

* The fees relate to assurance fees charged in respect of work performed by BDO South Africa Inc. within the Group.

** The non-assurance fees relates to fees charged in respect of work performed by BDO South Africa Inc. within the Group prior to 31 August 2025.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

21. FINANCE INCOME

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Bank	53 167	53 543	—	—
Other	2 839	5 979	—	—
Interest received	56 006	59 522	—	—

22. FINANCE COSTS

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Net gain from foreign exchange translation and fair-value adjustments on derivative financial instruments*		(6 846)	(6 947)	—	—
Bank		11 929	2 741	5	13
Loans	14	38 713	45 660	—	—
Leases	14	2 625	2 579	—	—
Other		6 605	7 403	—	—
Interest expense		59 872	58 383	5	13
		53 026	51 436	5	13

* The current year includes R11,8 million loss (2025: R5 million gain) on translation of trade payables and R18,6 million gain (2025: R1,9 million gain) on translation of forward exchange contracts.

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Cashflow reconciliation of finance cost					
Interest portion of lease liabilities paid per statement of cash flows	14	2 625	2 579		
Finance cost on borrowings & other		57 247	55 804	—	—
Interest paid per statement of cashflows		57 247	55 804	—	—
		59 872	58 383	—	—

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

23. TAXATION

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Major components of the income tax expense				
Current	117 614	137 632	—	—
Local income tax — current period	121 469	137 562	—	—
Local income tax — prior years	(3 855)	70	—	—
Deferred	(23 179)	(30 068)	—	—
Local income tax — current period	(30 644)	(26 687)	—	—
Local income tax — prior years	7 465	(3 381)	—	—
	94 435	107 564	—	—
Reconciliation of the income tax expense				
Reconciliation between the accounting profit and the income tax expense				
Accounting profit	367 701	463 624	174 195	156 687
Tax at the applicable tax rate of 27% (2025: 27%)	99 280	125 179	47 033	42 305
Tax effects of adjustments on taxable income				
Non-deductible expenses*	11 713	4 701	1	3
Non-taxable income**	(7 176)	(5 652)	(47 034)	(42 309)
Gain on bargain purchase	(399)	(4 425)	—	—
Net gain on investment in associate	—	(13 822)	—	—
Prior year adjustments	2 530	(3 010)	—	—
Other	351	(4)	—	—
Tax attributable to acquisition of assets in a business	—	—	—	—
Tax attributable to associate income	(5 889)	4 597	—	—
Adjustment for foreign entities other tax rates	16	—	—	—
Capital loss	(5 992)	—	—	—
	94 435	107 564	—	—
Effective tax rate	25,7%	23,2%	0,0%	0,0%

* Non-deductible expenses within the Group relate mainly to non-deductible consulting and legal fees.

** Non-taxable income within the Group mainly relates to DTI Grant income and learnership allowances claimed in Novus Print (Pty) Ltd. Non-taxable income within the Company relate to inter-group dividends received.

24. EARNINGS PER SHARE

Basic earnings per share

Earnings per share is calculated using the weighted average number of ordinary shares in issue during the period and is based on the net profit attributable to ordinary shareholders. For the purpose of calculating earnings per share, treasury shares are deducted from the number of ordinary shares in issue. Diluted earnings per share is calculated by adjusting the weighted average number of ordinary shares outstanding to assume conversion of all dilutive potential ordinary shares and is based on the net profit attributable to ordinary shareholders, adjusted for the after-tax dilutive effect. Currently, the share options granted and vested under equity settled schemes to participating employees and directors (see note 15) are considered anti-dilutive.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

24. EARNINGS PER SHARE (continued)

Headline earnings per share

Headline earnings per share is calculated using the weighted average number of ordinary shares in issue during the period and is based on the earnings attributable to ordinary shareholders, after excluding those items as required by Circular 01/2023 issued by the South African Institute of Chartered Accountants (SAICA).

2026

	Gross R'000	Taxation R'000	Net R'000
Earnings			
Net profit attributable to shareholders			266 119
Adjusted for:	3 552	(1 441)	2 111
Loss on disposal of property, plant and equipment (note 19)	5 119	(1 382)	3 737
Gain on bargain purchase (note 19)	(1 786)	—	(1 786)
Remeasurement items included in associate equity accounted earnings			
Group's share of loss on disposal/recoupment of property, plant and equipment and intangible assets.	154	(42)	113
Group's share of loss on sale of property, plant and equipment	65	(17)	47
Headline earnings			268 230

2025

	Gross R'000	Taxation R'000	Net R'000
Earnings			
Net profit attributable to shareholders			347 971
Adjustments	(71 956)	1 182	(70 775)
Profit on disposal of property, plant and equipment (note 19)	(639)	173	(467)
Gain on partial disposal of shares (note 19)	(3 737)	1 009	(2 728)
Gain on bargain purchase (note 19)	(16 388)	—	(16 388)
Net gain on investment in associate	(51 192)	—	(51 192)
Headline earnings			277 196

	2026	2025
Number of ordinary shares in issue at year end	343 183 023	343 183 023
Weighted average number of shares		
Shares for earnings per share adjusted for weighting	316 351 023	313 816 306
Earnings per ordinary share (cents)		
Basic	84,12	110,88
Diluted*	75,92	102,70
Headline earnings/(loss) per share (cents)		
Basic	84,79	88,33
Diluted*	76,59	80,15

* Earnings per share and Headline Earnings per share have been adjusted for the after-tax dilutive effect of the future conversion of the accelerated empowerment ("AE") shares to ordinary shares held by the minority shareholders in MML, which will result in increased earnings attributable to non-controlling interest.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

25. SEGMENTAL ANALYSIS

IFRS 8: Operating Segments requires operating segments to be identified on the basis of internal reports about components of the Group that are regularly reviewed by the chief operating decision-maker ("CODM") to allocate resources to the segments and to assess their performance. The CODM has been identified as the executive committee that makes strategic decisions. Operating profit is the income statement measure used most often by the CODM to assess performance and allocate resources.

The executive committee has identified six operating segments based on business by service or product and aggregated it into the reportable segments based on the nature of the operating segment and it meeting the aggregation criteria in terms of IFRS 8 paragraph 12 as they deliver similar products and services to their customers through the similar distribution methods applied, has a similar production process and utilising similar suppliers to service these same customers.

The Print, Publishing and Distribution segment comprises of Novus Print, On the Dot Supply Chain Management, Novus Media and Novus Sport. Novus Print has a national network of printing plants equipped with the most technologically advanced equipment, ensuring highly efficient and fully automated production processes in the printing of books, magazines, retail inserts and newspapers in servicing the customers in the fast-moving consumer goods ("FMCG") sector. The Print segment engages with local and external suppliers in providing raw materials (paper) and related services in the production process of these products while using their efficient supply chain in the distribution of the products per order. On the Dot Supply Chain Management provides logistics/distribution of mainly media products. Novus Media and Novus Sport publish community newspapers and sport publications across South Africa. These divisions are aggregated into a single reporting segment as they exhibit similar economic characteristics. These divisions are involved in the publishing, printing and distribution of various publications, while On the Dot Supply Chain Management provides internal logistics that support the distribution of these printed materials. All divisions serve a similar customer base within the media and publishing industry, and use integrated production and distribution processes, resulting in a cohesive "Integrated Print Media and Distribution" segment.

The Education segment relates to Maskew Miller Learning, which develops educational content for various institutions from government to private colleges.

The Packaging segment produces flexible packaging products and prints flexible labels to their specific customers in the beverage, petrochemical and broader FMCG markets. The production process and facilities in producing these products are aligned to create an efficient packaging process to distribute the products per order.

The Other segment comprises non-print/packaging or educational related transactions. Included in this segment is earnings from the Group's associate in the Tissue manufacturing industry. This business produces jumbo tissue wadding, which is used by clients to produce a complete range of household and consumer products such as toilet paper, facial tissue, kitchen towels and serviettes. The production process converts paper from the printing operations into jumbo tissue wadding in a model of production efficiency. In the current year new acquisition, Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited, and start up company, Laduma Sport Proprietary Limited, have been included in the Other segment. They operate in the sports retail and i-Gaming industries respectively.

Revenue of approximately R889,9 million (2025: R967 million) is derived from a single external customer within the Print segment. The total revenue from external foreign customers is R135 million (2025: R135 million).

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

25. SEGMENTAL ANALYSIS (continued)

2026

	Print, Publishing and Distribution R'000	Packaging R'000	Education R'000	Other R'000	Eliminations R'000	Total R'000
External revenue	2 726 314	699 465	758 581	10 503	—	4 194 863
Inter-segmental revenue	70 198	—	—	—	(70 198)	—
Total revenue	2 796 512	699 465	758 581	10 503	(70 198)	4 194 863
Cost of sale of goods	(1 997 787)	(534 174)	(264 691)	(1 652)	57 325	(2 740 979)
Selling, general and administrative expenses	(626 560)	(55 894)	(211 592)	(8 573)	11 185	(891 435)
Other gains/(losses)	(2 134)	4 432	45	(18 518)	—	(16 175)
EBITDA	170 031	113 829	282 343	(18 240)	(1 688)	546 275
Depreciation	(52 980)	(24 751)	(4 260)	(220)	—	(82 211)
Amortisation	(12 634)	(235)	(108 208)	(75)	—	(121 151)
Operating profit	104 417	88 843	169 875	(18 535)	(1 688)	342 913
Finance income	30 956	4 699	17 624	2 728	—	56 006
Finance costs	(50 965)	(1 835)	14	(240)	—	(53 026)
Earnings from associates	(2 265)	26 426	—	(2 353)	—	21 808
Profit/(loss) before taxation	82 143	118 133	187 513	(18 400)	(1 688)	367 701
Additional disclosure						
Property, plant and equipment additions	99 418	15 020	5 493	685	—	120 616
Capital commitments	35 234	1 010	3 879	—	—	40 123
Impairment of assets	—	—	—	(19 995)	—	(19 995)
Staff costs	(526 025)	(104 232)	(108 531)	(4 420)	—	(743 208)
Amortisation on acquired intangibles	(9 355)	—	(85 682)	(75)	—	(95 112)
Gain on bargain purchase	309	—	—	1 477	—	1 786
Net impairment losses on financial assets	(12 056)	(54)	(6 092)	—	—	(18 202)
Distribution costs	(304 147)	—	(21 287)	—	—	(325 434)
Repairs and maintenance	(163 564)	(20 434)	(50 988)	(87)	11 185	(223 888)
Taxation	(12 821)	(31 666)	(51 036)	632	456	(94 435)
Investment in associates	38 210	328 316	—	—	—	366 526
Total assets	2 509 297	1 300 248	626 371	381 027	(896 770)	3 920 173
Total liabilities	644 805	679 658	204 097	724 451	(896 770)	1 356 241

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

25. SEGMENTAL ANALYSIS (continued)

The table below shows the relationship between the revenue streams disclosed in note 19 and the revenue disclosed per segment above:

Segment:	Print revenue R'000	Packaging revenue R'000	Educational revenue: Printed products R'000	Educational revenue: Digital products R'000	Publishing revenue R'000	Distribution revenue R'000	Waste revenue R'000	Other revenue R'000	Total R'000
Print, Publishing and Distribution	1 969 041	—	—	—	224 057	443 335	24 586	65 295	2 726 314
Packaging	—	670 466	—	—	—	17 088	—	11 911	699 465
Education	—	—	713 546	45 035	—	—	—	—	758 581
Other	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	10 503	10 503
	1 969 041	670 466	713 546	45 035	224 057	460 423	24 586	87 709	4 194 863
Expenses per the segment note:									
Cost of sale of goods									(2 740 979)
Selling, general and administrative expenses									(891 435)
Depreciation									(82 211)
Amortisation									(121 151)
									(3 835 775)
Expenses per the income statement:									
Cost of sales									(2 813 796)
Operating expenses									(1 021 979)
									(3 835 776)

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

25. SEGMENTAL ANALYSIS (continued)

2025

	Print, Publishing and Distribution R'000	Packaging R'000	Education R'000	Other R'000	Eliminations R'000	Total R'000
External revenue	2 552 324	736 916	925 718	7 387	—	4 222 345
Inter-segmental revenue	73 073	—	—	—	(73 073)	—
Total revenue	2 625 397	736 916	925 718	7 387	(73 073)	4 222 345
Cost of sale of goods	(1 946 426)	(572 741)	(338 827)	—	71 227	(2 786 767)
Selling, general and administrative expenses	(474 935)	(61 756)	(235 167)	(316)	—	(772 174)
Other gains/(losses)	17 368	8 935	(2 806)	3 737	—	27 234
EBITDA	221 405	111 354	348 918	10 808	(1 846)	690 639
Depreciation	(50 707)	(24 652)	(4 564)	(33)	—	(79 956)
Amortisation	(4 186)	(235)	(184 556)	—	—	(188 977)
Operating profit	166 513	86 467	159 798	10 775	(1 846)	421 707
Finance income	28 137	7 170	23 882	333	—	59 522
Finance costs	(41 938)	(9 316)	(182)	—	—	(51 436)
Earnings from associate	(332)	(7 268)	—	(9 760)	—	(17 360)
Net gain on investment in associate	—	51 192	—	—	—	51 192
Profit/(loss) before taxation	152 379	128 245	183 498	1 348	(1 846)	463 624
Additional disclosure:						
Property, plant and equipment additions	44 641	9 736	2 515	—	—	56 893
Capital commitments	15 355	233	—	—	—	15 588
Impairment of assets	—	—	(2 580)	—	—	(2 580)
Staff costs	(409 944)	(115 447)	(111 055)	—	—	(636 446)
Amortisation on acquired intangibles	(3 898)	—	(128 523)	—	—	(132 421)
Gain on bargain purchase	16 388	—	—	—	—	16 388
Net impairment losses on financial assets	(14 194)	(91)	(34 661)	—	—	(48 946)
Distribution costs	(129 005)	—	(27 762)	—	—	(156 767)
Repairs and maintenance	(105 460)	(23 202)	(19 819)	(356)	720	(148 117)
Taxation	(37 695)	(20 909)	(48 915)	(543)	498	(107 564)
Investment in associates	40 476	265 166	—	2 353	—	307 995
Total assets	2 726 161	1 267 071	619 436	281 897	(896 334)	3 998 231
Total liabilities	1 232 770	401 813	263 224	567 819	(896 334)	1 569 292

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

25. SEGMENTAL ANALYSIS (continued)

The table below shows the relationship between the revenue streams disclosed in note 19 and the revenue disclosed per segment above:

Segment:	Print revenue R'000	Packaging revenue R'000	Educational revenue: Printed products R'000	Educational revenue: Digital revenue R'000	Publishing revenue R'000	Distribution revenue R'000	Waste revenue R'000	Other revenue R'000	Total R'000
Print	2 181 337	—	—	—	85 563	223 461	23 573	38 390	2 552 324
Packaging	—	713 592	—	—	—	17 199	—	6 124	736 915
Education	—	—	850 092	70 470	—	—	—	5 156	925 718
Other	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	7 387	7 387
	2 181 337	713 592	850 092	70 470	85 563	240 660	23 573	57 057	4 222 344

Expenses per the segment note:

Cost of sale of goods	(2 786 767)
Selling, general and administrative expenses	(772 174)
Staff costs	(79 956)
Amortisation	(188 977)
	(3 827 873)

Expenses per the income statement:

Cost of sales	(2 895 529)
Operating expenses	(932 344)
	(3 827 873)

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

26. CASH GENERATED FROM OPERATIONS

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Profit before tax		367 701	463 624	174 195	156 687
Adjusted for:		218 754	239 281	(174 195)	(156 687)
Depreciation of property, plant and equipment	2	80 445	78 190	—	—
Depreciation of investment property	38	1 766	1 766	—	—
Amortisation of intangible assets	4	121 151	188 977	—	—
Impairment of loans	19	19 995	2 580	—	—
Profit/(loss) on disposal of property, plant and equipment	19	5 119	(639)	—	—
Gain on derecognition of lease	19	(131)	—	—	—
Gain on bargain purchase	19	(1 786)	(16 388)	—	—
Net gain on investment in associate	37	—	(51 192)	—	—
Bad debts written off	8	15 646	21 365	—	—
Finance income	21	(56 006)	(59 522)	—	—
Finance costs	22	59 872	58 383	5	13
Movement in provisions for inventory write-down	7	2 271	(9 713)	—	—
Long-service and retirement gratuity expense	20	4 440	(2 418)	—	—
Increase of bad debt provision/loss allowance	8	3 184	27 327	—	—
Share-based payment expense	20	—	483	—	—
Earnings from equity accounted associates	37	(21 808)	17 360	—	—
Dividends received	18	—	—	(174 200)	(156 700)
Foreign exchange movements	22	(6 846)	(6 947)	—	—
Other non-cash items		(8 558)	(10 331)	—	—
Changes in working capital		153 491	(144 335)	—	—
Inventories and product development assets		35 006	(115 005)	—	—
Trade and other receivables		215 712	(457 693)	—	—
Trade and other payables		(97 227)	428 363	—	—
		739 947	558 570	—	—

27. TAX PAID

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Receivable at the beginning of the year	3 348	19 173	—	—
Acquisition of subsidiary	309	—	—	—
Current tax for the year recognised in profit or loss	(117 614)	(137 632)	—	—
Net payable/(receivable) at the end of the year	586	(3 348)	—	—
	(113 371)	(121 807)	—	—

28.1 DIVIDENDS

Dividends declared by the Group during the year amounted to 55 cents per share (2025: 50 cents). The Board has approved a final dividend of 55 cents per share.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

28.2 DIVIDENDS PAID

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Dividends paid by Novus Holdings Limited	174 160	157 034	174 160	157 034
	174 160	157 034	174 160	157 034

Dividends paid by the Group excludes any dividends payable in respect of treasury shares. Dividends declared by the Group amounted to 55 cents per share during the financial year.

The Company declared dividends of R188,6 million, of which R174,2 million was paid externally. Total dividends distributed by the Company in the prior year amounted to R171,6 million, of which R157,0 million was paid externally.

29. RELATED PARTIES

The Group entered into transactions and has balances with related parties including its subsidiaries, directors and associates. Transactions that are eliminated on consolidation as well as profits or losses eliminated through application of the equity method are not included.

The balances and transactions with related parties are summarised below:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Related party balances				
Loans payable				
Subsidiary				
Novus Print Proprietary Limited	—	—	34 884	34 884
Novus Share Trust	—	—	21 630	10 581
Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited	—	—	12 747	9 205
Latiano 554 Proprietary Limited	—	—	16 533	16 533

The loans from Novus Print Proprietary Limited, Novus Holdings Share Trust, Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited and Latiano 554 Proprietary Limited are non-interest bearing and payable on demand.

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Loans receivable				
Associate				
Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited	—	18 571	—	—
	—	18 571	—	—

The loan to Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited is non-interest bearing and is payable on demand as at the end of the reporting period. The nature of the loan is deemed to be a shareholder's loan to fund initial working capital requirements of the associate. During the current year, an impairment evaluation of the receivable was performed, impairment indicators were identified and the loan was fully impaired. The impairment amounted to R19,9 million, after the loan balance increased by R1,4 million during the year.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

29. RELATED PARTIES (continued)

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Sales to related parties	—	—	—	—
	—	—	—	—
Rental income from related parties				
Associate				
Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited	7 387	7 387	—	—
	7 387	7 387	—	—
Purchases from related parties				
Companies in which directors have a significant interest				
Mr A van der Veen : Bytefuse Proprietary Limited (Associate of the Group)	12 550	8 795	—	—
Mr A van der Veen : Polymorph Systems Proprietary Limited	9 134	7 095	—	—

Directors emoluments 2026

	Executive R'000	Non- executive R'000	Total R'000
Salaries	13 779	—	13 779
Incentive bonuses	2 821	—	2 821
Pension contributions	716	—	716
Share Based Compensation	1 414	—	1 414
Fees for services as director	—	2 245	2 245
Total	18 731	2 245	20 975

The detail of directors' participation in share / SARs schemes is included in note 15.

The individual directors received the following remuneration and emoluments:

	Fees for services as director R'000	Salary R'000	Bonus and performance related payments R'000	Pension contributions R'000	Share Based Compensation R'000	Total R'000
Executive directors						
Mr A van der Veen	—	7 500	—	—	—	7 500
Ms K Alwar	—	2 804	1 155	275	1 135	5 369
Mr C Wright (resigned on 31 December 2025)	—	1 693	983	273	—	2 949
Ms K Julies	—	1 782	683	168	279	2 912
Non-executive directors						
Mr A Mayman	408	—	—	—	—	408
Ms M Mashologu	313	—	—	—	—	313
Dr L Botha	283	—	—	—	—	283
Ms P Mnisi	318	—	—	—	—	318
Mr A Zetler	924	—	—	—	—	924
	2 245	13 779	2 821	716	1 414	20 975

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

29. RELATED PARTIES (continued)

Directors emoluments 2025

	Executive R'000	Non- executive R'000	Total R'000
Salaries	11 129	—	11 129
Incentive bonuses	2 226	—	2 226
Pension contributions	738	—	738
Share Based Compensation	1 370	—	1 370
Fees for services as director	—	2 059	2 059
Total	15 463	2 059	17 522

The detail of directors' participation in share / SARs schemes is included in note 15.

The individual directors received the following remuneration and emoluments:

	Fees for services as director R'000	Salary R'000	Bonus and performance related payments R'000	Pension contributions R'000	Share Based Compensation R'000	Total R'000
Executive directors						
Mr A van der Veen	—	5 000	—	—	—	5 000
Ms K Alwar	—	2 697	1 088	264	352	4 401
Mr C Wright	—	2 170	786	350	1 018	4 324
Ms K Julies	—	1 262	352	124	—	1 738
Non-executive directors						
Mr A Mayman	374	—	—	—	—	374
Ms M Mashologu	287	—	—	—	—	287
Dr L Botha	222	—	—	—	—	222
Ms L Mtanga	328	—	—	—	—	328
Mr A Zetler	848	—	—	—	—	848
	2 059	11 129	2 226	738	1 370	17 522

Key management compensation

The total of executive directors' and key management emoluments amounted to R54 million (2025: R58,5 million); comprising short-term employee benefits of R51,9 million (2025: R53,8 million) and share-based payments of R2,1 million (2025: R4,6 million).

No other remuneration is paid to executive directors. Remuneration is earned for services rendered in conducting the business of the Group.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

30. COMMITMENTS

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
Authorised capital expenditure				
Already contracted for but not provided for				
- Property, plant and equipment	40 123	15 588	—	—

Commitments relate to approved capital expenditure on property, plant and equipment and future obligations under operating lease arrangements entered into by our Print, Packaging and Distribution segments.

31. FINANCIAL RISK MANAGEMENT

All of the Group's financial assets are carried at amortised cost, apart from derivatives, which are held for hedging purposes. Similarly, all of the Group's financial liabilities are carried at amortised cost apart from derivatives, which are held for hedging purposes. CFDs are classified as financial assets and they are measured at fair value through profit and loss. The CFDs are not held for hedging purposes.

Capital risk management

The Group's objectives when managing capital are to safeguard the Group's ability to continue as a going concern, so that it can continue to provide adequate returns for shareholders.

The Group manages its capital in proportion to risk. The Group manages the capital structure and makes adjustments to it in the light of changes in economic conditions and the risk characteristics of the underlying assets. In order to maintain or adjust the capital structure, the Group may adjust the amount of dividends paid to shareholders, return capital to shareholders, issue new shares, or sell assets to reduce debt. The Group does not have a formal targeted debt to equity ratio.

The Company is illiquid but solvent. Management considers this reasonable as the loans payable to related parties are not expected to be called upon. The Company relies upon distributions, including dividends, from its subsidiaries to generate the funds necessary to meet the obligations of the Company.

Financial risk factors

The Group's activities expose it to a variety of financial risks: liquidity risk, credit risk and market risk (including currency risk, interest rate risk and price risk).

The Group's overall risk management program focuses on the unpredictability of financial markets and seeks to minimise potential adverse effects on the Group's financial performance. The Group uses derivative financial instruments to hedge certain risk exposures. Risk management is carried out by a central treasury department (Group treasury) under policies approved by the directors. Group treasury identifies, evaluates and hedges financial risks in close co-operation with the Group's operating units. The directors provide written principles for overall risk management, as well as written policies covering specific areas, such as foreign exchange risk, interest rate risk, and credit risk, use of derivative financial instruments and non-derivative financial instruments, and investment of excess liquidity.

Liquidity risk

Prudent liquidity risk management implies maintaining sufficient cash and marketable securities, the availability of funding through an adequate amount of committed credit facilities and the ability to close out market positions. In terms of the Memorandum of Incorporation of the Group, no limitation is placed on its borrowing capacity. The facilities are held across Standard Bank, Investec Bank Limited, Mercantile and First National Bank.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

31. FINANCIAL RISK MANAGEMENT (continued)

The Group had the following unutilised borrowing facilities at 31 March:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Company 2026 R'000	Company 2025 R'000
On call	596 775	763 649	—	—
Unutilised borrowing facilities per segment:				
Print	581 719	732 420	—	—
Packaging	10 094	31 229	—	—
Other	4 962	—	—	—
Expiring within one year:				
	96 775	563 649	—	—
Standard Bank	59 181	53 586	—	—
Investec	30 000	478 834	—	—
Nedbank	—	—	—	—
First National Bank	1 500	—	—	—
Mercantile	6 094	31 229	—	—
Expiring beyond one year:				
	500 000	200 000	—	—
Standard Bank	250 000	—	—	—
Investec	250 000	200 000	—	—

The facilities expiring within one year are subject to renewal at various dates during the next year.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

31. FINANCIAL RISK MANAGEMENT (continued)

The following analysis details the Group and Company's non-derivative financial liabilities and derivative financial assets/ (liabilities) which will be settled on a gross basis, using working capital and unused credit facilities, into relevant maturity groupings based on the remaining period from the statement of financial position to the contractual maturity date. The amounts disclosed in the table are the contractual undiscounted cash flows. Balances due within 12 months equal their carrying balances as the impact of discounting is not significant.

Group	Carrying Amount R'000	Contractual cash flows R'000	0 to 12 months R'000	1 to 2 years R'000	Over 2 years R'000
Non-derivative financial liabilities					
At 31 March 2026					
Interest-bearing: Capitalised lease liabilities	19 672	21 159	15 792	4 254	1 113
Interest-bearing: Loans and other liabilities	359 260	443 779	106 364	99 526	237 889
Trade payables*	444 970	444 970	444 970	—	—
Accrued expenses and other current liabilities	198 956	198 956	198 956	—	—
	1 022 858	1 108 864	766 082	103 780	239 002

Group	Carrying Amount R'000	Contractual cash flows R'000	0 to 12 months R'000	1 to 2 years R'000	Over 2 years R'000
At 31 March 2025					
Interest-bearing: Capitalised lease liabilities	28 290	31 215	16 327	12 795	2 093
Interest-bearing: Loans and other liabilities	430 125	493 355	206 700	187 933	98 722
Trade payables*	556 073	556 073	556 073	—	—
Accrued expenses and other current liabilities	257 408	257 408	257 408	—	—
	1 271 896	1 338 051	1 036 508	200 728	100 815

* Trade payables are usually settled within a period of 1 to 4 months.

Company	Carrying Amount R'000	Contractual cash flows R'000	0 to 12 months R'000	1 to 2 years R'000	Over 2 years R'000
At 31 March 2026					
Related party balances	85 794	85 794	85 794	—	—
	85 794	85 794	85 794	—	—
At 31 March 2025					
Related party balances	71 203	71 203	71 203	—	—
	71 203	71 203	71 203	—	—

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

31. FINANCIAL RISK MANAGEMENT (continued)

Group	Carrying Amount R'000	Contractual cash flows R'000	0 to 12 months R'000	1 to 2 years R'000	Over 2 years R'000
Derivative financial assets/(liabilities)					
At 31 March 2026					
Forward exchange contracts					
- Outflow	5 252	—	—	—	—
- Inflow	—	—	—	—	—
	5 252	—	—	—	—
At 31 March 2025					
Forward exchange contracts					
- Outflow	—	—	—	—	—
- Inflow	—	—	—	—	—
	—	—	—	—	—

Credit risk

The Group is exposed to credit risk relating to the following assets:

Financial assets at FVOCI, financial assets at FVPL and financial assets at amortised cost

There is no concentration of credit risk within these financial assets and management monitors the credit risk regularly. No expected credit loss allowance has been raised on the financial assets at amortised cost due to payments being made as per contract with no historical write-offs relating to these assets.

Trade and other receivables

Trade receivables consist primarily of invoiced amounts from normal trading activities. Various credit checks are performed on new debtors to determine the quality of their credit history. These checks are also performed on existing debtors with long-overdue accounts. Furthermore, current debtors are monitored to ensure they do not exceed their credit limits on an ongoing basis. Consideration of credit risk across sectors and groups of customers are disclosed in note 8. Other receivables are assessed on a continuous basis to determine their risk of default. Management considers this risk to be low from the history of the counterparty settling its outstanding amounts by the due date and through monitoring of the sector that the counterparty operates in. Refer to note 1.8 and note 8 where the measurement and recognition of expected loss allowance on trade and other receivables is explained.

Cash deposits and derivative assets

The Group is exposed to certain concentrations of credit risk relating to its cash. It places its cash mainly with major banking groups and high-quality institutions that have high credit ratings. Cash is held to fund short-term working capital requirements. The Group's treasury policy is designated to limit exposure to any one institution and invests its excess cash in low-risk investment accounts. As at 31 March 2026 the Group held the majority of its cash, deposits and derivative assets with local banks with a "Ba2" (2025: "Ba2") credit rating (Moody's International's Long-term Deposit rating). The counter parties that are used by the Group are evaluated on a continuous basis.

Foreign exchange risk

The Group is exposed to foreign exchange risk arising from various currency exposures, primarily with respect to the Euro, British Pound, Namibian Dollar and the US Dollar. As the Group acquires a significant portion of the materials used in the printing process internationally, depreciation of the local currency against the Euro or US Dollar adversely affects the Group's earnings and its ability to meet cash obligations. Management has set up a policy to manage their foreign exchange risk against their functional currency. The Group companies are required to hedge their foreign exchange risk exposure with the Group treasury. To manage their foreign exchange risk arising from future commercial transactions and recognised assets and liabilities, entities in the Group use forward exchange contracts ("FECs"), transacted with financial institutions. Foreign exchange risk arises when future commercial transactions or recognised assets or liabilities are denominated in a currency that is not the entity's functional currency.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

31. FINANCIAL RISK MANAGEMENT (continued)

Forward exchange contract transactions relate to the settlement of trade payables for the acquisition of inventory items. The Group covers forward for up to a maximum of one year on firm commitments. At year-end the Group had an open FEC within the Print segment. In the prior year, there were no open FECS due to the ZAR trading in a narrow band. FECs are taken out between order date and 6 months prior to the order being placed and inventory on average is delivered within 3 months. Once the inventory is shipped, trade payables is settled between 1 and 4 months.

The Group has classified its FECs relating to forecast transactions and firm commitments as cash flow hedges and states them at fair value.

The Group separates the forward element and the spot price element of a forward exchange contract. The forward element is accounted for in finance income/costs (refer to notes 21 and 22). The spot price element is designated as the hedging instrument in a cash flow hedge, with the cumulative gain or loss recognised in the initial carrying amount of inventory and therefore recognised in cost of goods sold when the inventory is sold. Refer to note 20 for amounts recognised in cost of goods sold.

Hedge effectiveness is determined at the inception of the hedge relationship, and through periodic prospective effectiveness assessments, to ensure that an economic relationship exists between the hedged item and hedging instrument. A cumulative after-tax profit of R 17 million (2025: Nil) has been deferred in a hedging reserve at 31 March 2026. This amount is expected to realise over the next year. Changes in the fair value of FECs that economically hedge monetary liabilities in foreign currencies and for which no hedge accounting is applied, are recognised in the income statement. Both the changes in fair value of the forward contracts and the foreign exchange gains and losses relating to the monetary items are recognised in profit and loss within the cost of sales, finance income and finance costs lines. The fair value of all FECs at 31 March 2026 was R5,2 million (2025: Nil).

The notional principal amounts of the outstanding FECs for import purchases and export sales transactions at 31 March 2026 were R5,2 million (2025: Nil).

There were no forecast purchases linked to FECs that were no longer considered highly probable. The hedged highly probable forecast transactions denominated in foreign currency are expected to occur at various dates during the next 12 months.

At 31 March 2026, if the currency had weakened/strengthened by 10% against the US dollar and Euro with all other variables held constant, comprehensive income for the year would have been R2,2 million (2025: R2,6 million) higher/lower due to Euro exposure and R2,7 million (2025: R4,5 million) higher/lower due to US dollar exposure, mainly as a result of foreign exchange gains or losses on translation of US dollar and Euro denominated foreign exchange contracts.

The Group's exposure to foreign currency risk at the end of the reporting period was as follows:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Trade payables, denominated in Euro	319	1 912
Trade payables, Rand value	5 964	36 899
Trade payables, denominated in US dollars	46	3 488
Trade payables, Rand value	793	65 116
Trade payables, denominated in Great British Pound	116	132
Trade payables, Rand value	2 678	3 104

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

31. FINANCIAL RISK MANAGEMENT (continued)

Total FECs outstanding at year end (commitments to buy foreign exchange maturing within one year)

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Total FECs outstanding at year-end (maturing within one year)		
Denominated in Euro		
Rand Value	2 158	—
Denominated in US Dollars		
Rand Value	3 095	—
Hedge ratio	1:1	1:1

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Derivative financial assets — Current portion		
Foreign exchange contracts	5 252	—
	5 252	—
Derivative financial liabilities — Current portion		
Foreign exchange contracts	—	—
	—	—

	R	R
Average forward exchange rates for FECS outstanding at year-end (maturing within one year)		
Euro	18,97	—
US Dollar	16,12	—

	R	R
Exchange rates used for conversion of foreign items were:		
Euro	19,61	19,78
US Dollar	17,09	18,30
British Pound	22,58	—
Namibian Dollar	1,00	—

The Group reviews its foreign currency exposure, including commitments on an ongoing basis. The Group expects its foreign exchange contracts to hedge foreign exchange exposure.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

31. FINANCIAL RISK MANAGEMENT (continued)

Interest rate risk

During prior years the Group entered into a funding agreement due to the acquisition of its subsidiary, Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited and obtained funding amounting to R500 million with a weighted average year-end interest rate: 10,48% linked to 3 months JIBAR. The Group also has a policy in place to reduce this risk should the need arise for future external borrowings. A refinancing arrangement was concluded whereby the above term loans were settled and replaced with a new R400 million term loan. The term loan is held jointly with Investec and The Standard Bank of South Africa Limited (Standard Bank). The loan is repayable over 5 years at an interest rate of JIBAR + 2,3%. As part of the refinancing arrangement, an increased revolving credit facility of R500 million has been made available at an interest rate of JIBAR + 2,45%.

The Group would manage this process by ensuring a mix between fixed and floating borrowings, the interest rate characteristics of new borrowings and the refinancing of existing borrowings are positioned according to expected movements in interest rates. Where appropriate, the Group would consider the use of derivative instruments, such as interest rate swap agreements, purely for hedging purposes. There has however been no swap agreements entered into during the financial year.

At 31 March 2026, if the Group's interest rates on Rand-denominated borrowings had been 1% higher/lower with all other variables held constant, post-tax profit for the year would have been R3,6 million (2025: R2,6 million) lower/higher, mainly as a result of higher/lower interest expense on floating rate borrowings.

Price risk

The Group is exposed to price risk in relation to its investment in CFDs acquired during the current financial period.

The directors provide written principles for overall risk management, as well as written policies covering specific areas, such as price risk over these types of investments.

At 31 March 2026, if the underlying securities to which the CFDs relate value fluctuated by 1% higher/lower with all other variables held constant, there would be no material change to post-tax profit for the year due to the fair value gain or loss recognised thereon.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

32. FAIR VALUE ESTIMATION OF FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS

The fair values, which approximate the carrying values, net gains and losses recognised in profit and loss, total interest income, total interest expense, and impairment of each class of financial instrument are as follows:

31 March 2026

	Group			
	Carrying value R'000	Net gains/(losses) recognised in profit and loss R'000	Total interest income R'000	Impairment R'000
Assets				
Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income	3 005	—	—	—
Other financial assets at amortised cost	3 434	—	68	—
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss	36 208	3 128	—	—
Receivables and loans	678 119	—	1	18 202
Trade receivables	604 332	—	1	18 202
Other receivables	73 787	—	—	—
Related party receivables	—	—	—	—
Derivative financial instruments	5 252	17 019	—	—
Foreign exchange contracts	5 252	17 019	—	—
Cash and cash deposits	1 017 140	—	55 844	—
Total	1 743 158	20 147	55 913	18 202
	Carrying value R'000	Net gains/(losses) recognised in profit and loss R'000	Total interest expense R'000	Impairment R'000
Liabilities				
Long-term liabilities	289 000	—	43 321	—
Interest-bearing: lease liabilities	5 006	—	2 625	—
Interest-bearing: loans and other	283 994	—	40 696	—
Short-term payables and loans	891 451	(11 768)	303	—
Interest-bearing: lease liabilities	14 666	—	—	—
Interest-bearing: loans and other	75 265	—	—	—
Trade payables	444 970	(11 768)	303	—
Accrued expenses and other current liabilities	356 550	—	—	—
Derivatives	—	—	—	—
Foreign exchange contracts	—	—	—	—
Bank overdrafts and call loans	1	—	9 946	—
Total	1 180 452	(11 768)	53 570	—

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

32. FAIR VALUE ESTIMATION OF FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS (continued)

The fair values, together with the carrying values, net gains and losses recognised in profit and loss, total interest income, total interest expense, and impairment of each class of financial instrument are as follows:

31 March 2025

	Group			
	Carrying value R'000	Net gains/(losses) recognised in profit and loss R'000	Total interest income R'000	Impairment R'000
Assets				
Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income	3 019	—	—	—
Bank overdrafts	4 745	—	38	2 580
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss	19 033	7 441	—	—
Receivables and loans	931 536	—	140	48 946
Trade receivables	849 586	—	140	48 946
Other receivables	63 379	—	—	—
Related party receivables	18 571	—	—	—
Derivative financial instruments	—	1 933	—	—
Foreign exchange contracts	—	1 933	—	—
Cash and cash deposits	812 254	—	57 796	—
Total	1 770 587	9 374	57 974	51 526

	Carrying value R'000	Net gains/(losses) recognised in profit and loss R'000	Total interest expense R'000	Impairment R'000
Liabilities				
Long-term liabilities	275 681	—	48 239	—
Interest-bearing: lease liabilities	14 024	—	2 579	—
Interest-bearing: loans and other	261 657	—	45 660	—
Short-term payables and loans	996 214	5 013	7 362	—
Interest-bearing: lease liabilities	14 266	—	—	—
Interest-bearing: loans and other	168 468	—	—	—
Trade payables	556 073	5 013	1 359	—
Accrued expenses and other current liabilities	257 408	—	6 003	—
Derivatives	—	—	—	—
Foreign exchange contracts	—	—	—	—
Bank overdrafts and call loans	—	—	2 741	—
Total	1 271 895	5 013	58 342	—

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

32. FAIR VALUE ESTIMATION OF FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS (continued)

The fair value levels of hierarchy are as follows:

Level 1 fair value measurements are those derived from quoted prices (unadjusted) in active markets for identical assets or liabilities.

Level 2 fair value measurements are those derived from inputs other than quoted prices included within level 1 that are observable for the asset or liability, either directly (i.e. as prices) or indirectly (i.e. derived from prices). The fair value of financial instruments that are not traded in an active market (for example, derivatives such as interest rate swaps, foreign exchange contracts and certain options) is determined through valuation techniques. These valuation techniques maximise the use of observable market data where it is available and rely as little as possible on entity specific estimates. If all significant inputs required to fair value an instrument are observable, the instrument is included in level 2.

Level 3 fair value measurements are those derived from valuation techniques that include inputs for the asset or liability that are not based on observable market data (unobservable inputs).

At 31 March 2026

	Group			
	Level 1 R'000	Level 2 R'000	Level 3 R'000	Total R'000
Assets				
Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income	4	3 001	—	3 005
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss	36 208	—	—	36 208
Derivative financial instruments*	—	5 252	—	5 252
Related party loan receivables**	—	—	—	—
	36 212	8 253	—	44 465
Liabilities				
Derivative financial instruments*	—	—	—	—
	—	—	—	—

At 31 March 2025

	Group			
	Level 1 R'000	Level 2 R'000	Level 3 R'000	Total R'000
Assets				
Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income	1	3 018	—	3 019
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss	19 033	—	—	19 033
Derivative financial instruments*	—	—	—	—
Related party loan receivables**	—	—	18 571	18 571
	19 034	3 018	18 571	40 623
Liabilities				
Derivative financial instruments*	—	—	—	—
	—	—	—	—

There have been no transfers between levels in the current and prior year.

* Financial assets/liabilities carried at fair value.

** Financial assets/liabilities measured at amortised cost and included in the above table for fair value disclosure.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

32. FAIR VALUE ESTIMATION OF FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS (continued)

Valuation techniques and key inputs used to measure significant level 2 fair values

Derivative financial instruments (foreign exchange contracts) - in measuring the fair value of foreign exchange contracts the Group makes use of market observable quotes of forward foreign exchange rates on instruments that have a maturity similar to the maturity profile of the Group's foreign exchange contracts. Key inputs used in measuring the fair value of foreign exchange contracts include current spot exchange rates, market forward exchange rates, and the term of the Group's foreign exchange contracts.

Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income - the use of quoted market prices for similar instruments.

Valuation techniques and key inputs used to measure significant level 3 fair values

Related party loan receivables - the loan is carried at amortised cost which approximates fair value. Fair value was determined based on the use of unobservable inputs including counterparty credit risk.

Price risk

The Group is not exposed to significant price risk in relation to its financial assets at fair value through profit or loss. Refer to note 31 for foreign exchange risk management in relation to foreign exchange contracts.

33. FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS BY CATEGORY

Financial instruments disclosed in the statement of financial position include interest-bearing borrowings, financial assets, cash and cash equivalents, trade and other receivables and trade and other payables.

The following is a summary of financial instrument categories applicable to the Group:

Financial assets

	Notes	Financial assets at amortised cost R'000	Fair value through profit or loss R'000	Financial assets at FVOCI R'000	Total R'000
2026					
Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income		—	—	3 005	3 005
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss		—	36 208	—	36 208
Other financial assets at amortised cost		3 434	—	—	3 434
Trade and other receivables	8	678 119	—	—	678 119
Derivative financial instruments		—	—	5 252	5 252
Cash and cash equivalents		1 017 140	—	—	1 017 140
		1 698 693	36 208	8 257	1 743 158
2025					
Financial assets at fair value through other comprehensive income		—	—	3 019	3 019
Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss		—	19 033	—	19 033
Other financial assets at amortised cost		4 745	—	—	4 745
Trade and other receivables	8	912 965	—	—	912 965
Related party receivables		18 571	—	—	18 571
Cash and cash equivalents		812 254	—	—	812 254
		1 748 535	19 033	3 019	1 770 587

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

33. FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS BY CATEGORY (continued)

Financial liabilities

	Financial liabilities at amortised cost R'000	Fair value through profit or loss R'000	Financial assets at FVOCI R'000	Total R'000
2026				
Borrowings and lease liabilities	378 931	—	—	378 931
Trade and other payables	801 520	—	—	801 520
	1 180 451	—	—	1 180 451
2025				
Borrowings and lease liabilities	458 415	—	—	458 415
Trade and other payables	813 480	—	—	813 480
	1 271 895	—	—	1 271 895

34. GOING CONCERN

As at 31 March 2026, the Company has current assets amounting to R0,2 million (2025: R0,1 million) and current liabilities amounting to R85,8 million (2025: R71,2 million) resulting in an illiquid position. The current loan payable relates to dividends declared during the current year to subsidiaries within the Group, which is not expected to be called upon, but it is the intention that future dividend distributions from the subsidiary companies would be used as repayment of the related party loan payables. Due to this, it has been concluded that the Company will continue as a going concern.

The Group has experienced a decline in profitability during the current year compared to the prior year. This decrease was primarily driven by a significant increase in selling, general and administrative expenses in the Print, Publishing and Distribution segment following the acquisition of businesses (Novus Media Proprietary Limited, Novus Sport Proprietary Limited and On the Dot Supply Chain Management Proprietary Limited) in the prior year, with only a slight increase in revenues. The acquired businesses were included in the Group's results for a full 12 month period in the current year, compared to only 5 months in the prior year.

The directors believe that the Group has adequate financial resources to continue in operation for the foreseeable future and accordingly the annual financial statements have been prepared on a going concern basis. The directors have satisfied themselves that the Group is in a sound financial position and that it has access to sufficient borrowing facilities to meet its foreseeable cash requirements. As at 31 March 2026, the Group is in a strong liquidity position with a positive closing cash balance of R1,017 billion (2025: R812,2 million) and unutilised short and medium-term borrowing facilities of R596,7 million (2025: R763,6 million). The directors are not aware of any new material changes that may adversely impact the Group and are satisfied that no material uncertainty exists that might cast significant doubt on the entity's ability to continue as a going concern. The directors are also not aware of any material non-compliance with statutory or regulatory requirements or of any pending changes to legislation which may affect the Group.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

35. DIRECTORS' INTERESTS IN SHARE CAPITAL AND TRANSACTIONS

Other than as disclosed in notes 15 and 29 no director of the Company nor any director of any of its subsidiaries has or had any beneficial interest, directly or indirectly, in any transaction which is, or was, material to the business of Novus Holdings Limited and which was effected by Novus Holdings Limited during the current financial year or the immediately preceding financial year or in respect of any previous financial year which remains in any respect outstanding or unperformed.

The below directors have direct and indirect interests in Novus Holdings Limited ordinary shares on 31 March 2026 as at date of issue of these annual financial statements. Detail of directors' participation in share / SARs schemes is included in note 15.

Directors interests in shares

As at 31 March 2026

	Direct	Indirect*	Total
Executive			
- A van der Veen**	—	209 526 689	209 526 689
- A van der Veen***	—	2 513 558	2 513 558
- C Wright	67 380	—	67 380
- K Alwar	122 917	—*	122 917
- K Julies	—	—*	—
Non-executive			
- A Zetler**	148	209 526 689	209 526 837
- M Mashologu***	—	10 700 298	10 700 298
Total	190 445	222 740 545	222 930 990

* Unexercised options held by executive directors in terms of the Company's share appreciation rights scheme, on the basis that one option does not equal one Novus Holdings Limited Share, which do not carry economic or voting rights.

** Indirect shareholding held collectively by directors through the same investment company.

*** Indirect shareholding held independently.

There have been no further changes in the directors' shareholdings from the year end to the date of this report.

Directors interests in shares

As at 31 March 2025

	Direct	Indirect*	Total
Executive			
- A van der Veen**	—	209 526 689	209 526 689
- A van der Veen***	—	2 513 558	2 513 558
- C Wright	67 380	—	67 380
- K Alwar	41 515	261 480*	302 995
- K Julies	—	74 844*	74 844
Non-executive			
- A Zetler**	148	209 526 689	209 526 837
- M Mashologu***	—	10 700 298	10 700 298
Total	109 043	223 076 869	223 185 912

* Unexercised options held by executive directors in terms of the Company's share appreciation rights scheme, on the basis that one option does not equal one Novus Share, which do not carry economic or voting rights.

** Indirect shareholding held collectively by directors through the same investment company.

*** Indirect shareholding held independently.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

36. BUSINESS COMBINATION AND ACQUISITIONS OF CONTROLLED STRUCTURED ENTITIES

Effective 04 March 2026, Novus Holdings Limited's 50,1% held subsidiary, Novus Brand Collective Proprietary Limited, acquired 100% of Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited. This results in the Group obtaining a 50,1% shareholding in the company. The purchase consideration for the business was R4 million. The acquisition creates synergies within the Group's existing sports related operations.

The fair value of the assets and liabilities recognised as a result of the acquisition are as follows:

	Note	Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited 2026 R'000
Property, plant and equipment	2	1 923
Inventory		3 868
Other intangible assets		2 614
Trade and other payables		1 360
Trade and other receivables		(790)
Cash and cash equivalents		1 996
Deferred tax		(23)
Net identifiable assets acquired		10 948
Less: non - controlling interests		(5 463)
Net assets acquired		5 485
Gain on bargain purchase		(1 477)
Purchase consideration		4 008
Purchase consideration consist of:		
Cash consideration paid		(4 008)
		(4 008)
Cash in entity acquired		1 996
Net cash outflow per statement of cash flows		(2 012)

Gain on bargain purchase recognised

Gain on bargain purchase of R1,4 million was recognised on the acquisition of Spanish Sportswear due to the purchase consideration paid being less than the fair value of the net assets acquired.

Intangible assets

During the year, the Joma brand was recognised. The Joma brand is a well-established international sportswear brand with strong market recognition globally, ranking as the fourth-largest football teamwear supplier in the world. Refer to note 4.

Revenue and profit contribution

On a stand-alone basis, Spanish Sportswear contributed external revenue of R3,1 million and after tax loss of R0,8 million to the Group for the period 01 March 2026 to 31 March 2026.

If the acquisition had occurred on 01 April 2025, the contribution to Group consolidated pro-forma revenue and after tax loss for the year ended 31 March 2026 would have been R21,2 million and -R5,8 million respectively.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

36. BUSINESS COMBINATION AND ACQUISITIONS OF CONTROLLED STRUCTURED ENTITIES (continued)

Effective 01 July 2025, it has been determined that Novus Holdings Limited has obtained control over The Novus Foundation, a charitable trust initially founded by Maskew Miller Longman Proprietary Limited, a dormant subsidiary of Novus Holdings Limited subsidiary, Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited. Changes in the strategic management and underlying trust deed have resulted in the Group obtaining control. The assessment of control is based on IFRS 10: Consolidated Financial Statements, however the transaction itself does not meet the requirements of IFRS 3: Business Combinations. Therefore, the transaction has been accounted for as a controlled structured entity and the carrying values of the assets and liabilities at the date of control are considered the fair value due to the nature of the assets.

The carrying value of the assets and liabilities recognised as a result of the transaction are as follows:

	Note	The Novus Foundation 2026 R'000
Property, plant and equipment	2	126
Trade and other payables		(1 036)
Cash and cash equivalents		46 244
Net identifiable assets acquired		45 334
Net assets acquired		45 334
Constructive obligation recognised at acquisition		(4 800)
Non-controlling interest		(40 534)
Purchase consideration		—
Cash in entity acquired		46 244
Net cash inflow per statement of cash flows		46 244

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

37. INVESTMENT IN ASSOCIATES

The following information relates to the Group's financial interest in associates.

Bytefuse Proprietary Limited has a 30 April year-end, Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited has a 28 February year-end and Mustek Limited has a 30 June year-end. All associates are incorporated in South Africa. Associates are accounted for using the equity method.

Name of company	Nature of business	Effective interest 2026 %	Effective interest 2025 %	Group Carrying Amount 2026 R'000	Group Carrying Amount 2025 R'000
Bytefuse Proprietary Limited	Artificial Intelligence Technology	48,58	48,58	38 211	40 476
Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited	Tissue manufacturing	42,00	42,00	—	2 353
Mustek Limited	Information and Communications Technology	39,96	35,07	328 315	265 166
				366 526	307 995

	Bytefuse Proprietary Limited		Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited		Mustek Limited	
	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Opening balance	40 476	—	2 353	13 787	265 166	—
Purchase of investment in associate	—	40 808	—	—	36 723	221 242
Equity accounted (loss)/earnings	(2 265)	(332)	(2 353)	(9 760)	26 426	(7 268)
Day 1 gain on acquisition of associate	—	—	—	—	—	388 559
Impairment of associate	—	—	—	—	—	(337 367)
Partial disposal of shares	—	—	—	(1 674)	—	—
Closing balance	38 211	40 476	—	2 353	328 315	265 166

Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited was accounted for as an investment in associate on 01 October 2020 when the Group lost control of Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited after it disposed of 51% of its shares in the Company. The investment in Mthembu Paper Mill was recognised at R19,2 million on 01 October 2020. No impairment was considered necessary for the investment in Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited in the prior year or current year. In the prior year, effective 31 May 2024, the Group proportionately disposed of 7 of its 49 shares held in Mthembu Paper Mill to Mthembu Tissue Converting Proprietary Limited for R5,4 million. This resulted in the Groups shareholding decreasing to 42%.

In the prior year, effective 01 May 2024, the Group purchased a stake in Bytefuse Proprietary Limited, a company that develops machine learning and artificial intelligence technology for application in various fields, for a cost of R40,8million. The purchase consideration of R40,8 million comprises a cash component of R30 million paid, as well as 2 513 558 Novus Holdings Limited shares to the value of R10,8 million. The Group owns 48.58% of the ordinary shares.

The purchase agreement also provides for an option (expiring 01 May 2026) to purchase additional ordinary shares and investor preference shares for R20 million within two years after the effective date of the transaction. The option, if exercised would result in the Group holding 58,8% of the ordinary shares. Significant judgement was involved in assessing whether the potential voting rights attached to these option shares are substantive in accordance with IFRS 10, as Bytefuse is currently in a loss-making position and the valuation of the option is highly sensitive to changes in the inputs into the model. Management has assessed that these option shares do not give substantive rights to the Group and therefore the Group does not control Bytefuse.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

37. INVESTMENT IN ASSOCIATES (continued)

In the prior year, the Group acquired 35,07% of the issued share capital of Mustek Limited ("Mustek"). As a result, the Group made a mandatory offer to the remaining shareholders, on the terms and conditions set out in the firm intention announcement published on the Stock Exchange News Service ("SENS") on 15 November 2024. Refer to note 41.

In the current year, a further 2 814 069 shares were purchased, resulting in the Group holding 39.96% of the issued share capital of Mustek. The investment has been accounted for as an investment in associate at cost, with earnings being equity accounted. The Group has used annual and interim financial statements, as published, from the associate as at 30 June 2025 and 31 December 2025 respectively, as financial statements for the same reporting period as the Group are not available. This time lag does not exceed three months in accordance with paragraph 33 of IAS 28: Investments in associates and joint ventures.

In the prior year, an at acquisition gain of R388,6 million was recognised in terms of paragraph 32 of IAS 28, being the difference between the cost of the investment and the Group's share of the net fair value of the identifiable assets and liabilities at acquisition. This adjustment was based on the provisional purchase price allocation accounting performed in terms of IFRS 3, pursuant to the mandatory offer made, which is subject to finalisation within a 12 month period from the effective date at which the Group gains control of Mustek. Subsequently, at 31 March 2025, the investment in associate was impaired by R337,4 million in terms IAS36: Impairment of Assets as the carrying value of the investment exceeds the recoverable amount determined in reference to its market value. This was presented as a net gain on investment in associate of R51,1 million.

The summarised financial information for Bytefuse Proprietary Limited at 31 March is set out below:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Summarised statement of financial position		
Non-current assets	24 604	29 730
Current assets	3 224	10 132
Non-current liabilities	—	720
Current liabilities	1 326	491
Net assets as at 31 March 2026	26 502	38 651
Summarised statement of comprehensive income		
Revenue	11 812	7 963
Loss for the period	(4 662)	(936)
Reconciliation to carrying amount:		
Opening net assets	38 651	—
Net assets at acquisition	—	39 587
Loss for the period	(4 662)	(936)
Other	(7 487)	—
Closing net assets	26 502	38 651
Group's direct interest in associate (at year-end)	48,58%	48,58%
Group's interest in opening net assets	18 899	—
Group's share of net assets at acquisition	—	19 231
Equity accounted losses	(2 265)	(332)
Group's interest in closing net assets	16 634	18 899
Goodwill on acquisition	21 577	21 577
Carrying value of investment (at year-end)	38 211	40 476

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

37. INVESTMENT IN ASSOCIATES (continued)

The summarised financial information for Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited at 31 March is set out below:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Summarised statement of financial position		
Non-current assets	108 677	106 449
Current assets	51 433	61 746
Non-current liabilities	100 797	104 777
Current liabilities	54 526	46 480
Net assets as at 31 March 2026	4 787	16 938
Summarised statement of comprehensive income		
Revenue	340 132	336 015
Loss for the period	(12 151)	(22 535)
Reconciliation to carrying amount:		
Opening net assets	16 938	39 473
Loss for the period	(12 151)	(22 535)
Closing net assets	4 787	16 938
Group's direct interest in associate (at year-end)	42%	42%
Group's interest in opening net assets	9 582	19 342
Equity accounted losses	(2 353)	(9 760)
Group's interest in closing net assets	7 229	9 582
Partial disposal of shares	—	(1 674)
Fair value gain at acquisition	(5 544)	(5 544)
Losses not accounted for	(2 751)	—
Other	1 066	(11)
Carrying value of investment (at year-end)	—	2 353

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

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37. INVESTMENT IN ASSOCIATES (continued)

The summarised financial information for Mustek Limited at 31 December is set out below:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Summarised statement of financial position		
Non-current assets	576 735	623 795
Current assets	3 620 570	3 736 019
Non-current assets held for sale	8 750	—
Non-current liabilities	125 908	96 214
Current liabilities	2 493 318	2 732 720
Net assets as at 31 December 2025	1 586 829	1 530 880
Summarised statement of comprehensive income		
Revenue	7 097 689	348 662
Profit/(loss) for the period 1 January 2025 - 31 December 2025	66 176	(20 723)
Reconciliation to carrying amount:		
Opening net assets	1 530 880	—
Net assets at acquisition	—	1 551 603
Profit/(loss) for the period 1 January 2025 - 31 December 2025	66 176	(20 723)
Other	(10 227)	—
Closing net assets	1 586 829	1 530 880
Group's direct interest in associate (at year-end)	39,96%	35,07%
Group's interest in opening net assets	529 612	—
Group's share of net assets at acquisition	—	536 880
Equity accounted profits/(losses)	26 426	(7 268)
Group's interest in closing net assets	556 038	529 612
Fair value adjustments on identifiable net assets	72 922	72 922
Impairment losses	(337 367)	(337 367)
Purchase of additional shares	36 723	—
Carrying value of investment (at year-end)	328 315	265 166

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

38. INVESTMENT PROPERTY

	Notes	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Opening balance		58 785	60 551
Depreciation	20	(1 766)	(1 766)
Closing balance		57 019	58 785
Cost		66 326	66 326
Accumulated depreciation and impairment		(9 307)	(7 541)

Investment property relates to property situated in Kwazulu Natal where the Group's previous subsidiary Correll Tissue operated, which is now occupied by Mthembu Paper Mill Proprietary Limited.

The Group entered into a sale agreement for its Investment Property (refer to note 41) on 17 March 2026. The property's sale was contingent to fulfilment or waiver of certain conditions which were fulfilled by 30 April 2026. The fair value of the property is considered to be R85 million based on this sale agreement.

Rental income of R7,4 million (2025: R7,3 million) was recognised related to the property. All property related costs are on charged to the lessee.

39. FINANCIAL ASSETS AT FAIR VALUE THROUGH PROFIT AND LOSS

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Opening balance	19 033	13 678
Additions	17 175	5 355
Fair value adjustments	3 128	7 441
Reclassification to other assets*	(3 128)	(7 441)
Closing balance	36 208	19 033

Fair value through profit or loss financial assets include the following:

Listed entities:

Instruments in the form of Contracts for Differences ("CFDs")	36 208	19 033
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Financial assets at fair value through profit or loss includes the Group's strategic investments in listed entities that are held for trading, are classified at fair value through profit or loss and are therefore classified as current.

* Fair value gains/(losses) on the CFDs are capitalised against funds available for trading and immediately available for withdrawal. Subsequently this has been reclassified to cash equivalents.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

40. NON-CONTROLLING INTERESTS

Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited

Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited ("MML"), a 75% owned subsidiary of the Group, has a material non-controlling interest. The 10 742 ordinary shares held by Novus Print Proprietary Limited translates to 75% voting rights and 94% economic rights (refer to note 5).

On 30 November 2022, the Group recognised non-controlling interests in MML at the non-controlling interest's proportionate share (3,23%) of the acquired entity's net identifiable assets. In addition to this, the equity settled share-based payment recorded in the books of MML was also recognised as non-controlling interest in the statement of financial position, with a fair value of R32,4 million.

In 2016 Sphere RB Investments Proprietary Limited ("Sphere"), subscribed for 22.5% of MML's equity shares via 326 ordinary shares for cash of R49,927,928 and 2,897 AE Shares in cash for R29 and the balance of the purchase price for the AE Shares was funded via a Notional Acquisition Funding Amount ("NAFA") of R443,684,685 (together comprising 22.5% of MML's total equity shares). The subscription of the AE Shares is in effect a share option scheme via a non-recourse loan. As the subscription of the ordinary and AE Shares and the provision of the notional funding took place at the same time, the transactions have the same counterparties, they relate to the same risk and there is no economic need or substantive business purpose for structuring the transactions separately, the two transactions were viewed as one and the substance of the transaction is that of an option issued.

MML accounted for a cash settled share-based payment liability as a result of the acquisition by Sphere of the 22,5% of MML's equity shares initially. By way of the Deed of Adherence entered into on 12 August 2022 and as part of the Proposed Acquisition, Sphere agreed to waive its rights pertaining to this option from the signature date of such document, being 09 August 2022. This resulted in a modification of the cash settled share-based payment to an equity settled share-based payment within the records of MML. The equity settled share-based payment was recognised as non-controlling interest in the statement of financial position.

	R'000
Reconciliation of non-controlling interest recognised at acquisition:	
Non-controlling interest share of the net identifiable assets and liabilities at acquisition (3,23%)	32 539
Sphere's 22,5% interest in Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited	32 477
	65 016

Effective 14 March 2023, there was an increase in the non-controlling interests shareholding from 3,23% to 5,99% in Maskew Miller Learning Proprietary Limited via a repurchase of 326 accelerated empowerment shares and the subsequent issue of 326 ordinary shares for a consideration amount of R3,3 million.

Sphere holds 2 571 AE shares in MML which gives them 22.5% voting rights. These AE shares are subject to a notional vendor funding arrangement and will become economically equivalent to ordinary shares including dividend rights once the NAFA is repaid. Refer to note 24 for the impact of the future conversion on EPS and HEPS for the Group.

Novus Brand Collective Proprietary Limited Proprietary Limited

On 04 March 2026, the Group recognised non-controlling interests in Novus Brand Collective Proprietary Limited at the non-controlling interest's proportionate share (49,9%) of the entity's net identifiable assets, being those acquired through the acquisition of 100% of Spanish Sportswear Proprietary Limited.

Laduma Sport Proprietary Limited

On 20 January 2026, the Group recognised non-controlling interests in Laduma Sport Proprietary Limited at the non-controlling interest's proportionate share (26%) of the entity's net identifiable assets.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

40. NON-CONTROLLING INTERESTS (continued)

During the current year, movements in the non-controlling interest were as follows:

	Group 2026 R'000	Group 2025 R'000
Opening balance	14 562	33 975
Minority interests' proportionate share in profit for the year	7 147	8 089
Dividends paid to minorities	(13 870)	(27 502)
Acquisition of minorities	5 266	—
Acquisition of minorities in controlled structures	40 534	—
Closing balance	53 639	14 562

Summarised financial information of MML is presented in note 25 of the Notes to the Annual Financial Statements under the Education segment.

41. EVENTS AFTER REPORTING DATE

During the prior financial year, the Company acquired more than 35% of all the issued share capital of Mustek Limited. Accordingly, Novus proceeded to make a mandatory offer on 30 May 2025, as required in terms of section 123 of the Companies Act, 71 of 2008 ("Companies Act") read with the Regulations published in terms of the Companies Act ("Takeover Regulations") to acquire all of the shares of Mustek Limited not already beneficially held by Novus, or any of its related and concert parties. The offer process has been placed on hold pending formal confirmation by the Takeover Special Committee (TSC) to increase the cash offer to R15,41 per Mustek share, up from the previous R13,00 offer.

At 31 March 2026, the Group held a 39,96% interest in Mustek Limited. Subsequent to year-end, the Group concluded two separate transactions which increased its shareholding to 50,39%. Details of the transactions were announced on SENS on 05 June 2026 and 10 June 2026, respectively. Given the recent timing of the transactions approximating the date of authorisation of these financial statements, its impracticality results in management not being able to perform a control assessment in terms of IFRS 10: Consolidated Financial Statements and to quantify the financial effects of this transaction in line with IFRS 3: Business Combinations. Therefore, no disclosures are presented as contemplated by IFRS 3: Business Combinations.

Effective 16 April 2026, the Group entered into share subscription agreements with Forestry Systems Proprietary Limited (South Africa) and Forest Systems Ltd (Mauritius), subject to fulfilment of suspensive conditions by 15 July 2026. Upon implementation, the Group will acquire a 50,1% shareholding in each entity for a combined cash consideration of R24,5 million.

Subsequent to the reporting date, Maskew Miller Learning (Pty) Ltd (a subsidiary of the group) initiated a comprehensive restructuring exercise affecting all staff across its operations. The restructuring programme was approved and is aimed at aligning the organisation's cost base and operating model with its strategic objectives and current market conditions.

The restructuring includes:

- A review and redesign of the organisational structure;
- Redundancies and role rationalisation across various functions; and
- The implementation of revised operating processes and reporting lines.

At the reporting date, no formal plan for the restructuring had been announced and no constructive obligation existed. Accordingly, no provision has been recognised in the financial statements for the year ended 31 March 2026 in respect of this restructuring.

The Group entered into a sale agreement for its Investment Property (refer to note 38) on 17 March 2026. The property's sale was contingent to fulfilment or waiver of certain conditions which were not met at year end, but were fulfilled by 18 May 2026. The fair value of the property is considered to be R85 million based on this sale agreement.

Notes to the annual financial statements (continued)

for the year ended 31 March 2026

41. EVENTS AFTER REPORTING DATE (continued)

The Board approved and declared a final gross dividend No. 8 of 55 cents per share for the year ended 31 March 2026 (2025: 55 cents). The source of the dividend is from distributable reserves and will be paid in cash. The dividend declared is subject to dividend withholding tax at 20,0%. The tax payable is 11 cents per share, leaving shareholders who are not exempt from dividends tax with a net dividend of 44 cents per share.

The issued share capital of Novus Holdings at the declaration date comprises 343 183 023 shares.

The Company's income tax reference number is 9656/360/15/4.

The salient dates for the dividend are:

Last day to trade (cum dividend)	Tuesday, 30 June 2026
Trading ex dividend commences	Wednesday, 01 July 2026
Record date	Friday, 03 July 2026
Closing balance	Monday, 06 July 2026

Share certificates may not be dematerialised or rematerialised between Wednesday, 01 July 2026 and Friday, 03 July 2026, both dates inclusive.

Analysis of shareholders

Size of holdings	Number of shareholders	Number of shares owned
1 - 1,000	4 516	769 281
1,001 - 50,000	1 068	11 511 842
50,001 - 100,000	86	6 144 722
100,001 - 10,000,000	126	53 737 340
10,000,001 and above	5	244 440 098
	5 801	316 603 283

The following shareholders hold 5% or more of the issued share capital of the company.

Name	% held	Number of shares owned
Peresec Equities (Johannesburg)	32,84%	112 692 710
A ² Investment Partners (Cape Town)	28,49%	97 770 533
Novus Holdings Share Trust (Johannesburg)	5,76%	19 759 942
Investec Wealth & Investment (Cape Town)	7,45%	25 570 612
	83,73%	287 343 998

Public shareholder spread

To the best of the knowledge of the Board, the spread of public shareholders at 31 March 2026 was 31.20%, represented by 5 799 shareholders holding 107 076 594 shares in the Company. The non-public shareholders of the Company comprising 5 shareholders representing 236 106 429 ordinary shares are analysed as follows:

Non-public shareholders	Number of shares	% of issued share capital
A ² Investment Partners Proprietary Limited	97 770 533	30,88%
Novus Print Proprietary Limited	745	0,00%
Novus Holdings Share Trust	19 759 197	6,24%
Peresec Prime Brokers Proprietary Limited	111 756 156	35,30%
Novus Packaging Proprietary Limited	6 819 798	2,15%
	236 106 429	74,57%